

Macbeth

William Shakespeare · 1606

First Folio (1623) text as edited by Standard Ebooks

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

29 scene lessons plus 3 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 35 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 7 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC
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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–29), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Whole-book test and answer key
6. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Macbeth survives only in the 1623 First Folio. The reading text is the Standard Ebooks edition, divided into the conventional 28 scenes (plus the cast list). Most scholars think the Hecate passages (Act III, Scene V and part of Act IV, Scene I) were added by another writer, probably Thomas Middleton. Cite act, scene and line from this edition.

Content note for teachers: Recurring violence (murders on and off stage, including a child), witchcraft, a reported suicide and a severed head; the play's treatment of 'manhood' and of Lady Macbeth draws on period gender ideas that deserve critical discussion. See the scene notes and the safe-messaging script.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (also 7–8 with support; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Excerpt-based support track: these plays are above the grades 6–8 text-complexity band, so Middle School prompts work from teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 7. **Class days:** 35 × 90 minutes (29 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Macbeth suggest about ambition and its costs?
- What does Macbeth suggest about fate and free will?
- What does Macbeth suggest about guilt and conscience?
- What does Macbeth suggest about appearance versus reality?
- What does Macbeth suggest about masculinity, power and violence?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the play.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards: Common Core

RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Dramatis Personae Act I, Scene I Act I, Scene II Act I, Scene III	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*ambition and its costs* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Act I, Scene IV *Socratic seminar on ambition and its costs* Act I, Scene V Act I, Scene VI Act I, Scene VII	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*fate and free will* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on ambition and its costs • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Act II, Scene I Act II, Scene II Act II, Scene III Act II, Scene IV Act III, Scene I	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*guilt and conscience* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
4	Act III, Scene II Act III, Scene III *Socratic seminar on fate and free will* Act III, Scene IV Act III, Scene V	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*appearance versus reality* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on fate and free will • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
5	Act III, Scene VI Act IV, Scene I Act IV, Scene II Act IV, Scene III Act V, Scene I	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*masculinity, power and violence* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
6				

	Act V, Scene II Act V, Scene III Act V, Scene IV *Socratic seminar on guilt and conscience* Act V, Scene V	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*ambition and its costs* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on guilt and conscience • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
7	Act V, Scene VI Act V, Scene VII Act V, Scene VIII *Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final essay workshop and submission*	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*fate and free will* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final essay workshop and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Macbeth

Author biography

William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, the son of John Shakespeare, a glover and town official, and Mary Arden. He probably attended Stratford's grammar school, married Anne Hathaway in 1582, and had three children: Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith (Hamnet died aged eleven in 1596). By the early 1590s he was an actor and playwright in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, who built the Globe theatre in 1599 and became the King's Men when James VI of Scotland became James I of England in 1603. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays and the Sonnets, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. Seven years later his fellow actors John Heminges and Henry Condell published 36 of his plays in the First Folio (1623).

Historical and cultural context

Macbeth was written around 1606 for a company that now served a Scottish king. James I was fascinated by witchcraft (he wrote a treatise, Daemonologie, in 1597, and had taken part in witch trials in Scotland) and traced his descent from Banquo, whom the play makes noble. In November 1605 the Gunpowder Plot to blow up the king and Parliament was discovered; at the 1606 trial of the Jesuit Henry Garnet, "equivocation" (misleading by ambiguous speech) became notorious, and the Porter's joke about an "equivocator" in Act II, Scene III points to it. Shakespeare took his story from Raphael Holinshed's Chronicles (1587), changing much: the historical Macbeth ruled Scotland from 1040 to 1057 and killed Duncan I in battle, not in his bed.

Publication and reception, then and now

The play was first printed in the First Folio (1623), the only early text. It is Shakespeare's shortest tragedy, and most scholars think the version we have was adapted after his death, with the Hecate passages probably added by Thomas Middleton. The earliest surviving eyewitness account of a performance is the astrologer Simon Forman's description of a Macbeth at the Globe in April 1611.

Then: Little is recorded about first reactions. After the theatres reopened in 1660, William Davenant staged a version with added songs and flying witches that held the stage for decades; the actor David Garrick restored much of Shakespeare's text in 1744. Romantic critics such as Thomas De Quincey ("On the Knocking at the Gate in Macbeth," 1823) praised its psychological intensity.

Now: Macbeth is among the most performed and taught of all plays. Film versions range from Akira Kurosawa's Throne of Blood (1957) to Roman Polanski's (1971) and Joel Coen's The Tragedy of Macbeth (2021). Theatre superstition calls it "the Scottish play" and avoids saying its name backstage. Modern critics debate its gender politics (Lady Macbeth's "unsex me here"), its view of fate and free will, and its politics of tyranny and succession.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Returning from a victorious battle, the Scottish general Macbeth meets three witches who greet him with titles, including "king hereafter." What Macbeth and his wife do with that prophecy, and what it does to them and to Scotland, is the play.

Main themes

- ambition: watch how wanting becomes doing, and what each crime demands next.
- fate and free will: the witches predict, but who decides?
- appearance and reality: "fair is foul": faces, words and prophecies that hide their meaning.
- guilt and conscience: blood, sleep and hands; how guilt shows itself.
- masculinity and power: what "being a man" means to each character.

Why it matters

Macbeth is the classic study of how a decent, admired person talks himself into doing evil, and of how leaders who seize power must keep using violence to hold it. Those patterns are visible in politics and in ordinary life, and the play's language about guilt has entered everyday English ("out, damned spot").

Spoilers · teacher only

Macbeth murders King Duncan in his sleep, urged by Lady Macbeth; Duncan's sons flee and Macbeth is crowned. He has Banquo murdered (Fleance escapes), sees Banquo's ghost, returns to the witches and receives riddling prophecies, and has Macduff's family slaughtered. Lady Macbeth sleepwalks and dies, probably by suicide. Malcolm's army, carrying branches from Birnam Wood, attacks Dunsinane; Macduff, "from his mother's womb untimely ripped," kills Macbeth, and Malcolm becomes king.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
>
> *Before we open Macbeth: Imagine someone tells you that you will definitely get something you want. Would you wait for it, or try to make it happen? Write for five minutes.*
> **Prompt:** Before we open Macbeth: Imagine someone tells you that you will definitely get something you want. Would you wait for it, or try to make it happen? Write for five minutes.

> **8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)**
>
> *tragedy (a play in which a great figure falls through his own choices); soliloquy (a speech alone on stage revealing thoughts); aside (a remark the audience hears but other characters do not); dramatic irony (the audience knows what a character does not); blank verse (unrhymed iambic pentameter); thane (a Scottish lord).*

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

About the author. William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, the son of John Shakespeare, a glover and town official, and Mary Arden. He probably attended Stratford's grammar school, married Anne Hathaway in 1582, and had three children: Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith (Hamnet died aged eleven in 1596). By the early 1590s he was an actor and playwright in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, who built the Globe theatre in 1599 and became the King's Men when James VI of Scotland became James I of England in 1603. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays and the Sonnets, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. Seven years later his fellow actors John Heminges and Henry Condell published 36 of his plays in the First Folio (1623). The world of the book. Macbeth was written around 1606 for a company that now served a Scottish king. James I was fascinated by witchcraft (he wrote a treatise, Daemonologie, in 1597, and had taken part in witch trials in Scotland) and traced his descent from Banquo, whom the play makes noble. In November 1605 the Gunpowder Plot to blow up the king and Parliament was discovered; at the 1606 trial of the Jesuit Henry Garnet, "equivocation" (misleading by ambiguous speech) became notorious, and the Porter's joke about an "equivocator" in Act II, Scene III points to it. Shakespeare took his story from Raphael Holinshed's Chronicles (1587), changing much: the historical Macbeth ruled Scotland from 1040 to 1057 and killed Duncan I in battle, not in his bed. Publication and reception. The play was first printed in the First Folio (1623), the only early text. It is Shakespeare's shortest tragedy, and most scholars think the version we have was adapted after his death, with the Hecate passages probably added by Thomas Middleton. The earliest surviving eyewitness account of a performance is the astrologer Simon Forman's description of a Macbeth at the Globe in April 1611. Then: Little is recorded about first reactions. After the theatres reopened in 1660, William Davenant staged a version with added songs and flying witches that held the stage for decades; the actor David Garrick restored much of Shakespeare's text in 1744. Romantic critics such as Thomas De Quincey ("On the Knocking at the Gate in Macbeth," 1823) praised its psychological intensity. Now: Macbeth is among the most performed and taught of all plays. Film versions range from Akira Kurosawa's Throne of Blood (1957) to Roman Polanski's (1971) and Joel Coen's The Tragedy of Macbeth (2021). Theatre superstition calls it "the Scottish play" and avoids saying its name backstage. Modern critics debate its gender politics (Lady Macbeth's "unsex me here"), its view of fate and free will, and its politics of tyranny and succession.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

“Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)). The witches' chant in the first scene: the play's motto. Values are inverted and appearances lie.

> *Fair is foul, and foul is fair* *(Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10))*

Think-aloud: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)). The witches' chant in the first scene: the play's motto. Values are inverted and appearances lie.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)

What the book is about (no spoilers): Returning from a victorious battle, the Scottish general Macbeth meets three witches who greet him with titles, including "king hereafter." What Macbeth and his wife do with that prophecy, and what it does to them and to Scotland, is the play. Themes to track: ambition: watch how wanting becomes doing, and what each crime demands next. fate and free will: the witches predict, but who decides? appearance and reality: "fair is foul": faces, words and prophecies that hide their meaning. guilt and conscience: blood, sleep and hands; how guilt shows itself. masculinity and power: what "being a man" means to each character.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)

Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "fate and free will": Prediction: the witches will be right but in an unexpected way. Question: would Macbeth have killed anyone without them?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Macbeth: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page "fate and free will": Prediction: the witches will be right but in an unexpected way. Question: would Macbeth have killed anyone without them?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Why does Macbeth still matter? Macbeth is the classic study of how a decent, admired person talks himself into doing evil, and of how leaders who seize power must keep using violence to hold it. Those patterns are visible in politics and in ordinary life, and the play's language about guilt has entered everyday English ("out, damned spot").
Anchor question: Why might Macbeth still be taught today?
Facilitation: Macbeth is the classic study of how a decent, admired person talks himself into doing evil, and of how leaders who seize power must keep using violence to hold it. Those patterns are visible in politics and in ordinary life, and the play's language about guilt has entered everyday English ("out, damned spot").

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)

Name one fact about the time Macbeth was written that helps explain something in the play. Answer: Examples: King James believed in witches and wrote a book about them (the witches); James claimed descent from Banquo (Banquo is shown as noble); the Gunpowder Plot and "equivocation" (the Porter's joke and the riddling prophecies).
Exit ticket: Name one fact about the time Macbeth was written that helps explain something in the play.
Answer: Examples: King James believed in witches and wrote a book about them (the witches); James claimed descent from Banquo (Banquo is shown as noble); the Gunpowder Plot and "equivocation" (the Porter's joke and the riddling prophecies).

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)

Tomorrow we begin reading: Dramatis Personae.

Teacher notes · sources: Folger Shakespeare Library, "Shakespeare's life" and "Macbeth" (https://www.folger.edu/explore/shakespeares-works/macbeth/); Royal Shakespeare Company, "Macbeth: about the play" (https://www.rsc.org.uk/macbeth/about-the-play); British Library, "Macbeth, Holinshed and the Gunpowder Plot" (https://www.bl.uk/shakespeare/articles/macbeth-and-the-gunpowder-plot); Britannica, "Macbeth" (king of Scotland) (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Macbeth-king-of-Scotland); Simon Forman, Booke of Plaies (Bodleian MS Ashmole 208) (https://www.bodleian.ox.ac.uk/); Thomas De Quincey, "On the Knocking at the Gate in Macbeth" (1823) (https://www.gutenberg.org/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- The date "around 1606" is a scholarly inference (the Porter's equivocation joke, the Gunpowder Plot, a probable performance before King James); no record fixes it.
- The Middleton revision of the Hecate scenes is the majority view, not a certainty.
- Whether Lady Macbeth's death is suicide rests on Malcolm's report in the last scene ("by self and violent hands"); present it as reported.

Lesson 2: Dramatis Personae

Focus: the cast and world of the play

Teacher only · spoilers

The cast list sets up two kingdoms (Scotland and England), King Duncan and his sons Malcolm and Donalbain, the generals Macbeth and Banquo, the thanes (Macduff, Lennox, Ross and others), Lady Macbeth and Lady Macduff, Hecate and three Witches, and apparitions. The play moves between Scottish castles, a heath, a battlefield and the English court.

Background: Shakespeare wrote Macbeth around 1606, soon after James VI of Scotland became James I of England (1603). James claimed descent from Banquo, had written a book on witchcraft (Daemonologie, 1597) and had survived the Gunpowder Plot (1605). Shakespeare drew the story loosely from Holinshed's Chronicles (1587).

Significance: A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the first scene.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because....
Prompt: If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: disbursed — paid out (money); furbish — to polish and make (weapons) ready again; overcharged — loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge; cannons — large guns that fire heavy shot; vantage — an opportunity or advantage.
Words: disbursed: paid out (money) · furbish: to polish and make (weapons) ready again · overcharged: loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge · cannons: large guns that fire heavy shot · vantage: an opportunity or advantage

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Shakespeare wrote Macbeth around 1606, soon after James VI of Scotland became James I of England (1603). James claimed descent from Banquo, had written a book on witchcraft (Daemonologie, 1597) and had survived the Gunpowder Plot (1605). Shakespeare drew the story loosely from Holinshed's Chronicles (1587). A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the first scene. Characterization: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test. Setting: "Scotland; England": a divided map. England will be where the rightful heir and the forces of order gather. Structure: Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "Duncan, king of Scotland" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Macbeth, general of the king's army" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)). Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. That is characterization at work: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test.

> *Macbeth, general of the king's army (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Macbeth, general of the king's army" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)). Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. That is characterization at work: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. Look at the craft: "Scotland; England": a divided map. England will be where the rightful heir and the forces of order gather. Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected: Almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. (The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil.)

> *Banquo, general of the king's army (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. Look at the craft: "Scotland; England": a divided map. England will be where the rightful heir and the forces of order gather.
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected answer: Almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. (The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the cast and world of the play? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the cast and world of the play. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. When the text says "Macbeth, general of the king's army" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)), it shows this directly. Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the cast and world of the play? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the cast and world of the play. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. When the text says "Macbeth, general of the king's army" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)), it shows this directly. Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge? Ask students to sort the cast into groups (royal family, thanes, outsiders, supernatural) and predict which groups will clash.
Anchor question: If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge?
Facilitation: Ask students to sort the cast into groups (royal family, thanes, outsiders, supernatural) and predict which groups will clash.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the cast and world of the play? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. ("Macbeth, general of the king's army", Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the cast and world of the play? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. ("Macbeth, general of the king's army", Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the cast and world of the play. Key takeaway: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test.
- **Setting:** "Scotland; England": a divided map. England will be where the rightful heir and the forces of order gather.
- **Structure:** Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Duncan, king of Scotland” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)) Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break.
- “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)) The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil.
- “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)) Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation.
Evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0))
Reasoning: Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
disbursed (verb)	paid out (money)	*That now Sweno, the Norways’ king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme’s inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
furbish (verb)	to polish and make (weapons) ready again	*Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm’d Compell’d these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish’d arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
overcharged (adjective)	loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge	*If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cannons (noun)			

	large guns that fire heavy shot	*If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vantage (noun)	an opportunity or advantage	*Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm'd Compell'd these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish'd arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
banners (noun)	flags carried by an army	*From Fife, great king; Where the Norweyan banners flout the sky And fan our people cold.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pronounce (verb)	to declare or say aloud	*No more that thane of Cawdor shall deceive Our bosom interest: go pronounce his present death, And with his former title greet Macbeth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
shipman (noun)	a sailor	*I myself have all the other, And the very ports they blow, All the quarters that they know I' the shipman's card.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which characters on the cast list are women? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff, the Gentlewoman, Hecate and the three Witches.
2. Who is the king of Scotland at the start of the play? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Duncan
3. Which two countries does the play take place in? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Scotland and England
4. What are Malcolm and Donalbain to Duncan? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His sons

5. Which character is listed as general of the king's army? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Macbeth
6. Which supernatural figure leads the Witches? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Hecate
7. Retell the three most important events of "Dramatis Personae" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The cast list sets up two kingdoms (Scotland and England), King Duncan and his sons Malcolm and Donalbain, the generals Macbeth and Banquo, the thanes (Macduff, Lennox, Ross and others), Lady Macbeth and Lady Macduff, Hecate and three Witches, and apparitions. The play moves between Scottish castles, a heath, a battlefield and the English court.
8. Who is on stage in "Dramatis Personae", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Dramatis Personae" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "That now Sweno, the Norways' king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme's inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use." What does "disbursed" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: disbursed: paid out (money).

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Shakespeare's first audience, under King James, have watched Banquo with special interest? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: James I claimed descent from Banquo; the play flatters that line.
2. What does "Dramatis Personae" suggest about the cast and world of the play? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the first scene.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the cast and world of the play? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: "Macbeth, general of the king's army" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. On characterization: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Duncan, king of Scotland”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Dramatis Personae”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: The cast list sets up two kingdoms (Scotland and England), King Duncan and his sons Malcolm and Donalbain, the generals Macbeth and Banquo, the thanes (Macduff, Lennox, Ross and others), Lady Macbeth and Lady Macduff, Hecate and three Witches, and apparitions. The play moves between Scottish…
7. As the opening scene, what does “Dramatis Personae” set up that the rest of Macbeth will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. On structure: Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). On characterization: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. On structure: Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is a cast list a neutral document? What does the order of names suggest about who matters in this world? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Rank and gender shape the order; kings and lords first, women and servants later.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the first scene.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. On characterization: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Dramatis Personae”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the cast and world of the play. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. On structure: Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Dramatis Personae”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. On setting: "Scotland; England": a divided map. England will be where the rightful heir and the forces of order gather. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Dramatis Personae” treats the cast and world of the play with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: "Macbeth, general of the king's army" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the cast and world of the play? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: "Banquo, general of the king's army" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz

1. Who is the king of Scotland at the start of the play?
    A. Duncan
    B. Macbeth
    C. Edward
    D. Malcolm
2. Which two countries does the play take place in?
    A. Scotland and England
    B. Scotland and Norway
    C. England and France
    D. Denmark and Scotland
3. What are Malcolm and Donalbain to Duncan?
    A. His generals
    B. His nephews
    C. His sons
    D. His brothers

4. Which character is listed as general of the king's army?
   A. Ross
   B. Macbeth
   C. Macduff
   D. Seyton
5. Which supernatural figure leads the Witches?
   A. Banquo's ghost
   B. Hecate
   C. The Porter
   D. An apparition
6. In the line "That now Sweno, the Norways' king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme's inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use.", what does "disbursed" most nearly mean?
   A. large guns that fire heavy shot
   B. loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge
   C. to polish and make (weapons) ready again
   D. paid out (money)
7. In the line "Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm'd Compell'd these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish'd arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.", what does "furbish" most nearly mean?
   A. loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge
   B. to polish and make (weapons) ready again
   C. paid out (money)
   D. large guns that fire heavy shot

Answer key: 1. A (Duncan); 2. A (Scotland and England); 3. C (His sons); 4. B (Macbeth); 5. B (Hecate); 6. D (paid out (money)); 7. B (to polish and make (weapons) ready again)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Dramatis Personae," how does Shakespeare show the cast and world of the play? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Dramatis Personae, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the cast and world of the play? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the cast and world of the play. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual

evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Dramatis Personae (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the cast and world of the play. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Dramatis Personae suggests about the cast and world of the play. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Dramatis Personae to complicate the reader's understanding of the cast and world of the play. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Dramatis Personae within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the cast and world of the play responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Dramatis Personae alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the cast and world of the play follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Dramatis Personae and its treatment of the cast and world of the play. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Dramatis Personae as evidence for a larger claim about the cast and world of the play in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Dramatis Personae as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the cast and world of the play. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "overcharged" most nearly mean?

   A. to declare or say aloud

   B. loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge

   C. a sailor

   D. flags carried by an army

2. *Duncan, king of Scotland*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Dramatis Personae"?

   A. The ghost at the banquet

   B. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief

   C. The cast and world of the play

   D. The tyrant's end and a new order

SAT key: 1. B (loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge); 2. C (The cast and world of the play)

Lesson 3: Act I, Scene I

Focus: the Witches' riddling world

Teacher only · spoilers

In thunder and lightning on a deserted place, three Witches agree to meet again 'when the hurlyburly's done, when the battle's lost and won,' upon the heath, to meet Macbeth. Called away by their familiars, they chant 'Fair is foul, and foul is fair' and vanish into the fog and filthy air.

Background: Jacobean audiences took witchcraft seriously: the 1604 Witchcraft Act made conjuring spirits a capital crime. Storms were believed to signal disorder in nature and the state.

Significance: The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....
Prompt: Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: disbursed — paid out (money); furbish — to polish and make (weapons) ready again; overcharged — loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge; cannons — large guns that fire heavy shot; vantage — an opportunity or advantage.
Words: disbursed: paid out (money) · furbish: to polish and make (weapons) ready again · overcharged: loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge · cannons: large guns that fire heavy shot · vantage: an opportunity or advantage

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Jacobean audiences took witchcraft seriously: the 1604 Witchcraft Act made conjuring spirits a capital crime. Storms were believed to signal disorder in nature and the state. The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech. Setting: A desert place in thunder and lightning: a world out of order before the story begins. Diction / vocabulary: Short rhyming lines in trochaic rhythm (stressed first syllables) set the witches apart from the blank verse of humans. FigurativeLanguage: Paradox ("When the battle's lost and won"; "Fair is foul") makes contradiction the witches' language. Watch for equivocation: "Fair is foul": appearances and words that mean two things, from the witches to the Porter to the prophecies. In this scene: "Fair is foul, and foul is fair: / Hover through the fog and" (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain" (Act I, Scene I, First Witch (speech 1)). The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. That is setting at work: A desert place in thunder and lightning: a world out of order before the story begins.

> *When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain* (Act I, Scene I, First Witch (speech 1))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain" (Act I, Scene I, First Witch (speech 1)). The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. That is setting at work: A desert place in thunder and lightning: a world out of order before the story begins.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Paradox: two opposites said to be the same. "Fair is foul" means beauty can hide evil and evil can look attractive. Expected link: appearance and reality. Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality? Expected: The first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. (The play's motto: moral values inverted.)

> *Fair is foul, and foul is fair* (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Paradox: two opposites said to be the same. "Fair is foul" means beauty can hide evil and evil can look attractive. Expected link: appearance and reality.
Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality?
Expected answer: The first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. (The play's motto: moral values inverted.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for setting, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Witches' riddling world? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the Witches' riddling world. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. When the text says "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)), it shows this directly. The witches' chant "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" collapses good and evil into each other, and their paradox "the battle's lost and won" warns that victory and defeat can be the same event.

Task: Annotate the scene for setting, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Witches' riddling world? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the Witches' riddling world. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. When the text says "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)), it shows this directly. The witches' chant "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" collapses good and evil into each other, and their paradox "the battle's lost and won" warns that victory and defeat can be the same event.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell? Ask: why open with the witches before we meet the hero?

Anchor question: Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell?

Facilitation: Ask: why open with the witches before we meet the hero?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Witches' riddling world? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. ("Fair is foul, and foul is fair", Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Witches' riddling world? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. ("Fair is foul, and foul is fair", Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how setting shapes the Witches' riddling world. Key takeaway: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** A desert place in thunder and lightning: a world out of order before the story begins.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Short rhyming lines in trochaic rhythm (stressed first syllables) set the witches apart from the blank verse of humans.
- **FigurativeLanguage:** Paradox ("When the battle's lost and won"; "Fair is foul") makes contradiction the witches' language.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.

Symbols and motifs

- **equivocation:** "Fair is foul": appearances and words that mean two things, from the witches to the Porter to the prophecies. In this scene: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair: / Hover through the fog and” (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch (speech 1)) The opening question: a world of storm and repetition.
- “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch (speech 2)) Paradox: every battle is lost by someone.
- “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)) The play's motto: moral values inverted.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed.
> **Evidence:** “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10))
> **Reasoning:** The witches' chant "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" collapses good and evil into each other, and their paradox "the battle's lost and won" warns that victory and defeat can be the same event.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

disbursed (verb)	paid out (money)	*That now Sweno, the Norways' king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme's inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
furbish (verb)	to polish and make (weapons) ready again	*Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm'd Compell'd these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish'd arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
overcharged (adjective)	loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge	*If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cannons (noun)	large guns that fire heavy shot	*If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vantage (noun)	an opportunity or advantage	*Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm'd Compell'd these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish'd arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
banners (noun)	flags carried by an army	*From Fife, great king; Where the Norweyan banners flout the sky And fan our people cold.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pronounce (verb)	to declare or say aloud	*No more that thane of Cawdor shall deceive Our bosom interest: go pronounce his present death, And with his former title greet Macbeth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
shipman (noun)	a sailor	*I myself have all the other, And the very ports they blow, All the quarters that they know I' the shipman's card.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What do the Witches say they will do when the hurlyburly is done? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Meet again, upon the heath, to meet with Macbeth.
2. What weather opens the play? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Thunder and lightning
3. Whom do the Witches plan to meet? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Macbeth
4. Where do the Witches agree to meet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Upon the heath
5. What paradox do the Witches chant? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Fair is foul, and foul is fair
6. When will the Witches meet again? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: When the battle's lost and won
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: In thunder and lightning on a deserted place, three Witches agree to meet again 'when the hurlyburly's done, when the battle's lost and won,' upon the heath, to meet Macbeth. Called away by their familiars, they chant 'Fair is foul, and foul is fair' and vanish into the fog and filthy air.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "That now Sweno, the Norways' king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme's inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use." What does "disbursed" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: disbursed: paid out (money).

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Shakespeare open with the Witches instead of the battle or the king? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: It frames events as shaped by uncanny forces and sets the paradox before the hero appears.
2. What does "Act I, Scene I" suggest about the Witches' riddling world? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

4. How does the foreshadowing in this scene shape what we understand about the Witches' riddling world? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch (speech 1)): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “A desert place.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: In thunder and lightning on a deserted place, three Witches agree to meet again 'when the hurlyburly's done, when the battle's lost and won,' upon the heath, to meet Macbeth. Called away by their familiars, they chant 'Fair is foul, and foul is fair' and vanish into the fog and filthy air.
7. How does “Act I, Scene I” build on “Dramatis Personae”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch (speech 2)): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch (speech 1)): The opening question: a world of

storm and repetition. On diction / vocabulary: Short rhyming lines in trochaic rhythm (stressed first syllables) set the witches apart from the blank verse of humans. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. How would you stage the Witches today so that they still feel threatening? Defend your choice. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A staging choice justified by the scene's language and mood.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch (speech 2)): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch (speech 1)): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the Witches' riddling world. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch (speech 2)): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where

appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch (speech 1)): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch (speech 2)): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. On setting: A desert place in thunder and lightning: a world out of order before the story begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene I” treats the Witches' riddling world with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All (speech 10)): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch (speech 1)): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the Witches' riddling world? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When the hurlyburly’s done, /

When the battle's lost and won" (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch (speech 2)): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz

1. What weather opens the play?
   A. Heavy snow
   B. A calm night
   C. A clear summer day
   D. Thunder and lightning
2. Whom do the Witches plan to meet?
   A. Duncan
   B. Banquo
   C. Macbeth
   D. Macduff
3. Where do the Witches agree to meet?
   A. At Duncan's camp
   B. Upon the heath
   C. At Inverness castle
   D. In England
4. What paradox do the Witches chant?
   A. Double, double toil and trouble
   B. Fair is foul, and foul is fair
   C. Out, damned spot
   D. All hail, Macbeth
5. When will the Witches meet again?
   A. Before the next storm
   B. At midnight on Christmas
   C. After Duncan is crowned
   D. When the battle's lost and won

6. In the line “That now Sweno, the Norways’ king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme’s inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use.”, what does “disbursed” most nearly mean?
   A. to polish and make (weapons) ready again
   B. large guns that fire heavy shot
   C. paid out (money)
   D. loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge
7. In the line “Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm’d Compell’d these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish’d arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.”, what does “furbish” most nearly mean?
   A. large guns that fire heavy shot
   B. to polish and make (weapons) ready again
   C. loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge
   D. paid out (money)

Answer key: 1. D (Thunder and lightning); 2. C (Macbeth); 3. B (Upon the heath); 4. B (Fair is foul, and foul is fair); 5. D (When the battle's lost and won); 6. C (paid out (money)); 7. B (to polish and make (weapons) ready again)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the Witches' riddling world? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the Witches' riddling world? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the Witches' riddling world. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the Witches' riddling world. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene I suggests about the Witches' riddling world. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act I, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the Witches' riddling world. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the Witches' riddling world responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the Witches' riddling world follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene I and its treatment of the Witches' riddling world. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the Witches' riddling world in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the Witches' riddling world. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “overcharged” most nearly mean?

   A. a sailor

   B. to declare or say aloud

   C. flags carried by an army

   D. loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge

2. *A desert place.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene I”?

   A. The ghost at the banquet

   B. The guilt that will not wash away

C. Suspicion spoken through irony

D. The Witches' riddling world

SAT key: 1. D (loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge); 2. D (The Witches' riddling world)

Lesson 4: Act I, Scene II

Focus: Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

Content note (battlefield violence): The Captain describes Macbeth cutting a rebel open 'from the nave to the chaps' and fixing his head on the battlements. Keep focus on what the praise says about Macbeth, not the gore.
Student preview: This scene describes battlefield violence in vivid terms.
Suggested language: "Why is Macbeth praised for this? What does that tell us about this world?"

Teacher only · spoilers

At a camp near Forres a bleeding Captain tells Duncan how 'brave Macbeth' cut the rebel Macdonwald open 'from the nave to the chaps' and, with Banquo, fought on against a fresh Norwegian attack. Ross reports the treachery of the Thane of Cawdor and the victory over Norway. Duncan orders Cawdor's execution and gives his title to Macbeth.

Background: Thanes were Scottish nobles holding land from the king. Rebellion (Macdonwald) and treason by a trusted noble (Cawdor) were real fears; the 1605 Gunpowder Plot was fresh in memory.

Significance: We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition because.... Content note before we start: This scene describes battlefield violence in vivid terms.
Prompt: Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: disbursed — paid out (money); furbish — to polish and make (weapons) ready again; overcharged — loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge; cannons — large guns that fire heavy shot; vantage — an opportunity or advantage.
Words: disbursed: paid out (money) · furbish: to polish and make (weapons) ready again · overcharged: loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge · cannons: large guns that fire heavy shot · vantage: an opportunity or advantage

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Thanes were Scottish nobles holding land from the king. Rebellion (Macdonwald) and treason by a trusted noble (Cawdor) were real fears; the 1605 Gunpowder Plot was fresh in memory. We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor. Characterization: The bleeding Captain's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps." Irony: Duncan gives the traitor Cawdor's title to Macbeth, the next traitor. Imagery: Blood, already: the Captain's wounds and Macbeth's sword "which smoked with bloody execution." Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "fought / 'Gainst my captivity. Hail, brave friend! / Say to the king the knowledge of the broil / As thou didst leave it" (Act I, Scene II, Malcolm (speech 2)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)). The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. That is characterization at work: The bleeding Captain's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps."

> *For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name* (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)). The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. That is characterization at work: The bleeding Captain's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps."

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Duncan's line repeats "lost" and "won" from Scene I: dramatic irony, since Macbeth will inherit Cawdor's treason as well as his title. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition? Expected: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. (Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won.")

> *What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won* (Act I, Scene II, Duncan (speech 18))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Duncan's line repeats "lost" and "won" from Scene I: dramatic irony, since Macbeth will inherit Cawdor's treason as well as his title.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition?
Expected answer: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. (Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won.")

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. When the text says "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)), it shows this directly. The Captain calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. When the text says "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)), it shows this directly. The Captain calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else? Ask: is it unsettling that the hero is introduced through such brutal violence?

Anchor question: Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else?

Facilitation: Ask: is it unsettling that the hero is introduced through such brutal violence?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. (“For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name”, Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. (“For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name”, Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Key takeaway: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The bleeding Captain's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps."
- **Irony:** Duncan gives the traitor Cawdor's title to Macbeth, the next traitor.
- **Imagery:** Blood, already: the Captain's wounds and Macbeth's sword "which smoked with bloody execution."

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition:** Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “fought / ’Gainst my captivity. Hail, brave friend! / Say to the king the knowledge of the broil / As thou didst leave it” (Act I, Scene II, Malcolm (speech 2)).
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: “What bloody man is that? He can report, / As seemeth by his plight” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan (speech 1)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)) The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic.
- “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)) Graphic violence praised as service.
- “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan (speech 18)) Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won."

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king.
Evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3))
Reasoning: The Captain calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
disbursed (verb)	paid out (money)	*That now Sweno, the Norways’ king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme’s inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
furbish (verb)	to polish and make (weapons) ready again	*Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm’d Compell’d these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish’d arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
overcharged (adjective)	loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge	*If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cannons (noun)	large guns that fire heavy shot	*If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vantage (noun)	an opportunity or advantage	*Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm’d Compell’d these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish’d arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
banners (noun)	flags carried by an army	*From Fife, great king; Where the Norweyan banners flout the sky And fan our people cold.*	

			Student look-up (not yet verified)
pronounce (verb)	to declare or say aloud	*No more that thane of Cawdor shall deceive Our bosom interest: go pronounce his present death, And with his former title greet Macbeth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
shipman (noun)	a sailor	*I myself have all the other, And the very ports they blow, All the quarters that they know I' the shipman's card.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which two captains does the Captain compare to 'cannons overcharged with double cracks'? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Macbeth and Banquo.
2. Who reports Macbeth's deeds in battle at the start of the scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A wounded Captain
3. What does Macbeth do to the rebel Macdonwald? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Cuts him open and fixes his head on the battlements
4. Which noble has betrayed Scotland by helping Norway? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The Thane of Cawdor
5. What does Duncan order for the Thane of Cawdor? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His execution
6. What reward does Duncan give Macbeth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The title Thane of Cawdor
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: At a camp near Forres a bleeding Captain tells Duncan how 'brave Macbeth' cut the rebel Macdonwald open 'from the nave to the chaps' and, with Banquo, fought on against a fresh Norwegian attack. Ross reports the treachery of the Thane of Cawdor and the victory over Norway. Duncan orders Cawdor's execution and gives his title to Macbeth.

8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act I, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “That now Sweno, the Norways’ king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme’s inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use.” What does “disbursed” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: disbursed: paid out (money).

Inferential / analytical

1. Duncan says 'What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won.' What irony does this line carry for the audience? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Macbeth inherits Cawdor's title and also his treachery.
2. What does “Act I, Scene II” suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. On characterization: The bleeding Captain's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “As whence the sun ’gins his reflection Shipwrecking storms and direful thunders break, So from that spring whence comfort seem’d to come Discomfort swells.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: At a camp near Forres a bleeding Captain tells Duncan how 'brave Macbeth' cut the rebel Macdonwald open 'from the nave to the chaps' and, with Banquo, fought on against a fresh Norwegian attack. Ross reports the treachery of the Thane of Cawdor and the victory over Norway. Duncan orders Cawdor's…
7. How does “Act I, Scene II” build on “Act I, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic,

which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)): Graphic violence praised as service. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan (speech 18)): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." On characterization: The bleeding Captain's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. On irony: Duncan gives the traitor Cawdor's title to Macbeth, the next traitor. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Duncan trusted Cawdor completely. Is trust a strength or a weakness in a ruler? Judge Duncan. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment about Duncan's trust with evidence from I.ii and I.iv.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)): Graphic violence praised as service. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic,

which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan (speech 18)): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. On characterization: The bleeding Captain's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)): Graphic violence praised as service. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan (speech 18)): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)): Graphic violence praised as service. On imagery: Blood, already: the Captain's wounds and Macbeth's sword "which smoked with bloody execution." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene II” treats Macbeth's reputation as a warrior with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan (speech 18)): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant (speech 3)): Graphic violence praised as service. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Who reports Macbeth's deeds in battle at the start of the scene?

   A. A wounded Captain

B. Macduff

C. Banquo

D. A Witch

2. What does Macbeth do to the rebel Macdonwald?

A. Cuts him open and fixes his head on the battlements

B. Lets him escape

C. Pardons him

D. Takes him prisoner

3. Which noble has betrayed Scotland by helping Norway?

A. The Thane of Fife

B. Banquo

C. Lennox

D. The Thane of Cawdor

4. What does Duncan order for the Thane of Cawdor?

A. A trial in England

B. His banishment

C. His execution

D. A pardon

5. What reward does Duncan give Macbeth?

A. The title Thane of Cawdor

B. Command of the navy

C. The crown

D. Gold and land in England

6. In the line "That now Sweno, the Norways' king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme's inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use.", what does "disbursed" most nearly mean?

A. paid out (money)

B. loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge

C. to polish and make (weapons) ready again

D. large guns that fire heavy shot

7. In the line "Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm'd Compell'd these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish'd arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.", what does "furbish" most nearly mean?

A. paid out (money)

B. loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge

C. large guns that fire heavy shot

D. to polish and make (weapons) ready again

Answer key: 1. A (A wounded Captain); 2. A (Cuts him open and fixes his head on the battlements); 3. D (The Thane of Cawdor); 4. C (His execution); 5. A (The title Thane of Cawdor); 6. A (paid out (money)); 7. D (to polish and make (weapons) ready again)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act I, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene II suggests about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act I, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene II and its treatment of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “overcharged” most nearly mean?

   A. to declare or say aloud

   B. flags carried by an army

   C. a sailor

   D. loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge

2. *As whence the sun ’gins his reflection Shipwrecking storms and direful thunders break, So from that spring whence comfort seem’d to come Discomfort swells. Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm’d Compell’d these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish’d arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene II”?

   A. A marriage drifting apart

   B. The prophecies and their pull

   C. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

   D. The apparitions and false security

SAT key: 1. D (loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge); 2. C (Macbeth's reputation as a warrior)

Lesson 5: Act I, Scene III

Focus: the prophecies and their pull

Teacher only · spoilers

On the heath the Witches hail Macbeth as Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor and 'king hereafter', and tell Banquo he will 'get kings, though thou be none.' They vanish. Ross and Angus arrive to tell Macbeth he is now Thane of Cawdor. Macbeth, startled, imagines murder ('horrible imaginings') and decides 'chance may crown me'; Banquo warns that 'instruments of darkness tell us truths' to betray us.

Background: Prophecy was a dangerous subject: predicting a monarch's death could be treason. Banquo's line about 'instruments of darkness' reflects the period's belief that the devil tells half-truths to trap souls.

Significance: The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: shipman — a sailor; enkindle — to stir up or set on fire (a desire); treasons — acts of betraying one's king or country; soliciting — urging or tempting someone to act; selfsame — exactly the same.
Words: shipman: a sailor · enkindle: to stir up or set on fire (a desire) · treasons: acts of betraying one's king or country · soliciting: urging or tempting someone to act · selfsame: exactly the same

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Prophecy was a dangerous subject: predicting a monarch's death could be treason. Banquo's line about 'instruments of darkness' reflects the period's belief that the devil tells half-truths to trap souls. The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will. Characterization: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder. Dramatic irony: The audience knows Macbeth is Cawdor before he does; the prophecy's first part comes true at once. Diction / vocabulary: Macbeth's first line echoes the witches: "So foul and fair a day I have not seen." Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Good sir, why do you start; and seem to fear / Things that do sound so fair? I' the name of truth" (Act I, Scene III, Banquo (speech 19)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "So foul and fair a day I have not seen" (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 13)). Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. That is characterization at work: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder.

> *So foul and fair a day I have not seen* (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 13))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "So foul and fair a day I have not seen" (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 13)). Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. That is characterization at work: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Suggestion" means temptation; "horrid image" is his own vision. Expected link: fate and free will: the witches never mention murder. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: The prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. (Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought.)

> *why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair* (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 43))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Suggestion" means temptation; "horrid image" is his own vision. Expected link: fate and free will: the witches never mention murder.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: The prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. (Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the prophecies and their pull? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of the prophecies and their pull. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. When the text says "why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair" (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 43)), it shows this directly. Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the prophecies and their pull? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of the prophecies and their pull. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

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70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not? Have students compare Banquo's and Macbeth's responses line by line.

Anchor question: If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not?

Facilitation: Have students compare Banquo's and Macbeth's responses line by line.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the prophecies and their pull? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. ("why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair", Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 43)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the prophecies and their pull? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. ("why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair", Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 43)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the prophecies and their pull. Key takeaway: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder.
- **Dramatic irony:** The audience knows Macbeth is Cawdor before he does; the prophecy's first part comes true at once.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Macbeth's first line echoes the witches: "So foul and fair a day I have not seen."

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Good sir, why do you start; and seem to fear / Things that do sound so fair? I' the name of truth" (Act I, Scene III, Banquo (speech 19)).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "All hail, Macbeth! hail to thee, thane of Glamis" (Act I, Scene III, First Witch (speech 16)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "So foul and fair a day I have not seen" (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 13)) Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them.
- "oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths" (Act I, Scene III, Banquo (speech 42)) Banquo's warning.
- "why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair" (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 43)) Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea.
Evidence: "why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair" (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 43))
Reasoning: Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
shipman (noun)	a sailor	*I myself have all the other, And the very ports they blow, All the quarters that they know I' the shipman's card.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enkindle (verb)	to stir up or set on fire (a desire)	*That trusted home Might yet enkindle you unto the crown, Besides the thane of Cawdor.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
treasons (noun)	acts of betraying one's king or country	*Whether he was combined With those of Norway, or did line the rebel With hidden help and vantage, or that with both He labour'd in his country's wreck, I know not; But treasons capital, confess'd and proved, Have overthrown him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
soliciting (noun)	urging or tempting someone to act	*This supernatural soliciting Cannot be ill, cannot be good: if ill, Why hath it given me earnest of success, Commencing in a truth?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
selfsame (adjective)	exactly the same	*To the selfsame tune and words.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chestnuts (noun)	the nuts of the chestnut tree	*A sailor's wife had chestnuts in her lap, And munch'd, and munch'd, and munch'd:—"Give me," quoth I: "Aroint thee, witch!" the rump-fed ronyon cries.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
smother (verb)	to stifle or suffocate		

		Present fears Are less than horrible imaginings: My thought, whose murder yet is but fantastical, Shakes so my single state of man that function Is smother'd in surmise, and nothing is But what is not.	Student look-up (not yet verified)
prediction (noun)	a statement of what will happen in the future	*My noble partner You greet with present grace and great prediction Of noble having and of royal hope, That he seems rapt withal: to me you speak not.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
corporal (adjective)	bodily; of the body	*Into the air; and what seem'd corporal melted As breath into the wind.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
interpret (verb)	to explain the meaning of	*You seem to understand me, By each at once her choppy finger laying Upon her skinny lips: you should be women, And yet your beards forbid me to interpret That you are so.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Macbeth say makes his 'seated heart knock at my ribs'? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The 'horrid image' (suggestion) of murdering the king.
2. What three titles do the Witches give Macbeth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor, and king hereafter
3. What do the Witches predict for Banquo? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He will father kings but not be one
4. Who brings news that Macbeth is Thane of Cawdor? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Ross and Angus
5. How does Banquo warn Macbeth about the Witches? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Evil powers tell small truths to betray us in greater things
6. What does Macbeth say chance may do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Crown him without his doing anything
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: On the heath the Witches hail Macbeth as Thane of Glamis,

Thane of Cawdor and 'king hereafter', and tell Banquo he will 'get kings, though thou be none.' They vanish. Ross and Angus arrive to tell Macbeth he is now Thane of Cawdor. Macbeth, startled, imagines murder ('horrible imaginings') and decides 'chance may crown me'; Banquo warns that 'instruments of darkness tell us truths' to betray us.

8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act I, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I myself have all the other, And the very ports they blow, All the quarters that they know I’ the shipman’s card.” What does “shipman” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: shipman: a sailor.

Inferential / analytical

1. Macbeth's first line is 'So foul and fair a day I have not seen.' What does the echo of the Witches suggest? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: He is already linked to their inverted world before meeting them.
2. Why does Macbeth react with fear while Banquo reacts with curiosity? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Macbeth's fear suggests the thought of murder was already present.
3. What does “Act I, Scene III” suggest about the prophecies and their pull? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will.
4. Find one example of foreshadowing in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
5. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the prophecies and their pull? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 13)): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. On characterization: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins “A sailor’s wife had chestnuts in her lap, And munch’d, and munch’d, and munch’d:—“Give me,””, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: On the heath the Witches hail Macbeth as Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor and 'king hereafter', and tell Banquo he will 'get kings, though thou be none.' They vanish. Ross and Angus arrive to tell Macbeth he is now Thane of Cawdor. Macbeth, startled, imagines murder ('horrible imaginings') and…

8. How does “Act I, Scene III” build on “Act I, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo (speech 42)): Banquo's warning. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 43)): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. On characterization: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Do the Witches cause Macbeth's crimes, or only reveal what he already wants? Take a position using this scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position on fate versus free will.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 13)): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo (speech 42)): Banquo's warning. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own

imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 43)): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. On characterization: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the prophecies and their pull. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 13)): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo (speech 42)): Banquo's warning. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 43)): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the foreshadowing in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 13)): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene III” treats the prophecies and their pull with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of

darkness tell us truths" (Act I, Scene III, Banquo (speech 42)): Banquo's warning. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act I, Scene IV" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: "why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair" (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 43)): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the prophecies and their pull? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: "So foul and fair a day I have not seen" (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 13)): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. What three titles do the Witches give Macbeth?
   A. Lord of the Isles, Thane of Cawdor, and prince
   B. Thane of Fife, prince, and king
   C. General, Thane of Ross, and king
   D. Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor, and king hereafter
2. What do the Witches predict for Banquo?
   A. He will father kings but not be one
   B. He will become Thane of Cawdor
   C. He will die in battle tomorrow
   D. He will be king soon
3. Who brings news that Macbeth is Thane of Cawdor?
   A. Lady Macbeth
   B. Duncan himself

C. Banquo

D. Ross and Angus

4. How does Banquo warn Macbeth about the Witches?

A. The Witches always lie

B. They should tell the king at once

C. Evil powers tell small truths to betray us in greater things

D. Prophecies cannot come true

5. What does Macbeth say chance may do?

A. Crown him without his doing anything

B. Make Banquo king

C. Reveal his secret

D. Kill Duncan for him

6. In the line "I myself have all the other, And the very ports they blow, All the quarters that they know I' the shipman's card.", what does "shipman" most nearly mean?

A. urging or tempting someone to act

B. a sailor

C. acts of betraying one's king or country

D. to stir up or set on fire (a desire)

7. In the line "That trusted home Might yet enkindle you unto the crown, Besides the thane of Cawdor.", what does "enkindle" most nearly mean?

A. to stir up or set on fire (a desire)

B. a sailor

C. acts of betraying one's king or country

D. urging or tempting someone to act

Answer key: 1. D (Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor, and king hereafter); 2. A (He will father kings but not be one); 3. D (Ross and Angus); 4. C (Evil powers tell small truths to betray us in greater things); 5. A (Crown him without his doing anything); 6. B (a sailor); 7. A (to stir up or set on fire (a desire))

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act I, Scene III," how does Shakespeare show the prophecies and their pull? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the prophecies and their pull? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of the prophecies and their pull. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the prophecies and their pull. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene III suggests about the prophecies and their pull. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses foreshadowing in Act I, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the prophecies and their pull. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the prophecies and their pull responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the prophecies and their pull follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene III and its treatment of the prophecies and their pull. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about the prophecies and their pull in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the prophecies and their pull. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Whether he was combined With those of Norway, or did line the rebel With hidden help and vantage, or that with both He labour'd in his country's wreck, I know not; But treasons capital, confess'd and proved, Have overthrown him.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "treasons" most nearly mean?

   A. a statement of what will happen in the future

   B. to explain the meaning of

   C. acts of betraying one's king or country

   D. bodily; of the body

2. *A sailor's wife had chestnuts in her lap, And munch'd, and munch'd, and munch'd:—"Give me," quoth I: "Aroint thee, witch!" the rump-fed ronyon cries. Her husband's to Aleppo gone, master o' the Tiger: But in a sieve I'll thither sail, And, like a rat without a tail, I'll do, I'll do, and I'll do.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene III"?

   A. The prophecies and their pull

   B. Insecurity on the throne

   C. Life as a tale told by an idiot

   D. The dagger of the mind

SAT key: 1. C (acts of betraying one's king or country); 2. A (The prophecies and their pull)

Lesson 6: Act I, Scene IV

Focus: the hidden mind behind a loyal face

Teacher only · spoilers

Malcolm reports that Cawdor died nobly, confessing his treason. Duncan reflects 'There's no art to find the mind's construction in the face' just as Macbeth enters. He thanks Macbeth and Banquo, then names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland, his heir. Macbeth, aside, sees Malcolm as a step he must 'o'erleap' and asks the stars to hide his 'black and deep desires.' Duncan will visit Macbeth's castle at Inverness.

Background: Scottish kingship was not strictly hereditary at this time; naming Malcolm Prince of Cumberland made him heir and closed Macbeth's lawful path to the throne.

Significance: Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....*
> **Prompt:** Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example.
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: harbinger — a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming; peerless — without equal; recompense — reward or repayment; ingratitude — failure to show thanks; overtake — to catch up with.*
> **Words:** harbinger: a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming · peerless: without equal · recompense: reward or repayment · ingratitude: failure to show thanks · overtake: to catch up with

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Scottish kingship was not strictly hereditary at this time; naming Malcolm Prince of Cumberland made him heir and closed Macbeth's lawful path to the throne. Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime. Dramatic irony: Duncan says of Cawdor, "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face," just as Macbeth enters. Characterization: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Imagery: "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires." Watch for darkness and light: Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder. In this scene: "Not unaccompanied invest him only, / But signs of nobleness, like stars, shall shine / On all deservers. From hence to Inverness, / And bind" (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan (speech 7)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan (speech 3)). Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. That is dramatic irony at work: Duncan says of Cawdor, "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face," just as Macbeth enters.

> *There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face* (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan (speech 3))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan (speech 3)). Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. That is dramatic irony at work: Duncan says of Cawdor, "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face," just as Macbeth enters.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Look at the craft: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality? Expected: The loyal face hides the disloyal mind. (Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery.)

> *Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires* (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Look at the craft: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap."
Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality?
Expected answer: The loyal face hides the disloyal mind. (Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. When the text says "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires" (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)), it shows this directly. Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires."

Task: Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

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70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example. Ask: is Duncan naive, or is trust a virtue the play wants us to value?

Anchor question: Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example.

Facilitation: Ask: is Duncan naive, or is trust a virtue the play wants us to value?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. ("Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires", Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. ("Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires", Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Key takeaway: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Duncan says of Cawdor, "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face," just as Macbeth enters.
- **Characterization:** Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap."
- **Imagery:** "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires."

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** the loyal face hides the disloyal mind.

Symbols and motifs

- **darkness and light:** Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder. In this scene: “Not unaccompanied invest him only, / But signs of nobleness, like stars, shall shine / On all deservers. From hence to Inverness, / And bind” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan (speech 7)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan (speech 3)) Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters.
- “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)) Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery.
- “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)) Malcolm as an obstacle.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face.
Evidence: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10))
Reasoning: Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	

	Definition (in this sentence)		Word history
harbinger (noun)	a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming	*The rest is labour, which is not used for you: I'll be myself the harbinger and make joyful The hearing of my wife with your approach; So humbly take my leave.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
peerless (adjective)	without equal	*Let's after him, Whose care is gone before to bid us welcome: It is a peerless kinsman.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
recompense (noun)	reward or repayment	*The sin of my ingratitude even now Was heavy on me: thou art so far before That swiftest wing of recompense is slow To overtake thee.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ingratitude (noun)	failure to show thanks	*The sin of my ingratitude even now Was heavy on me: thou art so far before That swiftest wing of recompense is slow To overtake thee.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
overtake (verb)	to catch up with	*The sin of my ingratitude even now Was heavy on me: thou art so far before That swiftest wing of recompense is slow To overtake thee.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
kinsman (noun)	a male relative	*Let's after him, Whose care is gone before to bid us welcome: It is a peerless kinsman.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
highness (noun)	a title of respect used to address a king	*Your highness' part Is to receive our duties; and our duties Are to your throne and state children and servants, Which do but what they should, by doing every thing Safe toward your love and honour.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chastise (verb)	to drive off by scolding; to punish with words	*Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that impedes thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown'd withal.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example.
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Complete Duncan's line about the old Cawdor: 'He was a gentleman on whom I built…' [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: '…an absolute trust.'
2. How did the old Thane of Cawdor die, according to Malcolm? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Nobly, confessing his treasons
3. What title does Duncan give Malcolm? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Prince of Cumberland
4. Why is Malcolm's new title a problem for Macbeth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It makes Malcolm the heir and blocks Macbeth's path
5. What does Macbeth ask the stars to do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Hide their fires so no one sees his dark desires
6. Where will Duncan go next? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To Macbeth's castle at Inverness
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Malcolm reports that Cawdor died nobly, confessing his treason. Duncan reflects 'There's no art to find the mind's construction in the face' just as Macbeth enters. He thanks Macbeth and Banquo, then names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland, his heir. Macbeth, aside, sees Malcolm as a step he must 'o'erleap' and asks the stars to hide his 'black and deep desires.' Duncan will visit Macbeth's castle at…
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "The rest is labour, which is not used for you: I'll be myself the harbinger and make joyful The hearing of my wife with your approach; So humbly take my leave." What does "harbinger" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: harbinger: a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is it ironic that Macbeth enters right after Duncan's line about reading faces? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Duncan is about to trust another hidden traitor.
2. What does "Act I, Scene IV" suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the imagery in this scene shape what we understand about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan (speech 3)): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. On imagery: "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “My liege, They are not yet come back.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Malcolm reports that Cawdor died nobly, confessing his treason. Duncan reflects 'There's no art to find the mind's construction in the face' just as Macbeth enters. He thanks Macbeth and Banquo, then names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland, his heir. Macbeth, aside, sees Malcolm as a step he must…
7. How does “Act I, Scene IV” build on “Act I, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)): Malcolm as an obstacle. On characterization: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan (speech 3)): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. On characterization: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Was naming an heir at this moment a wise political move by Duncan? Argue from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Evaluation of Duncan's timing and judgment.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)): Malcolm as an obstacle. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan (speech 3)): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. On characterization: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)): Malcolm as an obstacle. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A

judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan (speech 3)): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene IV” treats the hidden mind behind a loyal face with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)): Malcolm as an obstacle. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan (speech 3)): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 10)): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. How did the old Thane of Cawdor die, according to Malcolm?
   A. Trying to escape
   B. Cursing the king
   C. In battle
   D. Nobly, confessing his treasons
2. What title does Duncan give Malcolm?
   A. Lord of the Isles
   B. Prince of Cumberland
   C. Thane of Cawdor
   D. King of Scotland
3. Why is Malcolm's new title a problem for Macbeth?
   A. It sends Macbeth to England
   B. It takes Macbeth's lands
   C. It makes Malcolm Macbeth's commander
   D. It makes Malcolm the heir and blocks Macbeth's path
4. What does Macbeth ask the stars to do?
   A. Show him the future
   B. Hide their fires so no one sees his dark desires
   C. Protect Duncan
   D. Guide him to Inverness
5. Where will Duncan go next?
   A. To Forres
   B. To Macbeth's castle at Inverness
   C. To Scone
   D. To England
6. In the line “The rest is labour, which is not used for you: I’ll be myself the harbinger and make joyful The hearing of my wife with your approach; So humbly take my leave.”, what does “harbinger” most nearly mean?
   A. failure to show thanks
   B. without equal
   C. a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming
   D. reward or repayment
7. In the line “Let’s after him, Whose care is gone before to bid us welcome: It is a peerless kinsman.”, what does “peerless” most nearly mean?
   A. reward or repayment
   B. a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming
   C. failure to show thanks
   D. without equal

Answer key: 1. D (Nobly, confessing his treasons); 2. B (Prince of Cumberland); 3. D (It makes Malcolm the heir and blocks Macbeth's path); 4. B (Hide their fires so no one sees his dark desires); 5. B (To Macbeth's castle at Inverness); 6. C (a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming); 7. D (without equal)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act I, Scene IV," how does Shakespeare show the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the hidden mind behind a loyal face? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene IV suggests about the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act I, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the hidden mind behind a loyal face responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the hidden mind behind a loyal face follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene IV and its treatment of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about the hidden mind behind a loyal face in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *The sin of my ingratitude even now Was heavy on me: thou art so far before That swiftest wing of recompense is slow To overtake thee.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “recompense” most nearly mean?

   A. reward or repayment

   B. to drive off by scolding; to punish with words

   C. a male relative

   D. a title of respect used to address a king

2. *My liege, They are not yet come back. But I have spoke With one that saw him die: who did report That very frankly he confess’d his treasons, Implored your highness’ pardon and set forth A deep repentance: nothing in his life Became him like the leaving it; he died As one that had been studied in his death To throw away the dearest thing he owed, As ’twere a careless trifle.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene IV”?

   A. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

   B. The ghost at the banquet

   C. The tyrant's weakening grip

   D. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

SAT key: 1. A (reward or repayment); 2. A (The hidden mind behind a loyal face)

Lesson 7: Act I, Scene V

Focus: Lady Macbeth's resolve

Teacher only · spoilers

Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter about the prophecies and fears his nature is 'too full o' the milk of human kindness.' Hearing that Duncan will stay the night, she calls on spirits to 'unsex me here' and fill her with cruelty, and asks thick night to hide her knife. Macbeth arrives; she tells him to 'look like the innocent flower, but be the serpent under't' and to leave the business to her.

Background: Early modern ideas of gender linked women with pity and nursing and men with violence; Lady Macbeth's invocation deliberately reverses those expectations. Calling on spirits echoed what the witchcraft laws punished.

Significance: Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because....*
> **Prompt:** Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: chastise — to drive off by scolding; to punish with words; murdering — that kill; deadly; beguile — to deceive; to fool; dispatch — prompt handling or management of a task; battlements — the notched wall along the top of a castle.*
> **Words:** chastise: to drive off by scolding; to punish with words · murdering: that kill; deadly · beguile: to deceive; to fool · dispatch: prompt handling or management of a task · battlements: the notched wall along the top of a castle

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Early modern ideas of gender linked women with pity and nursing and men with violence; Lady Macbeth's invocation deliberately reverses those expectations. Calling on spirits echoed what the witchcraft laws punished. Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan. Characterization: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here." Imagery: Milk vs. gall, light vs. "thick night": the imagery of nurturing turned to poison. Soliloquy: Her speeches reveal resolve and fear of her own pity. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "and shalt be / What thou art promised: yet do I fear thy nature; / It is too full o' the milk of human" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 1)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 1)). Her judgment of her husband. That is characterization at work: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here."

> *It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way* (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 1))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 1)). Her judgment of her husband. That is characterization at work: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here."

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Milk is nurturing; she wants to replace it with gall (bitterness). She advises: "look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under't": appearance and reality. Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected: She rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. (Appearance and reality.)

> *look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under't* (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 9))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Milk is nurturing; she wants to replace it with gall (bitterness). She advises: "look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under't": appearance and reality.
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected answer: She rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. (Appearance and reality.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. When the text says "Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)), it shows this directly. She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. When the text says "Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)), it shows this directly. She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want? Ask: does Lady Macbeth really lack pity? Look for cracks later (II.ii).

Anchor question: Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want?

Facilitation: Ask: does Lady Macbeth really lack pity? Look for cracks later (II.ii).

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. ("Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here", Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. ("Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here", Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Lady Macbeth's resolve. Key takeaway: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here."
- **Imagery:** Milk vs. gall, light vs. "thick night": the imagery of nurturing turned to poison.
- **Soliloquy:** Her speeches reveal resolve and fear of her own pity.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “and shalt be / What thou art promised: yet do I fear thy nature; / It is too full o’ the milk of human” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 1)).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “rapt in the wonder of it, came missives from the king, who all-hailed me ‘Thane of Cawdor;’ by which title, before, these” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 1)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 1)) Her judgment of her husband.
- “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)) Her invocation.
- “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 9)) Appearance and reality.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity.
Evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 5))
Reasoning: She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
chastise (verb)	to drive off by scolding; to punish with words	*Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that impedes thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown'd withal.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
murdering (adjective)	that kill; deadly	*Come to my woman's breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless substances You wait on nature's mischief!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
beguile (verb)	to deceive; to fool	*To beguile the time, Look like the time; bear welcome in your eye, Your hand, your tongue: look like the innocent flower, But be the serpent under't.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dispatch (noun)	prompt handling or management of a task	*He that's coming Must be provided for: and you shall put This night's great business into my dispatch; Which shall to all our nights and days to come Give solely sovereign sway and masterdom.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
battlements (noun)	the notched wall along the top of a castle	*The raven himself is hoarse That croaks the fatal entrance of Duncan Under my battlements.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
substances (noun)	bodies or forms	*Come to my woman's breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless substances You wait on nature's mischief!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
transported (verb)	carried away by strong feeling	*Thy letters have transported me beyond This ignorant present, and I feel now The future in the instant.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hereafter (adverb)	later; at some future time	*Greater than both, by the all-hail hereafter!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does Lady Macbeth learn about the prophecies? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: From Macbeth's letter, which she reads aloud.
2. What does Lady Macbeth fear about her husband's nature? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It is too full of the milk of human kindness
3. What does Lady Macbeth ask the spirits to do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Unsex her and fill her with cruelty
4. What news does the messenger bring? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The king comes here tonight
5. What advice does she give Macbeth about his face? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Look like the innocent flower but be the serpent under it
6. What does she ask the night to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Hide her knife so it cannot see the wound it makes
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act I, Scene V” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter about the prophecies and fears his nature is 'too full o' the milk of human kindness.' Hearing that Duncan will stay the night, she calls on spirits to 'unsex me here' and fill her with cruelty, and asks thick night to hide her knife. Macbeth arrives; she tells him to 'look like the innocent flower, but be the serpent under't' and to leave the business to her.
8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene V”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act I, Scene V” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that impedes thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown’d withal.” What does “chastise” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: chastise: to drive off by scolding; to punish with words.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Lady Macbeth connect kindness with milk, and cruelty with being 'unsexed'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: She links tenderness with womanhood and thinks murder requires abandoning it.
2. What does “Act I, Scene V” suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Lady Macbeth's resolve? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 1)): Her judgment of her husband. On characterization: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Give him tending; He brings great news.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter about the prophecies and fears his nature is 'too full o' the milk of human kindness.' Hearing that Duncan will stay the night, she calls on spirits to 'unsex me here' and fill her with cruelty, and asks thick night to hide her knife. Macbeth arrives; she tells…
7. How does “Act I, Scene V” build on “Act I, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)): Her invocation. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 9)): Appearance and reality. On characterization: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 1)): Her judgment of her husband. Theme link: she

rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Lady Macbeth more ambitious than Macbeth, or simply more decisive? Use both I.v and I.vii. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A comparative judgment with evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)): Her invocation. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 9)): Appearance and reality. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 1)): Her judgment of her husband. On characterization: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Lady Macbeth's resolve. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)): Her invocation. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 9)): Appearance and reality. Theme link: she rejects

femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 1)): Her judgment of her husband. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)): Her invocation. On imagery: Milk vs. gall, light vs. "thick night": the imagery of nurturing turned to poison. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene V” treats Lady Macbeth's resolve with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 9)): Appearance and reality. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene VI” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 1)): Her judgment of her husband. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Lady Macbeth's resolve? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)): Her invocation. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz

1. What does Lady Macbeth fear about her husband's nature?
   A. It is too cruel
   B. He does not want to be king
   C. It is too full of the milk of human kindness
   D. He is a coward in battle
2. What does Lady Macbeth ask the spirits to do?
   A. Make Macbeth king without murder
   B. Protect Duncan
   C. Unsex her and fill her with cruelty
   D. Show her the future
3. What news does the messenger bring?
   A. The king comes here tonight
   B. Banquo is dead
   C. Norway attacks again
   D. Malcolm is crowned
4. What advice does she give Macbeth about his face?
   A. Show his anger openly
   B. Avoid the king completely
   C. Look like the innocent flower but be the serpent under it
   D. Weep to show loyalty
5. What does she ask the night to do?
   A. Bring a storm
   B. Hide her knife so it cannot see the wound it makes
   C. Wake the king early
   D. Reveal the Witches
6. In the line “Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that impedes thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown’d withal.”, what does “chastise” most nearly mean?
   A. to deceive; to fool
   B. to drive off by scolding; to punish with words
   C. prompt handling or management of a task
   D. that kill; deadly

7. In the line “Come to my woman’s breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless substances You wait on nature’s mischief!”, what does “murdering” most nearly mean?
   A. prompt handling or management of a task
   B. to deceive; to fool
   C. to drive off by scolding; to punish with words
   D. that kill; deadly

Answer key: 1. C (It is too full of the milk of human kindness); 2. C (Unsex her and fill her with cruelty); 3. A (The king comes here tonight); 4. C (Look like the innocent flower but be the serpent under it); 5. B (Hide her knife so it cannot see the wound it makes); 6. B (to drive off by scolding; to punish with words); 7. D (that kill; deadly)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show Lady Macbeth's resolve? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Lady Macbeth's resolve? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene V suggests about Lady Macbeth's resolve. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act I, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Lady Macbeth's

resolve responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Lady Macbeth's resolve follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene V and its treatment of Lady Macbeth's resolve. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about Lady Macbeth's resolve in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *To beguile the time, Look like the time; bear welcome in your eye, Your hand, your tongue: look like the innocent flower, But be the serpent under't.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "beguile" most nearly mean?

   A. later; at some future time

   B. carried away by strong feeling

   C. bodies or forms

   D. to deceive; to fool

2. *Give him tending; He brings great news. Exit Messenger. The raven himself is hoarse That croaks the fatal entrance of Duncan Under my battlements. Come, you spirits That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here, And fill me from the crown to the toe top-full Of direst cruelty! make thick my blood; Stop up the access and passage to remorse, That no compunctious visitings of nature Shake my fell purpose, nor keep peace between The effect and it! Come to my woman's breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless substances You wait on nature's mischief! Come, thick night, And pall thee in the dunnest smoke of hell, That my keen knife see not the wound it makes, Nor heaven peep through the blanket of the dark, To cry "Hold, hold!"*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene V"?

   A. Lady Macbeth's resolve

   B. The murder and its first guilt

C. The decision to murder

D. A marriage drifting apart

SAT key: 1. D (to deceive; to fool); 2. A (Lady Macbeth's resolve)

Lesson 8: Act I, Scene VI

Focus: dramatic irony at the castle gate

Teacher only · spoilers

Duncan and Banquo arrive at Inverness and praise the castle's pleasant seat and sweet air, where the martlet nests. Lady Macbeth welcomes the king with elaborate courtesy, saying all she and her household have is his. Duncan asks to be taken to his host, whom he loves highly.

Background: Hospitality was a sacred duty: killing a guest under one's roof violated religious and social law, which makes the coming murder doubly monstrous to the audience.

Significance: The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....
Prompt: When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: a welcoming home that is a death-trap.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: purveyor — an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging; recommends — presents (itself) pleasantly; sometime — sometimes; at times; hostess — a woman who receives and entertains guests; highness — a title of respect used to address a king.
Words: purveyor: an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging · recommends: presents (itself) pleasantly · sometime: sometimes; at times · hostess: a woman who receives and entertains guests · highness: a title of respect used to address a king

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Hospitality was a sacred duty: killing a guest under one's roof violated religious and social law, which makes the coming murder doubly monstrous to the audience. The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows. Dramatic irony: Duncan praises the castle's "pleasant seat" and sweet air; the audience knows it is a trap. Imagery: The martlet nesting in the castle's walls: an image of peace and trust. Characterization: Lady Macbeth's elaborate courtesy hides her intent. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "Where's the thane of Cawdor? / We coursed him at the heels, and had a" (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan (speech 5)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself" (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan (speech 1)). Duncan's innocence. That is dramatic irony at work: Duncan praises the castle's "pleasant seat" and sweet air; the audience knows it is a trap.

> *This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan (speech 1))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself" (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan (speech 1)). Duncan's innocence. That is dramatic irony at work: Duncan praises the castle's "pleasant seat" and sweet air; the audience knows it is a trap.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The martlet nests in holy places; the image makes the castle seem sacred, heightening the crime. Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality? Expected: A welcoming home that is a death-trap. (Banquo's image of nature and holiness.)

> *The temple-haunting martlet (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo (speech 2))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The martlet nests in holy places; the image makes the castle seem sacred, heightening the crime.
Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality?
Expected answer: A welcoming home that is a death-trap. (Banquo's image of nature and holiness.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about dramatic irony at the castle gate? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene VI develops the idea of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. When the text says “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo (speech 2)), it shows this directly. He says "this castle hath a pleasant seat," and Banquo describes "the temple-haunting martlet" nesting there, images of peace in the place of murder.

Task: Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about dramatic irony at the castle gate? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene VI develops the idea of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. When the text says “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo (speech 2)), it shows this directly. He says "this castle hath a pleasant seat," and Banquo describes "the temple-haunting martlet" nesting there, images of peace in the place of murder.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them? Ask: how should Lady Macbeth play this scene? Warm, or too warm?

Anchor question: When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them?

Facilitation: Ask: how should Lady Macbeth play this scene? Warm, or too warm?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about dramatic irony at the castle gate? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. (“The temple-haunting martlet”, Act I, Scene VI, Banquo (speech 2)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about dramatic irony at the castle gate? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. (“The temple-haunting martlet”, Act I, Scene VI, Banquo (speech 2)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes dramatic irony at the castle gate. Key takeaway: a welcoming home that is a death-trap.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Duncan praises the castle's "pleasant seat" and sweet air; the audience knows it is a trap.
- **Imagery:** The martlet nesting in the castle's walls: an image of peace and trust.
- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth's elaborate courtesy hides her intent.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** a welcoming home that is a death-trap.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Where’s the thane of Cawdor? / We coursed him at the heels, and had a” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan (speech 5)).
- **equivocation:** "Fair is foul": appearances and words that mean two things, from the witches to the Porter to the prophecies. In this scene: “his spur, hath holp him / To his home before us. Fair and noble hostess, / We are your guest to-night” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan (speech 5)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan (speech 1)) Duncan's innocence.
- “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo (speech 2)) Banquo's image of nature and holiness.
- “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth (speech 4)) Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes.
Evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo (speech 2))
Reasoning: He says "this castle hath a pleasant seat," and Banquo describes "the temple-haunting martlet" nesting there, images of peace in the place of murder.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
purveyor (noun)	an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging	*We coursed him at the heels, and had a purpose To be his purveyor: but he rides well; And his great love, sharp as his spur, hath holp him To his home before us.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
recommends (verb)	presents (itself) pleasantly	*This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself Unto our gentle senses.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sometime (adverb)	sometimes; at times	*The love that follows us sometime is our trouble, Which still we thank as love.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hostess (noun)	a woman who receives and entertains guests	*Fair and noble hostess, We are your guest to-night.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
highness (noun)	a title of respect used to address a king	*Your servants ever Have theirs, themselves and what is theirs, in compt, To make their audit at your highness' pleasure, Still to return your own.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chalice (noun)	a ceremonial drinking cup	*But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
daggers (noun)	short knives used as weapons	*Will it not be received, When we have mark'd with blood those sleepy two Of his own chamber and used their very daggers, That they have done't?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ingredients (noun)	the parts that are mixed together to make something	*But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whom does Duncan ask to be taken to at the end of the scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His host, Macbeth: 'Conduct me to mine host: we love him highly.'
2. How does Duncan describe the castle? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It has a pleasant seat and sweet air
3. Which bird does Banquo say nests at the castle? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The martlet
4. Who welcomes Duncan at the gate? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lady Macbeth
5. What does Lady Macbeth say about her household? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Everything they have is the king's to command
6. Why is this scene full of dramatic irony? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The audience knows of the murder plan that the king does not
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene VI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Duncan and Banquo arrive at Inverness and praise the castle's pleasant seat and sweet air, where the martlet nests. Lady Macbeth welcomes the king with elaborate courtesy, saying all she and her household have is his. Duncan asks to be taken to his host, whom he loves highly.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene VI", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene VI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "We coursed him at the heels, and had a purpose To be his purveyor: but he rides well; And his great love, sharp as his spur, hath holp him To his home before us." What does "purveyor" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: purveyor: an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging.

Inferential / analytical

1. How does the martlet image contrast with the raven Lady Macbeth mentioned in Scene V? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Peaceful, trusting nature versus an omen of death; the same castle seen two ways.
2. What does "Act I, Scene VI" suggest about dramatic irony at the castle gate? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

4. How does the setting in this scene shape what we understand about dramatic irony at the castle gate? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan (speech 1)): Duncan's innocence. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “See, see, our honour’d hostess!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene VI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Duncan and Banquo arrive at Inverness and praise the castle's pleasant seat and sweet air, where the martlet nests. Lady Macbeth welcomes the king with elaborate courtesy, saying all she and her household have is his. Duncan asks to be taken to his host, whom he loves highly.
7. How does “Act I, Scene VI” build on “Act I, Scene V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo (speech 2)): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth (speech 4)): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's elaborate courtesy hides her intent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan (speech 1)): Duncan's innocence. On imagery: The martlet nesting in the castle's walls: an image of peace and trust. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should a director make Lady Macbeth's welcome sound sincere or forced? Defend your choice. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A staging decision justified by the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo (speech 2)): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth (speech 4)): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan (speech 1)): Duncan's innocence. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's elaborate courtesy hides her intent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene VI”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of dramatic irony at the castle gate. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo (speech 2)): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth (speech 4)): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan (speech 1)): Duncan's innocence. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo (speech 2)): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene VI” treats dramatic irony at the castle gate with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth (speech 4)): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene VII” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan (speech 1)): Duncan's innocence. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about dramatic irony at the castle gate? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo (speech 2)): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz

1. How does Duncan describe the castle?
   A. It is dark and cold
   B. It smells of smoke
   C. It is too small for his men
   D. It has a pleasant seat and sweet air
2. Which bird does Banquo say nests at the castle?
   A. The falcon
   B. The martlet
   C. The raven
   D. The owl
3. Who welcomes Duncan at the gate?
   A. Lady Macbeth
   B. Banquo
   C. The Porter
   D. Macbeth
4. What does Lady Macbeth say about her household?
   A. They are too poor to host him
   B. They will leave for Fife
   C. Everything they have is the king's to command
   D. They wish he had not come
5. Why is this scene full of dramatic irony?
   A. The king suspects the Macbeths
   B. Banquo warns the king
   C. The audience knows of the murder plan that the king does not
   D. Lady Macbeth confesses
6. In the line “We coursed him at the heels, and had a purpose To be his purveyor: but he rides well; And his great love, sharp as his spur, hath holp him To his home before us.”, what does “purveyor” most nearly mean?
   A. sometimes; at times
   B. an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging
   C. a woman who receives and entertains guests
   D. presents (itself) pleasantly
7. In the line “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself Unto our gentle senses.”, what does “recommends” most nearly mean?
   A. presents (itself) pleasantly
   B. a woman who receives and entertains guests
   C. sometimes; at times
   D. an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging

Answer key: 1. D (It has a pleasant seat and sweet air); 2. B (The martlet); 3. A (Lady Macbeth); 4. C (Everything they have is the king's to command); 5. C (The audience knows of the murder plan that the king does not); 6. B (an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging); 7. A (presents (itself) pleasantly)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act I, Scene VI," how does Shakespeare show dramatic irony at the castle gate? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene VI, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of dramatic irony at the castle gate? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene VI develops the idea of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene VI suggests about dramatic irony at the castle gate. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act I, Scene VI to complicate the reader's understanding of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of dramatic irony at the castle gate responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of dramatic irony at the castle gate follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene VI and its treatment of dramatic irony at the castle gate. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene VI as evidence for a larger claim about dramatic irony at the castle gate in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene VI as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *The love that follows us sometime is our trouble, Which still we thank as love.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “sometime” most nearly mean?

   A. sometimes; at times

   B. a ceremonial drinking cup

   C. short knives used as weapons

   D. the parts that are mixed together to make something

2. *See, see, our honour’d hostess! The love that follows us sometime is our trouble, Which still we thank as love. Herein I teach you How you shall bid God ’ild us for your pains, And thank us for your trouble.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene VI”?

   A. Life as a tale told by an idiot

   B. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

   C. The dagger of the mind

   D. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

SAT key: 1. A (sometimes; at times); 2. D (Dramatic irony at the castle gate)

Lesson 9: Act I, Scene VII

Focus: the decision to murder

Content note (violence against an infant (image)): Lady Macbeth says she would have dashed out her nursing baby's brains rather than break such an oath. It is a rhetorical image, not an event; discuss why she chooses it.
Student preview: Lady Macbeth uses a shocking image of harming a baby to make a point.
Suggested language: "Why does she choose the most shocking image she can?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Alone during the feast, Macbeth weighs the murder ('If it were done when 'tis done'): Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest and a virtuous ruler, and 'bloody instructions' return to plague the inventor; he has only 'vaulting ambition.' He tells Lady Macbeth they will proceed no further. She attacks his manhood, says she would have dashed out her nursing baby's brains had she sworn to, and lays out the plan to drug the chamberlains and blame them. Macbeth agrees: 'False face must hide what the false heart doth know.'

Background: The soliloquy draws on Christian ideas of judgment ('the life to come') and on the belief that a king's murder upset the whole order of nature and heaven.

Significance: This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because.... Content note before we start: Lady Macbeth uses a shocking image of harming a baby to make a point.
Prompt: Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: she defines manhood as the will to murder.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: chalice — a ceremonial drinking cup; daggers — short knives used as weapons; ingredients — the parts that are mixed together to make something; fitness — suitability; readiness; compose — to make up; to form.
Words: chalice: a ceremonial drinking cup · daggers: short knives used as weapons · ingredients: the parts that are mixed together to make something · fitness: suitability; readiness · compose: to make up; to form

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The soliloquy draws on Christian ideas of judgment ('the life to come') and on the belief that a king's murder upset the whole order of nature and heaven. This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible. Soliloquy: "If it were done when 'tis done": Macbeth reasons against the murder: Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest, and virtuous; the only spur is "vaulting ambition." Characterization: Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath. Imagery: Pity "like a naked new-born babe"; ambition as a rider vaulting over the saddle. Watch for blood: Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: "cases / We still have judgment here; that we but teach / Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return / To plague the inventor: this even-handed" (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8)). Lady Macbeth's attack. That is soliloquy at work: "If it were done when 'tis done": Macbeth reasons against the murder: Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest, and virtuous; the only spur is "vaulting ambition."

> *When you durst do it, then you were a man (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8)). Lady Macbeth's attack. That is soliloquy at work: "If it were done when 'tis done": Macbeth reasons against the murder: Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest, and virtuous; the only spur is "vaulting ambition."

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Vaulting ambition" pictures a rider jumping too far and falling; it predicts his fall. Masculinity and power. Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected: She defines manhood as the will to murder. (Macbeth admits his only motive.)

> *I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Vaulting ambition" pictures a rider jumping too far and falling; it predicts his fall. Masculinity and power.
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected answer: She defines manhood as the will to murder. (Macbeth admits his only motive.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the decision to murder? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene VII develops the idea of the decision to murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. When the text says "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8)), it shows this directly. In soliloquy he finds "no spur … but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.

Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the decision to murder? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene VII develops the idea of the decision to murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. When the text says "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8)), it shows this directly. In soliloquy he finds "no spur … but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you? Ask: who is more responsible for the murder, Macbeth or Lady Macbeth?

Anchor question: Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you?

Facilitation: Ask: who is more responsible for the murder, Macbeth or Lady Macbeth?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the decision to murder? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. ("When you durst do it, then you were a man", Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the decision to murder? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. ("When you durst do it, then you were a man", Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how soliloquy shapes the decision to murder. Key takeaway: she defines manhood as the will to murder.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** "If it were done when 'tis done": Macbeth reasons against the murder: Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest, and virtuous; the only spur is "vaulting ambition."
- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath.
- **Imagery:** Pity "like a naked new-born babe"; ambition as a rider vaulting over the saddle.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** she defines manhood as the will to murder.

Symbols and motifs

- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: “cases / We still have judgment here; that we but teach / Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return / To plague the inventor: this even-handed” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)).
- **sleep:** Sleep is innocence and restoration; Macbeth "does murder sleep" and Lady Macbeth walks in hers. In this scene: “Was the hope drunk / Wherein you dress’d yourself? hath it slept since? / And wakes it now, to look so green and pale” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 6)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)) Macbeth admits his only motive.
- “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8)) Lady Macbeth's attack.
- “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 10)) Her resolve.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood.
Evidence: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8))
Reasoning: In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
chalice (noun)	a ceremonial drinking cup	*But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
daggers (noun)	short knives used as weapons	*Will it not be received, When we have mark'd with blood those sleepy two Of his own chamber and used their very daggers, That they have done't?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ingredients (noun)	the parts that are mixed together to make something	*But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
fitness (noun)	suitability; readiness	*Nor time nor place Did then adhere, and yet you would make both: They have made themselves, and that their fitness now Does unmake you.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
compose (verb)	to make up; to form	*Bring forth men-children only; For thy undaunted mettle should compose Nothing but males.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ornament (noun)	the thing that gives honor or beauty; here, the crown	*Wouldst thou have that Which thou esteem'st the ornament of life, And live a coward in thine own esteem, Letting "I dare not" wait upon "I would,"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enterprise (noun)	a bold or risky undertaking	*What beast was't, then, That made you break this enterprise to me?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ambition (noun)	a strong desire for power or success	*I have no spur To prick the sides of my intent, but only Vaulting ambition, which o'erleaps itself And falls on the other.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
corporal (adjective)	bodily; of the body	*I am settled, and bend up Each corporal agent to this terrible feat.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
kinsman (noun)	a male relative	*He's here in double trust; First, as I am his kinsman and his subject, Strong both against the deed; then, as his host, Who should against his murderer shut the door, Not bear the knife myself.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Lady Macbeth tell Macbeth to 'screw' to the sticking-place? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His courage.
2. Which relationships does Macbeth say make the murder doubly wrong? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He is Duncan's kinsman, subject and host
3. What is the only spur Macbeth says he has? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Vaulting ambition
4. What does Macbeth first tell Lady Macbeth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: We will proceed no further in this business
5. How does Lady Macbeth attack Macbeth's resolve? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: She calls him a coward and questions his manhood
6. What is the plan for blaming the murder? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Drug the chamberlains and mark them with blood
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act I, Scene VII” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Alone during the feast, Macbeth weighs the murder ('If it were done when 'tis done'): Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest and a virtuous ruler, and 'bloody instructions' return to plague the inventor; he has only 'vaulting ambition.' He tells Lady Macbeth they will proceed no further. She attacks his manhood, says she would have dashed out her nursing baby's brains had she sworn to, and lays…
8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene VII”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act I, Scene VII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison’d chalice To our…” What does “chalice” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: chalice: a ceremonial drinking cup.

Inferential / analytical

1. Macbeth imagines Duncan's virtues pleading 'like angels, trumpet-tongued.' What does this image show about his conscience? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: He feels the murder as a cosmic, damnable act that heaven will expose.

2. Why does Lady Macbeth's argument about manhood work when Macbeth's moral reasons were stronger? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: She ties his identity and her love to the deed.
3. What does "Act I, Scene VII" suggest about the decision to murder? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible.
4. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
5. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about the decision to murder? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: "I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition" (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)): Macbeth admits his only motive. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins "Was the hope drunk Wherein you dress'd yourself?", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in "Act I, Scene VII", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Alone during the feast, Macbeth weighs the murder ('If it were done when 'tis done'): Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest and a virtuous ruler, and 'bloody instructions' return to plague the inventor; he has only 'vaulting ambition.' He tells Lady Macbeth they will proceed no further. She attacks…
8. How does "Act I, Scene VII" build on "Act I, Scene VI"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8)): Lady Macbeth's attack. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: "We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we'll not fail" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 10)): Her resolve. On characterization: Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: "Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and

which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Who bears more responsibility for Duncan's murder, Macbeth or Lady Macbeth? Use evidence from I.v and I.vii. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A reasoned judgment of shared responsibility.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)): Macbeth admits his only motive. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8)): Lady Macbeth's attack. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 10)): Her resolve. On characterization: Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene VII”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the decision to murder. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)): Macbeth admits his only motive. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene VII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8)): Lady Macbeth's attack. Theme link: she defines

manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 10)): Her resolve. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)): Macbeth admits his only motive. On imagery: Pity "like a naked new-born babe"; ambition as a rider vaulting over the saddle. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene VII” treats the decision to murder with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 8)): Lady Macbeth's attack. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth (speech 10)): Her resolve. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the decision to murder? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)): Macbeth admits his only motive. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Which relationships does Macbeth say make the murder doubly wrong?
   A. He is Malcolm's teacher
   B. He is Duncan's son, heir and doctor
   C. He is Banquo's friend and brother
   D. He is Duncan's kinsman, subject and host
2. What is the only spur Macbeth says he has?
   A. Love for his wife
   B. Revenge
   C. Fear of the Witches
   D. Vaulting ambition
3. What does Macbeth first tell Lady Macbeth?
   A. Banquo must die first
   B. He will kill Duncan at dawn
   C. We will proceed no further in this business
   D. The deed is done
4. How does Lady Macbeth attack Macbeth's resolve?
   A. She offers to tell the king
   B. She threatens to leave him
   C. She calls him a coward and questions his manhood
   D. She calls on the Witches
5. What is the plan for blaming the murder?
   A. Drug the chamberlains and mark them with blood
   B. Blame the Norwegians
   C. Blame Banquo
   D. Blame Malcolm
6. In the line “But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison’d chalice To our own lips.”, what does “chalice” most nearly mean?
   A. short knives used as weapons
   B. suitability; readiness
   C. a ceremonial drinking cup
   D. the parts that are mixed together to make something

7. In the line “Will it not be received, When we have mark’d with blood those sleepy two Of his own chamber and used their very daggers, That they have done’t?”, what does “daggers” most nearly mean?
   A. short knives used as weapons
   B. a ceremonial drinking cup
   C. the parts that are mixed together to make something
   D. suitability; readiness

Answer key: 1. D (He is Duncan's kinsman, subject and host); 2. D (Vaulting ambition); 3. C (We will proceed no further in this business); 4. C (She calls him a coward and questions his manhood); 5. A (Drug the chamberlains and mark them with blood); 6. C (a ceremonial drinking cup); 7. A (short knives used as weapons)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene VII,” how does Shakespeare show the decision to murder? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene VII, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the decision to murder? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene VII develops the idea of the decision to murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene VII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the decision to murder. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene VII suggests about the decision to murder. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act I, Scene VII to complicate the reader's understanding of the decision to murder. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene VII within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the decision to murder responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene VII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the decision to murder follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene VII and its treatment of the decision to murder. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene VII as evidence for a larger claim about the decision to murder in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene VII as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the decision to murder. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "ingredients" most nearly mean?

   A. a male relative

   B. a strong desire for power or success

   C. bodily; of the body

   D. the parts that are mixed together to make something

2. *Was the hope drunk Wherein you dress'd yourself? hath it slept since? And wakes it now, to look so green and pale At what it did so freely? From this time Such I account thy love. Art thou afeard To be the same in thine own act and valour As thou art in desire? Wouldst thou have that Which thou esteem'st the ornament of life, And live a coward in thine own esteem, Letting "I dare not" wait upon "I would," Like the poor cat i' the adage?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene VII"?

   A. The decision to murder

   B. The cast and world of the play

   C. The discovery of the murder

   D. The tyrant's weakening grip

SAT key: 1. D (the parts that are mixed together to make something); 2. A (The decision to murder)

Lesson 10: Act II, Scene I

Focus: the dagger of the mind

Teacher only · spoilers

After midnight Banquo, unable to sleep, tells Fleance of 'cursed thoughts' and gives Macbeth a diamond from the king for Lady Macbeth. Banquo mentions dreaming of the Witches; Macbeth claims he does not think of them and hints at future honor if Banquo will 'cleave to my consent'; Banquo agrees only if he keeps his allegiance clear. Alone, Macbeth sees a dagger in the air leading him to Duncan, wonders if it is 'a dagger of the mind', and goes when the bell rings: 'Hear it not, Duncan; for it is a knell.'

Background: Plays at the Globe were performed in daylight, so night had to be created by words: references to darkness, torches and the bell signal the hour.

Significance: The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, a pattern the play repeats with Banquo's ghost.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....
Prompt: Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: dudgeon — the handle of a dagger; allegiance — loyalty owed to a ruler; husbandry — thrift; careful saving; palpable — able to be touched or felt; augment — to increase.
Words: dudgeon: the handle of a dagger · allegiance: loyalty owed to a ruler · husbandry: thrift; careful saving · palpable: able to be touched or felt · augment: to increase

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Plays at the Globe were performed in daylight, so night had to be created by words: references to darkness, torches and the bell signal the hour. The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, a pattern the play repeats with Banquo's ghost. Soliloquy: The dagger speech: Macbeth sees a dagger "of the mind," then real blood on it; he cannot tell imagination from reality. Dialogue: Banquo admits dreaming of the weird sisters; Macbeth lies ("I think not of them") and hints at reward for support. Imagery: Night, witchcraft, Tarquin's "ravishing strides": the world of the murder. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "earth, / Hear not my steps, which way they walk, for fear / Thy very stones prate of my whereabout, / And take the present" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)). The hallucination. That is soliloquy at work: The dagger speech: Macbeth sees a dagger "of the mind," then real blood on it; he cannot tell imagination from reality.

> *Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand* (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)). The hallucination. That is soliloquy at work: The dagger speech: Macbeth sees a dagger "of the mind," then real blood on it; he cannot tell imagination from reality.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Heat-oppressed brain" means a feverish mind: the vision is guilt. Expected link: guilt and conscience. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected: Guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. (He knows it is imaginary.)

> *A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain* (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Heat-oppressed brain" means a feverish mind: the vision is guilt. Expected link: guilt and conscience.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected answer: Guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. (He knows it is imaginary.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for soliloquy, dialogue (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the dagger of the mind? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of the dagger of the mind. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. When the text says “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)), it shows this directly. He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done."

Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, dialogue (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the dagger of the mind? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of the dagger of the mind. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. When the text says “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)), it shows this directly. He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there? Ask: should a production show the dagger? Argue from the text.

Anchor question: Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there?

Facilitation: Ask: should a production show the dagger? Argue from the text.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the dagger of the mind? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. (“A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain”, Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the dagger of the mind? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. (“A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain”, Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how soliloquy shapes the dagger of the mind. Key takeaway: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** The dagger speech: Macbeth sees a dagger "of the mind," then real blood on it; he cannot tell imagination from reality.
- **Dialogue:** Banquo admits dreaming of the weird sisters; Macbeth lies ("I think not of them") and hints at reward for support.
- **Imagery:** Night, witchcraft, Tarquin's "ravishing strides": the world of the murder.

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “earth, / Hear not my steps, which way they walk, for fear / Thy very stones prate of my whereabout, / And take the present” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “What, sir, not yet at rest? The king’s a-bed: / He hath been in unusual pleasure, and / Sent forth great” (Act II, Scene I, Banquo (speech 7)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)) The hallucination.
- "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)) He knows it is imaginary.
- "I go, and it is done; the bell invites me" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)) Decision.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills.
Evidence: "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16))
Reasoning: He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
dudgeon (noun)	the handle of a dagger	*Mine eyes are made the fools o' the other senses, Or else worth all the rest; I see thee still, And on thy blade and dudgeon gouts of blood, Which was not so before.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
allegiance (noun)	loyalty owed to a ruler	*So I lose none In seeking to augment it, but still keep My bosom franchised and allegiance clear, I shall be counsell'd.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
husbandry (noun)	thrift; careful saving	*There's husbandry in heaven; Their candles are all out.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
palpable (adjective)	able to be touched or felt	*I see thee yet, in form as palpable As this which now I draw.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
augment (verb)	to increase	*So I lose none In seeking to augment it, but still keep My bosom franchised and allegiance clear, I shall be counsell'd.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hostess (noun)	a woman who receives and entertains guests	*This diamond he greets your wife withal, By the name of most kind hostess; and shut up In measureless content.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
surfeited (adjective)	overfed; here, drunk	*He is about it: The doors are open; and the surfeited grooms Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg'd their possets, That death and nature do contend about them, Whether they live or die.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

hangman (noun)	an executioner who hangs the condemned person	*One cried "God bless us!" and "Amen" the other; As they had seen me with these hangman's hands.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Macbeth say the bell is to Duncan? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A knell that summons him to heaven or to hell.
2. Why can Banquo not sleep? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He is troubled by cursed thoughts
3. What gift does Banquo pass on from Duncan to Lady Macbeth? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A diamond
4. What does Macbeth see before him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A dagger leading him toward Duncan's chamber
5. Under what condition will Banquo support Macbeth? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: If he loses no honor and keeps his allegiance clear
6. What signal tells Macbeth to act? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A bell
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: After midnight Banquo, unable to sleep, tells Fleance of 'cursed thoughts' and gives Macbeth a diamond from the king for Lady Macbeth. Banquo mentions dreaming of the Witches; Macbeth claims he does not think of them and hints at future honor if Banquo will 'cleave to my consent'; Banquo agrees only if he keeps his allegiance clear. Alone, Macbeth sees a dagger in the air leading him to Duncan,…
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Mine eyes are made the fools o' the other senses, Or else worth all the rest; I see thee still, And on thy blade and dudgeon gouts of blood, Which was not so before." What does "dudgeon" mean here, and

what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: dudgeon: the handle of a dagger.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macbeth ask 'Is this a dagger which I see before me'? What does his uncertainty reveal? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: His mind is overheated by guilt; he cannot tell imagination from reality.
2. What does “Act II, Scene I” suggest about the dagger of the mind? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, a pattern the play repeats with Banquo's ghost.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the dagger of the mind? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Hold, take my sword.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: After midnight Banquo, unable to sleep, tells Fleance of 'cursed thoughts' and gives Macbeth a diamond from the king for Lady Macbeth. Banquo mentions dreaming of the Witches; Macbeth claims he does not think of them and hints at future honor if Banquo will 'cleave to my consent'; Banquo agrees…
7. How does “Act II, Scene I” build on “Act I, Scene VII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): He knows it is imaginary. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Decision. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the

act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with appearance versus reality? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should the dagger be shown on stage, or left invisible? Which choice better serves the play? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A staging argument tied to the open question of the supernatural.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): He knows it is imaginary. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, a pattern the play repeats with Banquo's ghost." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: "I go, and it is done; the bell invites me" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Decision. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing "Act II, Scene I". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the dagger of the mind. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): He knows it is imaginary. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Decision. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): He knows it is imaginary. On imagery: Night, witchcraft, Tarquin's "ravishing strides": the world of the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene I” treats the dagger of the mind with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Decision. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The

handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the dagger of the mind? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2]
    Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): He knows it is imaginary. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz

1. Why can Banquo not sleep?
   A. He is troubled by cursed thoughts
   B. He is guarding the gate
   C. He is sick
   D. He hears the Witches singing
2. What gift does Banquo pass on from Duncan to Lady Macbeth?
   A. A crown
   B. A letter
   C. A diamond
   D. A sword
3. What does Macbeth see before him?
   A. The Witches
   B. Banquo's ghost
   C. A dagger leading him toward Duncan's chamber
   D. A crown in the air
4. Under what condition will Banquo support Macbeth?
   A. If Fleance becomes king now
   B. If he is made Thane of Cawdor
   C. If he loses no honor and keeps his allegiance clear
   D. If Malcolm agrees

5. What signal tells Macbeth to act?
   A. A bell
   B. A trumpet
   C. An owl's scream
   D. A knock at the gate
6. In the line “Mine eyes are made the fools o’ the other senses, Or else worth all the rest; I see thee still, And on thy blade and dudgeon gouts of blood, Which was not so before.”, what does “dudgeon” most nearly mean?
   A. the handle of a dagger
   B. able to be touched or felt
   C. thrift; careful saving
   D. loyalty owed to a ruler
7. In the line “So I lose none In seeking to augment it, but still keep My bosom franchised and allegiance clear, I shall be counsell’d.”, what does “allegiance” most nearly mean?
   A. thrift; careful saving
   B. the handle of a dagger
   C. able to be touched or felt
   D. loyalty owed to a ruler

Answer key: 1. A (He is troubled by cursed thoughts); 2. C (A diamond); 3. C (A dagger leading him toward Duncan's chamber); 4. C (If he loses no honor and keeps his allegiance clear); 5. A (A bell); 6. A (the handle of a dagger); 7. D (loyalty owed to a ruler)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the dagger of the mind? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the dagger of the mind? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of the dagger of the mind. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the dagger of the mind. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene I suggests about the dagger of the mind. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act II, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the dagger of the mind. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act II, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the dagger of the mind responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act II, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the dagger of the mind follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene I and its treatment of the dagger of the mind. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the dagger of the mind in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the dagger of the mind. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *There's husbandry in heaven; Their candles are all out.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "husbandry" most nearly mean?

   A. overfed; here, drunk

   B. an executioner who hangs the condemned person

   C. thrift; careful saving

   D. a woman who receives and entertains guests

2. *Hold, take my sword. There's husbandry in heaven; Their candles are all out. Take thee that too. A heavy summons lies like lead upon me, And yet I would not sleep: merciful powers, Restrain in me the cursed thoughts that nature Gives way to in repose!*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene I"?

A. Life as a tale told by an idiot
B. The dagger of the mind
C. The tyrant's weakening grip
D. The murder and its first guilt

SAT key: 1. C (thrift; careful saving); 2. B (The dagger of the mind)

Lesson 11: Act II, Scene II

Focus: the murder and its first guilt

Content note (murder): Duncan's murder happens offstage; the scene shows blood and guilt. Allow students to discuss the aftermath without dwelling on the act.
Student preview: A murder has just happened offstage.
Suggested language: "What does each character notice first, and why?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Lady Macbeth waits, saying she would have killed Duncan herself had he not resembled her father as he slept. Macbeth returns from the murder with bloody hands, haunted that he could not say 'Amen' and that a voice cried 'Macbeth does murder sleep.' He has carried the daggers away; he refuses to return, so she takes them back and smears the grooms with blood. Knocking sounds at the gate; Macbeth says all great Neptune's ocean could not wash the blood from his hand, and wishes the knocking could wake Duncan.

Background: The murder happens offstage; Shakespeare shows its aftermath rather than the act. Blood, sleep and hands become the play's key image clusters.

Significance: The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line sets up the sleepwalking scene, where water no longer clears anything.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because.... Content note before we start: A murder has just happened offstage.
Prompt: Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: surfeited — overfed; here, drunk; hangman — an executioner who hangs the condemned person; nightgown — a dressing gown worn over night clothes; resembled — looked like; daggers — short knives used as weapons.
Words: surfeited: overfed; here, drunk · hangman: an executioner who hangs the condemned person · nightgown: a dressing gown worn over night clothes · resembled: looked like · daggers: short knives used as weapons

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The murder happens offstage; Shakespeare shows its aftermath rather than the act. Blood, sleep and hands become the play's key image clusters. The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line sets up the sleepwalking scene, where water no longer clears anything. Dialogue: Short, broken lines between Macbeth and Lady Macbeth after the murder show panic. Imagery: Blood on hands; "Macbeth does murder sleep"; "all great Neptune's ocean." Characterization: Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "they had seen me with these hangman's hands. / Listening their fear, I could not say "Amen," / When they did say "God bless" (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 16)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Methought I heard a voice cry "Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep" (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 20)). Sleep as innocence destroyed. That is dialogue at work: Short, broken lines between Macbeth and Lady Macbeth after the murder show panic.

> *Methought I heard a voice cry "Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep* (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 20))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Methought I heard a voice cry "Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep" (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 20)). Sleep as innocence destroyed. That is dialogue at work: Short, broken lines between Macbeth and Lady Macbeth after the murder show panic.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hyperbole: an entire ocean cannot clean the blood. Lady Macbeth's "little water" is dramatic irony: she will try to wash her hands in her sleep. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." (Hyperbole of guilt.)

> *Will all great Neptune's ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand* (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 26))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Hyperbole: an entire ocean cannot clean the blood. Lady Macbeth's "little water" is dramatic irony: she will try to wash her hands in her sleep.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected answer: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." (Hyperbole of guilt.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dialogue, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the murder and its first guilt? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the murder and its first guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. When the text says “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 27)), it shows this directly. He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking.
Task: Annotate the scene for dialogue, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the murder and its first guilt? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the murder and its first guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. When the text says “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 27)), it shows this directly. He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong? Ask: why can't Macbeth say "Amen"? What does that show about him?
Anchor question: Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong?
Facilitation: Ask: why can't Macbeth say "Amen"? What does that show about him?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the murder and its first guilt? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. (“A little water clears us of this deed”, Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 27)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the murder and its first guilt? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. (“A little water clears us of this deed”, Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 27)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how dialogue shapes the murder and its first guilt. Key takeaway: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more."*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dialogue:** Short, broken lines between Macbeth and Lady Macbeth after the murder show panic.
- **Imagery:** Blood on hands; "Macbeth does murder sleep"; "all great Neptune's ocean."
- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror.

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “they had seen me with these hangman’s hands. / Listening their fear, I could not say “Amen,” / When they did say “God bless” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 16)).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Who was it that thus cried? Why, worthy thane, / You do unbend your noble strength, to think / So brainsickly of” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 23)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 20)) Sleep as innocence destroyed.
- “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 26)) Hyperbole of guilt.
- “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 27)) Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse.
Evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 27))
Reasoning: He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
surfeited (adjective)	overfed; here, drunk	*He is about it: The doors are open; and the surfeited grooms Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg'd their possets, That death and nature do contend about them, Whether they live or die.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hangman (noun)	an executioner who hangs the condemned person	*One cried "God bless us!" and "Amen" the other; As they had seen me with these hangman's hands.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
nightgown (noun)	a dressing gown worn over night clothes	*Get on your nightgown, lest occasion call us, And show us to be watchers.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
resembled (verb)	looked like	*Had he not resembled My father as he slept, I had done't.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
daggers (noun)	short knives used as weapons	*I laid their daggers ready; He could not miss 'em.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pronounce (verb)	to declare or say aloud	*But wherefore could not I pronounce "Amen"?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
primrose (adjective)	pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure)	*I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
napkins (noun)	handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat)	*Here's a farmer, that hanged himself on the expectation of plenty: come in time; have napkins enow about you; here you'll sweat for't.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who carries the daggers back to Duncan's chamber? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lady Macbeth.
2. Why did Lady Macbeth not kill Duncan herself? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He looked like her father as he slept
3. What word could Macbeth not say? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Amen
4. What voice does Macbeth say he heard? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Sleep no more! Macbeth does murder sleep
5. What mistake does Macbeth make with the daggers? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He brings them away with him
6. What does Lady Macbeth say will clear them of the deed? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A little water
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act II, Scene II” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lady Macbeth waits, saying she would have killed Duncan herself had he not resembled her father as he slept. Macbeth returns from the murder with bloody hands, haunted that he could not say 'Amen' and that a voice cried 'Macbeth does murder sleep.' He has carried the daggers away; he refuses to return, so she takes them back and smears the grooms with blood. Knocking sounds at the gate; Macbeth…
8. Who is on stage in “Act II, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act II, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “He is about it: The doors are open; and the surfeited grooms Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg’d their possets, That death and nature do contend about them, Whether they live or die.” What does “surfeited” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: surfeited: overfed; here, drunk.

Inferential / analytical

1. Macbeth says his hand would rather turn the green sea red ('the multitudinous seas incarnadine'). How does this answer Lady Macbeth's 'A little water clears us'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: He knows the guilt is spiritual and limitless; she treats it as a stain.
2. What does “Act II, Scene II” suggest about the murder and its first guilt? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line sets up the sleepwalking scene, where water no longer clears anything.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the symbolism in this scene shape what we understand about the murder and its first guilt? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger

ideas.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 20)): Sleep as innocence destroyed. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “That which hath made them drunk hath made me bold; What hath quench’d them hath given me fire.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Lady Macbeth waits, saying she would have killed Duncan herself had he not resembled her father as he slept. Macbeth returns from the murder with bloody hands, haunted that he could not say 'Amen' and that a voice cried 'Macbeth does murder sleep.' He has carried the daggers away; he refuses to…
7. How does “Act II, Scene II” build on “Act II, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 26)): Hyperbole of guilt. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 27)): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 20)): Sleep as innocence destroyed. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed")

versus Macbeth's horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Why might Shakespeare keep the murder offstage? Evaluate the effect compared with showing it. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Judgment about offstage violence and the audience's imagination.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 26)): Hyperbole of guilt. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line sets up the sleepwalking scene, where water no longer clears anything.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 27)): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 20)): Sleep as innocence destroyed. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the murder and its first guilt. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 26)): Hyperbole of guilt. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 27)): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. Theme link:

Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 20)): Sleep as innocence destroyed. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 26)): Hyperbole of guilt. On imagery: Blood on hands; "Macbeth does murder sleep"; "all great Neptune's ocean." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene II” treats the murder and its first guilt with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 27)): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 20)): Sleep as innocence destroyed. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the murder and its first guilt? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 26)): Hyperbole of guilt.

Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Why did Lady Macbeth not kill Duncan herself?
   A. She heard a noise
   B. She was afraid of the guards
   C. Macbeth forbade it
   D. He looked like her father as he slept
2. What word could Macbeth not say?
   A. Murder
   B. Goodbye
   C. King
   D. Amen
3. What voice does Macbeth say he heard?
   A. All hail, Macbeth
   B. Banquo's children shall be kings
   C. Sleep no more! Macbeth does murder sleep
   D. Beware Macduff
4. What mistake does Macbeth make with the daggers?
   A. He throws them in the moat
   B. He brings them away with him
   C. He loses them
   D. He leaves them in Duncan's body
5. What does Lady Macbeth say will clear them of the deed?
   A. A prayer
   B. A little water
   C. The Witches' charm
   D. A confession
6. In the line “He is about it: The doors are open; and the surfeited grooms Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg’d their possets, That death and nature do contend about them, Whether they live or die.”, what does “surfeited” most nearly mean?
   A. looked like

B. overfed; here, drunk

C. an executioner who hangs the condemned person

D. a dressing gown worn over night clothes

7. In the line “One cried “God bless us!” and “Amen” the other; As they had seen me with these hangman’s hands.”, what does “hangman” most nearly mean?

A. overfed; here, drunk

B. looked like

C. a dressing gown worn over night clothes

D. an executioner who hangs the condemned person

Answer key: 1. D (He looked like her father as he slept); 2. D (Amen); 3. C (Sleep no more! Macbeth does murder sleep); 4. B (He brings them away with him); 5. B (A little water); 6. B (overfed; here, drunk); 7. D (an executioner who hangs the condemned person)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show the murder and its first guilt? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the murder and its first guilt? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the murder and its first guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the murder and its first guilt. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene II suggests about the murder and its first guilt. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act II, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the murder and its first guilt. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act II, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the murder and its first guilt responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act II, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the murder and its first guilt follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene II and its treatment of the murder and its first guilt. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the murder and its first guilt in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the murder and its first guilt. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Get on your nightgown, lest occasion call us, And show us to be watchers.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “nightgown” most nearly mean?

   A. to declare or say aloud

   B. a dressing gown worn over night clothes

   C. pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure)

   D. handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat)

2. *That which hath made them drunk hath made me bold; What hath quench’d them hath given me fire. Hark! Peace! It was the owl that shriek’d, the fatal bellman, Which gives the stern’st good-night. He is about it: The doors are open; and the surfeited grooms Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg’d their possets, That death and nature do contend about them, Whether they live or die.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene II”?

   A. The prophecies and their pull

   B. Lady Macbeth's resolve

   C. The dagger of the mind

   D. The murder and its first guilt

SAT key: 1. B (a dressing gown worn over night clothes); 2. D (The murder and its first guilt)

Lesson 12: Act II, Scene III

Focus: the discovery of the murder

Teacher only · spoilers

A drunken Porter imagines himself porter of hell gate, joking about a farmer, an 'equivocator' and a tailor, before opening to Macduff and Lennox. Lennox describes an unruly night of storms and screams. Macduff discovers Duncan's body ('Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!'). Macbeth reveals he has killed the chamberlains, claiming fury and love; Lady Macbeth faints. Banquo vows to fight 'treasonous malice.' Malcolm and Donalbain secretly flee to England and Ireland, fearing 'daggers in men's smiles.'

Background: The Porter's 'equivocator' is widely read as an allusion to the Jesuit Henry Garnet, executed in 1606 after the Gunpowder Plot, who defended misleading answers under oath.

Significance: Comic relief deepens the horror: the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....
Prompt: Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: primrose — pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure); napkins — handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat); bonfire — a large outdoor fire; masterpiece — a supreme piece of work; sacrilegious — violating something holy.
Words: primrose: pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure) · napkins: handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat) · bonfire: a large outdoor fire · masterpiece: a supreme piece of work · sacrilegious: violating something holy

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Porter's 'equivocator' is widely read as an allusion to the Jesuit Henry Garnet, executed in 1606 after the Gunpowder Plot, who defended misleading answers under oath. Comic relief deepens the horror: the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them. Characterization: The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary. Dramatic irony: Macbeth plays the shocked host; Lady Macbeth faints (real or feigned?). Plot: Macduff discovers the body; Macbeth kills the grooms; Malcolm and Donalbain flee. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "Is the king stirring, worthy thane" (Act II, Scene III, Macduff (speech 11)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale" (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)). Allusion to equivocation and the Gunpowder Plot trial. That is characterization at work: The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary.

> *an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale* (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale" (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)). Allusion to equivocation and the Gunpowder Plot trial. That is characterization at work: The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The Porter is joking, but the joke is accurate; equivocation (double-meaning) is how the witches and Macbeth speak. Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality? Expected: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. (The Porter's joke.)

> *Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate* (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The Porter is joking, but the joke is accurate; equivocation (double-meaning) is how the witches and Macbeth speak.
Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality?
Expected answer: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. (The Porter's joke.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the discovery of the murder? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of the discovery of the murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. When the text says "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)), it shows this directly. He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the discovery of the murder? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of the discovery of the murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

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70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event? Ask: why place comedy right after the murder? Try reading De Quincey's idea that the knocking returns us to the human world.

Anchor question: Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event?

Facilitation: Ask: why place comedy right after the murder? Try reading De Quincey's idea that the knocking returns us to the human world.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the discovery of the murder? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. ("Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate", Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the discovery of the murder? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. ("Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate", Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the discovery of the murder. Key takeaway: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary.
- **Dramatic irony:** Macbeth plays the shocked host; Lady Macbeth faints (real or feigned?).
- **Plot:** Macduff discovers the body; Macbeth kills the grooms; Malcolm and Donalbain flee.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Is the king stirring, worthy thane” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff (speech 11)).
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: “not know’t: / The spring, the head, the fountain of your blood / Is stopp’d; the very source of it is stopp’d” (Act II, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 35)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)) The Porter's joke.
- “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)) Allusion to equivocation and the Gunpowder Plot trial.
- “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff (speech 23)) Macduff's discovery.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell.
Evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1))
Reasoning: He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
primrose (adjective)	pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure)	*I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
napkins (noun)	handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat)	*Here's a farmer, that hanged himself on the expectation of plenty: come in time; have napkins enow about you; here you'll sweat for't.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bonfire (noun)	a large outdoor fire	*I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
masterpiece (noun)	a supreme piece of work	*Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sacrilegious (adjective)	violating something holy	*Most sacrilegious murder hath broke ope The Lord's anointed temple, and stole thence The life o' the building!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
prithee (interjection)	please (from "I pray thee")	*Dear Duff, I prithee, contradict thyself, And say it is not so.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
provoke (verb)	to bring on; to cause	*What three things does drink especially provoke?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
readiness (noun)	the state of being dressed and armed	*Let's briefly put on manly readiness, And meet i' the hall together.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
daggers (noun)	short knives used as weapons	*Those of his chamber, as it seem'd, had done't: Their hands and faces were all badged with blood; So were their daggers, which unwiped we found Upon their pillows: They stared, and were distracted; no man's life Was to be trusted with them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sometime (adverb)	sometimes; at times	*That it did, sir, i' the very throat on me: but I requited him for his lie; and, I think, being too strong for him, though he took up my legs sometime, yet I made a shift to cast him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Lennox report about the night? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Chimneys blown down, lamentings heard in the air, strange screams of death; an unruly night.
2. Whom does the Porter pretend to be? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The porter of hell gate
3. Who discovers Duncan's body? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Macduff
4. What has Macbeth done to the chamberlains? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Killed them, claiming fury
5. Where do Malcolm and Donalbain flee? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: England and Ireland
6. What does Donalbain say there are in men's smiles? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Daggers
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A drunken Porter imagines himself porter of hell gate, joking about a farmer, an 'equivocator' and a tailor, before opening to Macduff and Lennox. Lennox describes an unruly night of storms and screams. Macduff discovers Duncan's body ('Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!'). Macbeth reveals he has killed the chamberlains, claiming fury and love; Lady Macbeth faints. Banquo vows to fight…
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire." What does "primrose" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: primrose: pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure).

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Lady Macbeth faint at the moment Macbeth explains killing the grooms? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Real shock or a deliberate distraction; the text allows both.
2. What does "Act II, Scene III" suggest about the discovery of the murder? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Comic relief deepens the horror:

the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them.

3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about the discovery of the murder? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)): The Porter's joke. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Marry, sir, nose-painting, sleep, and urine.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A drunken Porter imagines himself porter of hell gate, joking about a farmer, an 'equivocator' and a tailor, before opening to Macduff and Lennox. Lennox describes an unruly night of storms and screams. Macduff discovers Duncan's body ('Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!'). Macbeth reveals he…
7. How does “Act II, Scene III” build on “Act II, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)): Allusion to equivocation and the Gunpowder Plot trial. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff (speech 23)): Macduff's discovery. On characterization: The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell.

Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)): The Porter's joke. On plot: Macduff discovers the body; Macbeth kills the grooms; Malcolm and Donalbain flee. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Do Malcolm and Donalbain act wisely or cowardly by fleeing? Defend your answer. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: An evaluation of the princes' choice and its consequences.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)): Allusion to equivocation and the Gunpowder Plot trial. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Comic relief deepens the horror: the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff (speech 23)): Macduff's discovery. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)): The Porter's joke. On characterization: The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the discovery of the murder. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)): Allusion to equivocation and the Gunpowder Plot trial. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff (speech 23)): Macduff's discovery. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a

performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)): The Porter's joke. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)): Allusion to equivocation and the Gunpowder Plot trial. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene III” treats the discovery of the murder with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff (speech 23)): Macduff's discovery. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)): The Porter's joke. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the discovery of the murder? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter (speech 1)): Allusion to equivocation and the Gunpowder Plot trial. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz

1. Whom does the Porter pretend to be?
   A. A soldier
   B. A king
   C. The porter of hell gate
   D. A witch
2. Who discovers Duncan's body?
   A. Malcolm
   B. Lennox
   C. Macduff
   D. Banquo
3. What has Macbeth done to the chamberlains?
   A. Let them go
   B. Killed them, claiming fury
   C. Arrested them
   D. Questioned them
4. Where do Malcolm and Donalbain flee?
   A. Norway and France
   B. Fife and Forres
   C. Scone and Colmekill
   D. England and Ireland
5. What does Donalbain say there are in men's smiles?
   A. Lies
   B. Daggers
   C. Prayers
   D. Tears
6. In the line “I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire.”, what does “primrose” most nearly mean?
   A. handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat)
   B. pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure)
   C. a large outdoor fire
   D. a supreme piece of work

7. In the line “Here’s a farmer, that hanged himself on the expectation of plenty: come in time; have napkins enow about you; here you’ll sweat for’t.”, what does “napkins” most nearly mean?
   A. handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat)
   B. a large outdoor fire
   C. a supreme piece of work
   D. pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure)

Answer key: 1. C (The porter of hell gate); 2. C (Macduff); 3. B (Killed them, claiming fury); 4. D (England and Ireland); 5. B (Daggers); 6. B (pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure)); 7. A (handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat))

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show the discovery of the murder? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the discovery of the murder? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of the discovery of the murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the discovery of the murder. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene III suggests about the discovery of the murder. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act II, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the discovery of the murder. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act II, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the discovery of the

murder responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act II, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the discovery of the murder follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene III and its treatment of the discovery of the murder. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about the discovery of the murder in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the discovery of the murder. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "bonfire" most nearly mean?

   A. a large outdoor fire

   B. the state of being dressed and armed

   C. short knives used as weapons

   D. sometimes; at times

2. *Marry, sir, nose-painting, sleep, and urine. Lechery, sir, it provokes, and unprovokes; it provokes the desire, but it takes away the performance: therefore, much drink may be said to be an equivocator with lechery: it makes him, and it mars him; it sets him on, and it takes him off; it persuades him, and disheartens him; makes him stand to, and not stand to; in conclusion, equivocates him in a sleep, and, giving him the lie, leaves him.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene III"?

   A. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

   B. Life as a tale told by an idiot

   C. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

   D. The discovery of the murder

SAT key: 1. A (a large outdoor fire); 2. D (The discovery of the murder)

Lesson 13: Act II, Scene IV

Focus: nature's revolt against the crime

Teacher only · spoilers

Ross and an Old Man describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by a 'mousing owl', and Duncan's horses breaking loose and eating each other. Macduff reports that the princes are suspected of bribing the grooms, that Macbeth has been named king and has gone to Scone to be invested, and that Duncan's body has been carried to Colmekill. Macduff will not go to Scone but home to Fife.

Background: The idea of a 'great chain of being' held that a king's murder disordered nature; Holinshed's chronicle supplied the omens of the horses and the darkness.

Significance: The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: storehouse — a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place; trifled — made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison; predecessors — people who held a position earlier; invested — formally given the office and crown of king; ambition — a strong desire for power or success.
Words: storehouse: a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place · trifled: made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison · predecessors: people who held a position earlier · invested: formally given the office and crown of king · ambition: a strong desire for power or success

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The idea of a 'great chain of being' held that a king's murder disordered nature; Holinshed's chronicle supplied the omens of the horses and the darkness. The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance. Setting: An Old Man and Ross describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl, Duncan's horses eating each other. Imagery: Nature in revolt mirrors the moral disorder. Characterization: Macduff refuses to attend the coronation at Scone: the first sign of resistance. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "They were suborn'd: / Malcolm and Donalbain, the king's two sons, / Are stol'n away and fled; which puts upon them" (Act II, Scene IV, Macduff (speech 11)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)). Darkness by day. That is setting at work: An Old Man and Ross describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl, Duncan's horses eating each other.

> *by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)). Darkness by day. That is setting at work: An Old Man and Ross describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl, Duncan's horses eating each other.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The falcon is the king, the owl Macbeth. It shows the belief in a divine order (the "great chain of being"). Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: The cosmic order reacts to a human crime. (Symbol of regicide.)

> *A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man (speech 3))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The falcon is the king, the owl Macbeth. It shows the belief in a divine order (the "great chain of being").
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: The cosmic order reacts to a human crime. (Symbol of regicide.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for setting, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of nature's revolt against the crime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. When the text says “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)), it shows this directly. Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

Task: Annotate the scene for setting, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of nature's revolt against the crime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. When the text says “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)), it shows this directly. Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does? Ask: would a modern audience believe these signs? How should a production stage them?

Anchor question: Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does?

Facilitation: Ask: would a modern audience believe these signs? How should a production stage them?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. ("by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp", Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. ("by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp", Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes nature's revolt against the crime. Key takeaway: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** An Old Man and Ross describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl, Duncan's horses eating each other.
- **Imagery:** Nature in revolt mirrors the moral disorder.
- **Characterization:** Macduff refuses to attend the coronation at Scone: the first sign of resistance.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "They were suborn'd: / Malcolm and Donalbain, the king's two sons, / Are stol'n away and fled; which puts upon them" (Act II, Scene IV, Macduff (speech 11)).
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: "seest, the heavens, as troubled with man's act, / Threaten his bloody stage: by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)) Darkness by day.
- "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man (speech 3)) Symbol of regicide.
- "Tis said they eat each other" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man (speech 5)) Duncan's horses.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe.
Evidence: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2))
Reasoning: Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
storehouse (noun)	a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place	*Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
trifled (verb)	made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison	*Threescore and ten I can remember well: Within the volume of which time I have seen Hours dreadful and things strange; but this sore night Hath trifled former knowings.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
predecessors (noun)	people who held a position earlier	*Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
invested (verb)	formally given the office and crown of king	*He is already named, and gone to Scone To be invested.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ambition (noun)	a strong desire for power or success	*Thriftless ambition, that wilt ravin up Thine own life's means!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
buffets (noun)	blows; hard knocks	*I am one, my liege, Whom the vile blows and buffets of the world Have so incensed that I am reckless what I do to spite the world.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
predominant (adjective)	strongest; ruling over the rest	*Do you find Your patience so predominant in your nature That you can let this go?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
parricide (noun)	the murder of one's father	*We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.	

Discussion questions

1. Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What strange thing has happened to the daylight? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Dark night strangles the travelling lamp: it is dark by day.
2. What killed the falcon? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A mousing owl
3. What did Duncan's horses do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Broke loose and ate each other
4. Who is suspected of the murder now? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Malcolm and Donalbain, who fled
5. Where has Macbeth gone to be crowned? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Scone
6. Where will Macduff go instead? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Home to Fife
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Ross and an Old Man describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by a 'mousing owl', and Duncan's horses breaking loose and eating each other. Macduff reports that the princes are suspected of bribing the grooms, that Macbeth has been named king and has gone to Scone to be invested, and that Duncan's body has been carried to Colmekill. Macduff will not go to Scone but home to Fife.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones." What does "storehouse" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: storehouse: a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does the owl killing the falcon symbolize? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: A lower creature killing a higher one: Macbeth killing his king.
2. What does "Act II, Scene IV" suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the symbolism in this scene shape what we understand about nature's revolt against the crime? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)): Darkness by day. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Ah, good father, Thou seest, the heavens, as troubled with man's act, Threaten his bloody stage: by the clock, 'tis day, And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp: Is't…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act II, Scene IV", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Ross and an Old Man describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by a 'mousing owl', and Duncan's horses breaking loose and eating each other. Macduff reports that the princes are suspected of bribing the grooms, that Macbeth has been named king and has gone to Scone to be invested,…
7. How does "Act II, Scene IV" build on "Act II, Scene III"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man (speech 3)): Symbol of regicide. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "Tis said they eat each other" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man (speech 5)): Duncan's horses. On characterization: Macduff refuses to attend the coronation at Scone: the first sign of resistance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)): Darkness by day. On setting: An Old Man and Ross describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl, Duncan's horses eating each other. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Macduff's decision not to attend the coronation is small but important. How brave is it? Explain. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment about quiet resistance.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man (speech 3)): Symbol of regicide. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "Tis said they eat each other" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man (speech 5)): Duncan's horses. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)): Darkness by day. On characterization: Macduff refuses to attend the coronation at Scone: the first sign of resistance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing "Act II, Scene IV". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of nature's revolt against the crime. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that

the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man (speech 3)): Symbol of regicide. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “Tis said they eat each other” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man (speech 5)): Duncan's horses. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)): Darkness by day. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man (speech 3)): Symbol of regicide. On imagery: Nature in revolt mirrors the moral disorder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene IV” treats nature's revolt against the crime with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “Tis said they eat each other” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man (speech 5)): Duncan's horses. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross (speech 2)): Darkness by day. Theme link: the

cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about nature's revolt against the crime? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man (speech 3)): Symbol of regicide. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz

1. What killed the falcon?
    A. The storm
    B. A mousing owl
    C. A hunter
    D. A hawk
2. What did Duncan's horses do?
    A. Died in the stable
    B. Ran to England
    C. Broke loose and ate each other
    D. Stood still all night
3. Who is suspected of the murder now?
    A. The Witches
    B. Malcolm and Donalbain, who fled
    C. Macduff
    D. Banquo
4. Where has Macbeth gone to be crowned?
    A. Fife
    B. Scone
    C. Inverness
    D. Forres
5. Where will Macduff go instead?
    A. To England immediately

B. To Ireland

C. To Scone

D. Home to Fife

6. In the line “Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones.”, what does “storehouse” most nearly mean?

A. a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place

B. formally given the office and crown of king

C. made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison

D. people who held a position earlier

7. In the line “Threescore and ten I can remember well: Within the volume of which time I have seen Hours dreadful and things strange; but this sore night Hath trifled former knowings.”, what does “trifled” most nearly mean?

A. a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place

B. made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison

C. formally given the office and crown of king

D. people who held a position earlier

Answer key: 1. B (A mousing owl); 2. C (Broke loose and ate each other); 3. B (Malcolm and Donalbain, who fled); 4. B (Scone); 5. D (Home to Fife); 6. A (a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place); 7. B (made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene IV,” how does Shakespeare show nature's revolt against the crime? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of nature's revolt against the crime? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of nature's revolt against the crime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of nature's revolt against the crime. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene IV suggests about nature's revolt against the crime. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act II, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of nature's revolt against the crime. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act II, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of nature's revolt against the crime responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act II, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of nature's revolt against the crime follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene IV and its treatment of nature's revolt against the crime. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about nature's revolt against the crime in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of nature's revolt against the crime. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “predecessors” most nearly mean?

   A. strongest; ruling over the rest

   B. people who held a position earlier

   C. the murder of one's father

   D. blows; hard knocks

2. *Ah, good father, Thou seest, the heavens, as troubled with man's act, Threaten his bloody stage: by the clock, 'tis day, And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp: Is't night's predominance, or the day's shame, That darkness does the face of earth entomb, When living light should kiss it?*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene IV"?

A. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

B. The cast and world of the play

C. Nature's revolt against the crime

D. Life as a tale told by an idiot

SAT key: 1. B (people who held a position earlier); 2. C (Nature's revolt against the crime)

Lesson 14: Act III, Scene I

Focus: insecurity on the throne

Teacher only · spoilers

Banquo suspects Macbeth 'play'dst most foully' for the crown but hopes the prophecy for his own line will also come true. Macbeth, now king, invites Banquo to the feast and learns he will ride out with Fleance. Alone, Macbeth says 'To be thus is nothing; but to be safely thus': Banquo's royal nature and the prophecy of his heirs torment him, since he holds a 'fruitless crown.' He persuades two murderers that Banquo is their enemy and hires them to kill Banquo and Fleance.

Background: Because James I claimed descent from Banquo, Shakespeare makes Banquo noble, departing from Holinshed, where Banquo helps kill Duncan.

Significance: Getting the crown has not ended Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition because....
Prompt: Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: buffets — blows; hard knocks; predominant — strongest; ruling over the rest; parricide — the murder of one's father; disasters — misfortunes; rebuked — checked; held back.
Words: buffets: blows; hard knocks · predominant: strongest; ruling over the rest · parricide: the murder of one's father · disasters: misfortunes · rebuked: checked; held back

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Because James I claimed descent from Banquo, Shakespeare makes Banquo noble, departing from Holinshed, where Banquo helps kill Duncan. Getting the crown has not ended Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him. Soliloquy: "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus": Macbeth fears Banquo and his heirs. Characterization: Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood. Imagery: "Fruitless crown" and "barren sceptre": he has no heir. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Cawdor, Glamis, all, / As the weird women promised, and, I fear, / Thou play'dst most foully for't: yet it was said / It should" (Act III, Scene I, Banquo (speech 1)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus" (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)). Kingship without security means nothing. That is soliloquy at work: "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus": Macbeth fears Banquo and his heirs.

> *To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus* *(Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus" (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)). Kingship without security means nothing. That is soliloquy at work: "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus": Macbeth fears Banquo and his heirs.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Fruitless" and "barren" mean childless: Macbeth gained the crown for Banquo's sons. Ambition. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition? Expected: Ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. (Childlessness.)

> *Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe* *(Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Fruitless" and "barren" mean childless: Macbeth gained the crown for Banquo's sons. Ambition.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition?
Expected answer: Ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. (Childlessness.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about insecurity on the throne? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of insecurity on the throne. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. When the text says “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)), it shows this directly. He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.
Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about insecurity on the throne? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of insecurity on the throne. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. When the text says “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)), it shows this directly. He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy? Compare how Macbeth persuades the murderers with how Lady Macbeth persuaded him.
Anchor question: Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy?
Facilitation: Compare how Macbeth persuades the murderers with how Lady Macbeth persuaded him.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about insecurity on the throne? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. (“To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus”, Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about insecurity on the throne? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. (“To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus”, Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how soliloquy shapes insecurity on the throne. Key takeaway: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus": Macbeth fears Banquo and his heirs.
- **Characterization:** Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood.
- **Imagery:** "Fruitless crown" and "barren sceptre": he has no heir.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition:** ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Cawdor, Glamis, all, / As the weird women promised, and, I fear, / Thou play’dst most foully for’t: yet it was said / It should” (Act III, Scene I, Banquo (speech 1)).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Thou hast it now: king, Cawdor, Glamis, all, / As the weird women promised, and, I fear” (Act III, Scene I, Banquo (speech 1)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)) Kingship without security means nothing.
- “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)) Childlessness.
- “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 22)) Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder.
Evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16))
Reasoning: He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
buffets (noun)	blows; hard knocks	*I am one, my liege, Whom the vile blows and buffets of the world Have so incensed that I am reckless what I do to spite the world.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
predominant (adjective)	strongest; ruling over the rest	*Do you find Your patience so predominant in your nature That you can let this go?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
parricide (noun)	the murder of one's father	*We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disasters (noun)	misfortunes	*And I another So weary with disasters, tugg'd with fortune, That I would set my lie on any chance, To mend it, or be rid on't.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
rebuked (verb)	checked; held back	*There is none but he Whose being I do fear: and, under him, My Genius is rebuked; as, it is said, Mark Antony's was by Caesar.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
confessing (verb)	admitting (a crime)	*We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
oracles (noun)	people or spirits who give prophecies	*If there come truth from them— As upon thee, Macbeth, their speeches shine— Why, by the verities on thee made good, May they not be my oracles as well, And set me up in hope?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cousins (noun)	kinsmen; relatives (here, Duncan's sons)	*We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
highness (noun)	a title of respect used to address a king	*Let your highness Command upon me; to the which my duties Are with a most indissoluble tie For ever knit.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Complete Macbeth's line: 'To be thus is nothing…' [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: '…but to be safely thus.'
2. What does Banquo suspect? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: That Macbeth played most foully for the crown
3. What does Macbeth ask about Banquo's afternoon? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Whether he rides, how far, and whether Fleance goes with him
4. What does Macbeth call his crown? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A fruitless crown
5. Whom does Macbeth hire the murderers to kill? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Banquo and Fleance
6. How does Macbeth persuade the murderers? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He tells them Banquo caused their misfortunes
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Banquo suspects Macbeth 'play'dst most foully' for the crown but hopes the prophecy for his own line will also come true. Macbeth, now king, invites Banquo to the feast and learns he will ride out with Fleance. Alone, Macbeth says 'To be thus is nothing; but to be safely thus': Banquo's royal nature and the prophecy of his heirs torment him, since he holds a 'fruitless crown.' He persuades two…
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "I am one, my liege, Whom the vile blows and buffets of the world Have so incensed that I am reckless what I do to spite the world." What does "buffets" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: buffets: blows; hard knocks.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macbeth not tell Lady Macbeth about the plan to kill Banquo? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: He is growing independent in crime and isolated from her.
2. What does "Act III, Scene I" suggest about insecurity on the throne? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Getting the crown has not ended

Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him.

3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about insecurity on the throne? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Kingship without security means nothing. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Thou hast it now: king, Cawdor, Glamis, all, As the weird women promised, and, I fear, Thou play’dst most foully for’t: yet it was said It should not stand in thy posterity, But…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Banquo suspects Macbeth 'play'dst most foully' for the crown but hopes the prophecy for his own line will also come true. Macbeth, now king, invites Banquo to the feast and learns he will ride out with Fleance. Alone, Macbeth says 'To be thus is nothing; but to be safely thus': Banquo's royal…
7. How does “Act III, Scene I” build on “Act II, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Childlessness. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 22)): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. On characterization: Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold,

light) and what mood they create.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Kingship without security means nothing. On imagery: "Fruitless crown" and "barren sceptre": he has no heir. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Banquo partly guilty for keeping silent about his suspicions? Argue for or against. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment about complicity through silence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Childlessness. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Getting the crown has not ended Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 22)): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Kingship without security means nothing. On characterization: Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of insecurity on the throne. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Childlessness. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 22)): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Kingship without security means nothing. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Childlessness. On characterization: Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene I” treats insecurity on the throne with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 22)): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Kingship without security means nothing. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about insecurity on the throne? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a

barren sceptre in my gripe" (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 16)): Childlessness. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz

1. What does Banquo suspect?
   A. That Malcolm killed Duncan
   B. That Macduff is a traitor
   C. That the Witches lied
   D. That Macbeth played most foully for the crown
2. What does Macbeth ask about Banquo's afternoon?
   A. Whether he will stay at court
   B. Whether he has seen the Witches
   C. Whether he rides, how far, and whether Fleance goes with him
   D. Whether he will visit England
3. What does Macbeth call his crown?
   A. A golden round
   B. A fruitless crown
   C. A heavy burden
   D. A stolen jewel
4. Whom does Macbeth hire the murderers to kill?
   A. Banquo and Fleance
   B. Malcolm
   C. Macduff and his family
   D. Lennox
5. How does Macbeth persuade the murderers?
   A. He threatens their families
   B. He tells them Banquo caused their misfortunes
   C. He offers them the crown
   D. He says the Witches command it
6. In the line "I am one, my liege, Whom the vile blows and buffets of the world Have so incensed that I am reckless what I do to spite the world.", what does "buffets" most nearly mean?
   A. blows; hard knocks

B. misfortunes

C. the murder of one's father

D. strongest; ruling over the rest

7. In the line “Do you find Your patience so predominant in your nature That you can let this go?”, what does “predominant” most nearly mean?

A. misfortunes

B. strongest; ruling over the rest

C. blows; hard knocks

D. the murder of one's father

Answer key: 1. D (That Macbeth played most foully for the crown); 2. C (Whether he rides, how far, and whether Fleance goes with him); 3. B (A fruitless crown); 4. A (Banquo and Fleance); 5. B (He tells them Banquo caused their misfortunes); 6. A (blows; hard knocks); 7. B (strongest; ruling over the rest)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show insecurity on the throne? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of insecurity on the throne? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of insecurity on the throne. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of insecurity on the throne. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene I suggests about insecurity on the throne. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act III, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of insecurity on the throne. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act III, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of insecurity on the throne responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act III, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of insecurity on the throne follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene I and its treatment of insecurity on the throne. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about insecurity on the throne in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of insecurity on the throne. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “parricide” most nearly mean?

   A. a title of respect used to address a king

   B. people or spirits who give prophecies

   C. kinsmen; relatives (here, Duncan's sons)

   D. the murder of one's father

2. *Thou hast it now: king, Cawdor, Glamis, all, As the weird women promised, and, I fear, Thou play'dst most foully for't: yet it was said It should not stand in thy posterity, But that myself should be the root and father Of many kings. If there come truth from them— As upon thee, Macbeth, their speeches shine— Why, by the verities on thee made good, May they not be my oracles as well, And set me up in hope? But hush! no more.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene I”?

   A. The murder of the innocent

   B. The army reveals itself

   C. The dagger of the mind

D. Insecurity on the throne

SAT key: 1. D (the murder of one's father); 2. D (Insecurity on the throne)

Lesson 15: Act III, Scene II

Focus: a marriage drifting apart

Teacher only · spoilers

Lady Macbeth admits 'Nought's had, all's spent, where our desire is got without content.' She urges Macbeth to stop brooding. He says they have 'scotch'd the snake, not kill'd it,' that terrible dreams shake them nightly, and that Duncan in his grave sleeps well. 'O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!' He hints at 'a deed of dreadful note' but tells her to 'be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck,' and calls on 'seeling night' to hide it.

Background: To 'seel' was a falconer's term for stitching shut a young hawk's eyes to tame it; Macbeth asks night to blind the day.

Significance: The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can a shared secret change a relationship? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....
Prompt: How can a shared secret change a relationship?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: applaud — to praise; cloister — a covered walkway; here, dark enclosed places where bats fly; yawning — drowsy; pitiful — full of pity; compassionate; invisible — that cannot be seen.
Words: applaud: to praise · cloister: a covered walkway; here, dark enclosed places where bats fly · yawning: drowsy · pitiful: full of pity; compassionate · invisible: that cannot be seen

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
To 'seel' was a falconer's term for stitching shut a young hawk's eyes to tame it; Macbeth asks night to blind the day. The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime. Characterization: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy. Imagery: "O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!" and invocations of night. Structure: The marriage reverses: he now leads; she follows. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "the worlds suffer, / Ere we will eat our meal in fear and sleep / In the affliction of these terrible dreams / That shake" (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 6)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content" (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)). Lady Macbeth's despair. That is characterization at work: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy.

> *Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content* (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 5))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content" (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)). Lady Macbeth's despair. That is characterization at work: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The rhyming couplet shows emptiness; "chuck" is affectionate but excludes her. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected: Both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." (He shuts her out.)

> *Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck* (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 14))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The rhyming couplet shows emptiness; "chuck" is affectionate but excludes her.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected answer: Both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." (He shuts her out.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a marriage drifting apart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of a marriage drifting apart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. When the text says “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 14)), it shows this directly. She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a marriage drifting apart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of a marriage drifting apart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. When the text says “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 14)), it shows this directly. She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How can a shared secret change a relationship? Ask: is Macbeth protecting his wife or isolating her?
Anchor question: How can a shared secret change a relationship?
Facilitation: Ask: is Macbeth protecting his wife or isolating her?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a marriage drifting apart? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. (“Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck”, Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 14)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a marriage drifting apart? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. (“Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck”, Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 14)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes a marriage drifting apart. Key takeaway: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy.
- **Imagery:** "O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!" and invocations of night.
- **Structure:** The marriage reverses: he now leads; she follows.

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “the worlds suffer, / Ere we will eat our meal in fear and sleep / In the affliction of these terrible dreams / That shake” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 6)).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Say to the king, I would attend his leisure / For a few words” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 3)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)) Lady Macbeth's despair.
- “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 10)) Torment.
- “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 14)) He shuts her out.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide.
Evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 14))
Reasoning: She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
applaud (verb)	to praise	*Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck, Till thou applaud the deed.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

cloister (noun)	a covered walkway; here, dark enclosed places where bats fly	*There's comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister'd flight, ere to black Hecate's summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night's yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
yawning (adjective)	drowsy	*There's comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister'd flight, ere to black Hecate's summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night's yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pitiful (adjective)	full of pity; compassionate	*Come, seeling night, Scarf up the tender eye of pitiful day; And with thy bloody and invisible hand Cancel and tear to pieces that great bond Which keeps me pale!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
invisible (adjective)	that cannot be seen	*Come, seeling night, Scarf up the tender eye of pitiful day; And with thy bloody and invisible hand Cancel and tear to pieces that great bond Which keeps me pale!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
leisure (noun)	a convenient time	*Say to the king, I would attend his leisure For a few words.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
glimmers (verb)	shines faintly	*The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day: Now spurs the lated traveller apace To gain the timely inn; and near approaches The subject of our watch.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
delivers (verb)	reports; tells	*He needs not our mistrust, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How can a shared secret change a relationship?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Macbeth call his wife in this scene that shows tenderness? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: 'Dear wife' and 'dearest chuck.'
2. What does Lady Macbeth mean by 'Nought's had, all's spent'? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: They have gained nothing that brings content
3. What does Macbeth say they have done to the snake? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Scotched it, not killed it
4. What is Macbeth's mind full of? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Scorpions
5. Who does Macbeth say sleeps well? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Duncan in his grave
6. What does Macbeth tell his wife about the coming deed? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Be innocent of the knowledge until she can applaud it
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act III, Scene II” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lady Macbeth admits 'Nought's had, all's spent, where our desire is got without content.' She urges Macbeth to stop brooding. He says they have 'scotch'd the snake, not kill'd it,' that terrible dreams shake them nightly, and that Duncan in his grave sleeps well. 'O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!' He hints at 'a deed of dreadful note' but tells her to 'be innocent of the knowledge,…
8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck, Till thou applaud the deed.” What does “applaud” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: applaud: to praise.

Inferential / analytical

1. Lady Macbeth says 'what's done is done' here; in V.i she says 'What's done cannot be undone.' How has the meaning changed? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Here she tries to control regret; later the same idea becomes despair.
2. What does “Act III, Scene II” suggest about a marriage drifting apart? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about a marriage drifting apart? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the

marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)): Lady Macbeth's despair. On characterization: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “There’s comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister’d flight, ere to black Hecate’s summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Lady Macbeth admits 'Nought's had, all's spent, where our desire is got without content.' She urges Macbeth to stop brooding. He says they have 'scotch'd the snake, not kill'd it,' that terrible dreams shake them nightly, and that Duncan in his grave sleeps well. 'O, full of scorpions is my mind,…
7. How does “Act III, Scene II” build on “Act III, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 10)): Torment. On structure: The marriage reverses: he now leads; she follows. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 14)): He shuts her out. On characterization: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How can a shared secret change a relationship?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with appearance versus reality? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)): Lady Macbeth's despair. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Macbeth protecting his wife by keeping her ignorant, or shutting her out? Argue your view. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment about the marriage with evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 10)): Torment. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 14)): He shuts her out. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)): Lady Macbeth's despair. On characterization: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of a marriage drifting apart. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 10)): Torment. On structure: The marriage reverses: he now leads; she follows. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 14)): He shuts her out. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look

for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)): Lady Macbeth's despair. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 10)): Torment. On imagery: "O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!" and invocations of night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene II” treats a marriage drifting apart with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 14)): He shuts her out. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth (speech 5)): Lady Macbeth's despair. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a marriage drifting apart? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth (speech 10)): Torment. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. What does Lady Macbeth mean by 'Nought's had, all's spent'?
   A. They have gained nothing that brings content
   B. The war is lost
   C. They have lost all their money
   D. The feast is over
2. What does Macbeth say they have done to the snake?
   A. Scotched it, not killed it
   B. Killed it completely
   C. Fed it
   D. Charmed it
3. What is Macbeth's mind full of?
   A. Scorpions
   B. Flowers
   C. Daggers
   D. Ghosts
4. Who does Macbeth say sleeps well?
   A. Banquo
   B. The Witches
   C. Duncan in his grave
   D. Malcolm in England
5. What does Macbeth tell his wife about the coming deed?
   A. Tell Banquo
   B. Be innocent of the knowledge until she can applaud it
   C. Do it herself
   D. Help him plan it
6. In the line “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck, Till thou applaud the deed.”, what does “applaud” most nearly mean?
   A. a covered walkway; here, dark enclosed places where bats fly
   B. drowsy
   C. full of pity; compassionate
   D. to praise
7. In the line “There’s comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister’d flight, ere to black Hecate’s summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night’s yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.”, what does “cloister” most nearly mean?
   A. drowsy
   B. to praise

C. a covered walkway; here, dark enclosed places where bats fly

D. full of pity; compassionate

Answer key: 1. A (They have gained nothing that brings content); 2. A (Scotched it, not killed it); 3. A (Scorpions); 4. C (Duncan in his grave); 5. B (Be innocent of the knowledge until she can applaud it); 6. D (to praise); 7. C (a covered walkway; here, dark enclosed places where bats fly)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act III, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show a marriage drifting apart? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of a marriage drifting apart? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of a marriage drifting apart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of a marriage drifting apart. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene II suggests about a marriage drifting apart. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act III, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of a marriage drifting apart. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act III, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of a marriage drifting apart responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act III, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of a marriage drifting apart

follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene II and its treatment of a marriage drifting apart. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about a marriage drifting apart in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of a marriage drifting apart. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *There's comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister'd flight, ere to black Hecate's summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night's yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "yawning" most nearly mean?

   A. a convenient time

   B. shines faintly

   C. reports; tells

   D. drowsy

2. *There's comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister'd flight, ere to black Hecate's summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night's yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene II"?

   A. A marriage drifting apart

   B. The moving wood

   C. The cast and world of the play

   D. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

SAT key: 1. D (drowsy); 2. A (A marriage drifting apart)

Lesson 16: Act III, Scene III

Focus: Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

Teacher only · spoilers

At dusk a mysterious Third Murderer joins the first two. Banquo and Fleance approach on foot from the palace gate with a torch. The murderers attack and kill Banquo, who cries to Fleance to fly and avenge him. The light is struck out and Fleance escapes. The murderers go to report how much is done.

Background: The identity of the Third Murderer is never explained; some productions make him Macbeth himself, Ross or Seyton, showing Macbeth's distrust even of his hired men.

Significance: Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: glimmers — shines faintly; delivers — reports; tells; mistrust — suspicion; approaches — comes near; grandam — a grandmother.
Words: glimmers: shines faintly · delivers: reports; tells · mistrust: suspicion · approaches: comes near · grandam: a grandmother

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The identity of the Third Murderer is never explained; some productions make him Macbeth himself, Ross or Seyton, showing Macbeth's distrust even of his hired men. Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail. Plot: Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes. Imagery: Dusk, a torch put out. Irony: The prophecy about Banquo's heirs survives in Fleance. Watch for darkness and light: Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder. In this scene: "Within. Give us a light there, ho" (Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 6)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer (speech 4)). Twilight setting. That is plot at work: Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes.

> *The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day* (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer (speech 4))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer (speech 4)). Twilight setting. That is plot at work: Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Banquo's last words. Look at the craft: Dusk, a torch put out. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. (Banquo's last words.)

> *O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly* (Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 15))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Banquo's last words. Look at the craft: Dusk, a torch put out.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. (Banquo's last words.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for plot, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. When the text says "O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 15)), it shows this directly. Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair."
Task: Annotate the scene for plot, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. When the text says "O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 15)), it shows this directly. Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved? Ask: who is the third murderer? Discuss the theories, and why Shakespeare may have left it open.
Anchor question: Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved?
Facilitation: Ask: who is the third murderer? Discuss the theories, and why Shakespeare may have left it open.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. ("O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly", Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 15)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. ("O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly", Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 15)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Key takeaway: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes.
- **Imagery:** Dusk, a torch put out.
- **Irony:** The prophecy about Banquo's heirs survives in Fleance.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

Symbols and motifs

- **darkness and light:** Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder. In this scene: “Within. Give us a light there, ho” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 6)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer (speech 4)) Twilight setting.
- “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 15)) Banquo's last words.
- “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer (speech 19)) The murderers' failure.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold.
Evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 15))
Reasoning: Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
glimmers (verb)	shines faintly	*The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day: Now spurs the lated traveller apace To gain the timely inn; and near approaches The subject of our watch.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

delivers (verb)	reports; tells	*He needs not our mistrust, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mistrust (noun)	suspicion	*He needs not our mistrust, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
approaches (verb)	comes near	*The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day: Now spurs the lated traveller apace To gain the timely inn; and near approaches The subject of our watch.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
grandam (noun)	a grandmother	*O, these flaws and starts, Impostors to true fear, would well become A woman's story at a winter's fire, Authorized by her grandam.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
nonpareil (noun)	someone without equal	*Thou art the best o' the cut-throats: yet he's good That did the like for Fleance: if thou didst it, Thou art the nonpareil.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
charnel (noun)	a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited	*If charnel-houses and our graves must send Those that we bury back, our monuments Shall be the maws of kites.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
displaced (verb)	driven out	*You have displaced the mirth, broke the good meeting, With most admired disorder.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What happens to the light at the moment of the attack? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The torch is struck out ('Who did strike out the light?').
2. Who joins the first two murderers? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A Third Murderer

3. What time of day is it? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Dusk, as the last light fades
4. What does Banquo tell Fleance? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Fly, good Fleance, fly
5. What happens to Fleance? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He escapes
6. What does the Third Murderer say about the result? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: There's but one down; the son is fled
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: At dusk a mysterious Third Murderer joins the first two. Banquo and Fleance approach on foot from the palace gate with a torch. The murderers attack and kill Banquo, who cries to Fleance to fly and avenge him. The light is struck out and Fleance escapes. The murderers go to report how much is done.
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day: Now spurs the lated traveller apace To gain the timely inn; and near approaches The subject of our watch." What does "glimmers" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: glimmers: shines faintly.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Macbeth have sent a Third Murderer without telling the others? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: He no longer trusts anyone, even his own agents.
2. What does "Act III, Scene III" suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer (speech 4)): Twilight setting. On irony: The prophecy about Banquo's heirs survives in Fleance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Then stand with us.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: At dusk a mysterious Third Murderer joins the first two. Banquo and Fleance approach on foot from the palace gate with a torch. The murderers attack and kill Banquo, who cries to Fleance to fly and avenge him. The light is struck out and Fleance escapes. The murderers go to report how much is done.
7. How does “Act III, Scene III” build on “Act III, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 15)): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer (speech 19)): The murderers' failure. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer (speech 4)): Twilight setting. On plot: Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Whom would you cast as the Third Murderer in a production, and why? Defend with clues from the play. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A justified interpretive staging choice.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 15)): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one

counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer (speech 19)): The murderers' failure. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer (speech 4)): Twilight setting. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 15)): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer (speech 19)): The murderers' failure. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer (speech 4)): Twilight setting. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 15)): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene III” treats Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer (speech 19)): The murderers' failure. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer (speech 4)): Twilight setting. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo (speech 15)): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz

1. Who joins the first two murderers?

   A. Lady Macbeth

   B. Lennox

   C. A Third Murderer

   D. Macbeth openly

2. What time of day is it?

   A. Noon

   B. Midday at the feast

C. Dawn

D. Dusk, as the last light fades

3. What does Banquo tell Fleance?

A. Hide in the castle

B. Fight beside me

C. Fly, good Fleance, fly

D. Go to England with Macduff

4. What happens to Fleance?

A. He is wounded and taken to Macbeth

B. He is captured

C. He escapes

D. He is killed

5. What does the Third Murderer say about the result?

A. Both are dead

B. They killed the wrong man

C. Banquo escaped

D. There's but one down; the son is fled

6. In the line “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day: Now spurs the lated traveller apace To gain the timely inn; and near approaches The subject of our watch.”, what does “glimmers” most nearly mean?

A. suspicion

B. shines faintly

C. reports; tells

D. comes near

7. In the line “He needs not our mistrust, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just.”, what does “delivers” most nearly mean?

A. shines faintly

B. comes near

C. reports; tells

D. suspicion

Answer key: 1. C (A Third Murderer); 2. D (Dusk, as the last light fades); 3. C (Fly, good Fleance, fly); 4. C (He escapes); 5. D (There's but one down; the son is fled); 6. B (shines faintly); 7. C (reports; tells)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene III suggests about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act III, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act III, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act III, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene III and its treatment of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape.

Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *He needs not our mistrust, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "mistrust" most nearly mean?

   A. a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited

   B. someone without equal

   C. driven out

   D. suspicion

2. *Then stand with us. The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day: Now spurs the lated traveller apace To gain the timely inn; and near approaches The subject of our watch.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene III"?

   A. Insecurity on the throne

   B. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

   C. Lady Macbeth's resolve

   D. The ghost at the banquet

SAT key: 1. D (suspicion); 2. B (Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape)

Lesson 17: Act III, Scene IV

Focus: the ghost at the banquet

Teacher only · spoilers

At the state banquet a Murderer tells Macbeth that Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped. When Macbeth wishes Banquo were present, Banquo's ghost sits in his place, seen only by Macbeth, who cries 'Thou canst not say I did it.' Lady Macbeth explains it as a fit he has had since youth and scolds him ('Are you a man?'). The ghost returns; the feast breaks up in disorder. Afterwards Macbeth says 'blood will have blood,' notes that Macduff refused to come, and resolves to visit the Witches: 'I am in blood stepp'd in so far…'

Background: Elizabethan audiences debated whether ghosts were spirits of the dead or devils in disguise; the play never settles whether this ghost is real.

Significance: The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....
Prompt: What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: grandam — a grandmother; nonpareil — someone without equal; charnel — a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited; displaced — driven out; betimes — early.
Words: grandam: a grandmother · nonpareil: someone without equal · charnel: a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited · displaced: driven out · betimes: early

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Elizabethan audiences debated whether ghosts were spirits of the dead or devils in disguise; the play never settles whether this ghost is real. The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control. Dramatic irony: Macbeth wishes Banquo were present; the ghost takes his seat. Characterization: Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him. Imagery: "It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood." Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "O proper stuff! / This is the very painting of your fear: / This is the air-drawn dagger which, you said, / Led you to" (Act III, Scene IV, Lady Macbeth (speech 29)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25)). Macbeth to the ghost. That is dramatic irony at work: Macbeth wishes Banquo were present; the ghost takes his seat.

> *Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me* (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25)). Macbeth to the ghost. That is dramatic irony at work: Macbeth wishes Banquo were present; the ghost takes his seat.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The river of blood image: halfway across, he keeps going. Guilt becomes hardness. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected: Guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. (Violence breeds violence.)

> *It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood* (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 47))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The river of blood image: halfway across, he keeps going. Guilt becomes hardness.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected answer: Guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. (Violence breeds violence.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the ghost at the banquet? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of the ghost at the banquet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. When the text says "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25)), it shows this directly. He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.

Task: Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the ghost at the banquet? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of the ghost at the banquet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. When the text says "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25)), it shows this directly. He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong? Ask: should the ghost be visible to the audience? What changes if not?

Anchor question: What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong?

Facilitation: Ask: should the ghost be visible to the audience? What changes if not?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the ghost at the banquet? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. (“Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me”, Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the ghost at the banquet? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. (“Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me”, Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes the ghost at the banquet. Key takeaway: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Macbeth wishes Banquo were present; the ghost takes his seat.
- **Characterization:** Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him.
- **Imagery:** "It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood."

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “O proper stuff! / This is the very painting of your fear: / This is the air-drawn dagger which, you said, / Led you to” (Act III, Scene IV, Lady Macbeth (speech 29)).
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: “drink a measure / The table round. Approaching the door. There’s blood on thy face” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 5)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25)) Macbeth to the ghost.
- "It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 47)) Violence breeds violence.
- "I am in blood / Stepp'd in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o'er" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 51)) Macbeth chooses to go on.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back.
Evidence: "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25))
Reasoning: He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
grandam (noun)	a grandmother	*O, these flaws and starts, Impostors to true fear, would well become A woman's story at a winter's fire, Authorized by her grandam.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
nonpareil (noun)	someone without equal	*Thou art the best o' the cut-throats: yet he's good That did the like for Fleance: if thou didst it, Thou art the nonpareil.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
charnel (noun)	a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited	*If charnel-houses and our graves must send Those that we bury back, our monuments Shall be the maws of kites.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
displaced (verb)	driven out	*You have displaced the mirth, broke the good meeting, With most admired disorder.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
betimes (adverb)	early	*I will to-morrow, And betimes I will, to the weird sisters: More shall they speak; for now I am bent to know, By the worst means, the worst.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
monuments (noun)	tombs	*If charnel-houses and our graves must send Those that we bury back, our monuments Shall be the maws of kites.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
admired (adjective)	causing wonder; astonishing	*You have displaced the mirth, broke the good meeting, With most admired disorder.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hostess (noun)	a woman who receives and entertains guests	*Our hostess keeps her state, but in best time We will require her welcome.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

highness (noun)	a title of respect used to address a king	*Please't your highness To grace us with your royal company.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Complete Macbeth's words to the ghost: 'Thou canst not say…' [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: '…I did it: never shake thy gory locks at me.'
2. What news does the Murderer bring? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped
3. Who can see Banquo's ghost? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Only Macbeth
4. How does Lady Macbeth explain Macbeth's behavior? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He has had such fits since his youth
5. What does Macbeth say blood will have? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Blood
6. Which thane refused to come at Macbeth's bidding? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Macduff
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: At the state banquet a Murderer tells Macbeth that Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped. When Macbeth wishes Banquo were present, Banquo's ghost sits in his place, seen only by Macbeth, who cries 'Thou canst not say I did it.' Lady Macbeth explains it as a fit he has had since youth and scolds him ('Are you a man?'). The ghost returns; the feast breaks up in disorder. Afterwards Macbeth says 'blood…
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "O, these flaws and starts, Impostors to true fear, would well become A woman's story at a winter's fire, Authorized by her grandam." What does "grandam" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: grandam: a grandmother.

Inferential / analytical

1. 'I am in blood stepp'd in so far that, should I wade no more, returning were as tedious as go o'er.' What does this image show about Macbeth's choices now? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: He feels going back is as hard as going on; he chooses more violence.
2. What does “Act III, Scene IV” suggest about the ghost at the banquet? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control.
3. Find one example of symbolism in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the ghost at the banquet? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25)): Macbeth to the ghost. On characterization: Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “O proper stuff!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: At the state banquet a Murderer tells Macbeth that Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped. When Macbeth wishes Banquo were present, Banquo's ghost sits in his place, seen only by Macbeth, who cries 'Thou canst not say I did it.' Lady Macbeth explains it as a fit he has had since youth and scolds him…
7. How does “Act III, Scene IV” build on “Act III, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 47)): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 51)): Macbeth chooses to go on. On characterization: Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth

tries to cover for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25)): Macbeth to the ghost. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should the ghost be played by an actor or left empty? Which choice better shows Macbeth's mind? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A staging argument tied to the question of the supernatural.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 47)): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 51)): Macbeth chooses to go on. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25)): Macbeth to the ghost. On characterization: Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the ghost at the banquet. [DOK 4 ·

thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 47)): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 51)): Macbeth chooses to go on. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25)): Macbeth to the ghost. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the symbolism in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 47)): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene IV” treats the ghost at the banquet with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 51)): Macbeth chooses to go on. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 25)): Macbeth to the ghost. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the ghost at the banquet? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2]
    Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth (speech 47)): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. What news does the Murderer bring?
   A. Fleance is captured
   B. Both are dead
   C. Banquo escaped
   D. Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped
2. Who can see Banquo's ghost?
   A. Lady Macbeth
   B. Only Macbeth
   C. Everyone at the table
   D. Lennox and Ross
3. How does Lady Macbeth explain Macbeth's behavior?
   A. He is ill with fever
   B. He is drunk
   C. He has had such fits since his youth
   D. He has seen the Witches
4. What does Macbeth say blood will have?
   A. Justice from heaven
   B. Peace
   C. Blood

D. Mercy

5. Which thane refused to come at Macbeth's bidding?
   A. Macduff
   B. Angus
   C. Ross
   D. Lennox
6. In the line "O, these flaws and starts, Impostors to true fear, would well become A woman's story at a winter's fire, Authorized by her grandam.", what does "grandam" most nearly mean?
   A. a grandmother
   B. driven out
   C. someone without equal
   D. a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited
7. In the line "Thou art the best o' the cut-throats: yet he's good That did the like for Fleance: if thou didst it, Thou art the nonpareil.", what does "nonpareil" most nearly mean?
   A. driven out
   B. someone without equal
   C. a grandmother
   D. a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited

Answer key: 1. D (Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped); 2. B (Only Macbeth); 3. C (He has had such fits since his youth); 4. C (Blood); 5. A (Macduff); 6. A (a grandmother); 7. B (someone without equal)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act III, Scene IV," how does Shakespeare show the ghost at the banquet? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the ghost at the banquet? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of the ghost at the banquet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of the ghost at the banquet. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene IV suggests about the ghost at the banquet. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's symbolism and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses symbolism in Act III, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of the ghost at the banquet. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act III, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the ghost at the banquet responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act III, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the ghost at the banquet follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene IV and its treatment of the ghost at the banquet. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's symbolism and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about the ghost at the banquet in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the ghost at the banquet. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *If charnel-houses and our graves must send Those that we bury back, our monuments Shall be the maws of kites.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “charnel” most nearly mean?

   A. causing wonder; astonishing

   B. a woman who receives and entertains guests

   C. a title of respect used to address a king

   D. a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited

2. *O proper stuff! This is the very painting of your fear: This is the air-drawn dagger which, you said, Led you to Duncan. O, these flaws and starts, Impostors to true fear, would well become A woman's story at a winter's fire, Authorized by her grandam. Shame itself! Why do you make such faces? When all's done, You look but on a stool.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene IV"?

A. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

B. The ghost at the banquet

C. The moving wood

D. The Witches' riddling world

SAT key: 1. D (a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited); 2. B (The ghost at the banquet)

Lesson 18: Act III, Scene V

Focus: Hecate and the machinery of fate

Teacher only · spoilers

Hecate angrily scolds the Witches, 'beldams' who are 'saucy and overbold,' for trading with Macbeth in riddles without her, for a 'wayward son' who loves for his own ends. She orders them to meet her at the pit of Acheron in the morning, where Macbeth will come to know his destiny, and plans illusions that will draw him on to his confusion. 'Security is mortals' chiefest enemy.'

Background: Most editors think this scene (in rhyming tetrameter and calling for a song found in Thomas Middleton's play The Witch) was added after Shakespeare's death, perhaps for a revival.

Significance: Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....*
> **Prompt:** Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy."

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: overbold — too bold; presumptuous; wayward — stubborn and self-willed; riddles — puzzling questions with hidden answers; traffic — to deal or trade with; vessels — containers.*
> **Words:** overbold: too bold; presumptuous · wayward: stubborn and self-willed · riddles: puzzling questions with hidden answers · traffic: to deal or trade with · vessels: containers

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Most editors think this scene (in rhyming tetrameter and calling for a song found in Thomas Middleton's play The Witch) was added after Shakespeare's death, perhaps for a revival. Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions. Characterization: Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence). Structure: The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton. Diction / vocabulary: Rhyming tetrameter like the witches'. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "scorn death, and bear / He hopes 'bove wisdom, grace and fear: / And you all know, security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy. Music and" (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Saucy and overbold" (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)). Hecate's complaint. That is characterization at work: Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence).

> *Saucy and overbold* (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Saucy and overbold" (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)). Hecate's complaint. That is characterization at work: Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence).

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Security" meant overconfidence. It foreshadows the apparitions. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." (Overconfidence.)

> *And you all know, security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy* (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Security" meant overconfidence. It foreshadows the apparitions.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." (Overconfidence.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Hecate and the machinery of fate? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene V develops the idea of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. When the text says “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)), it shows this directly. She says "security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" and that Macbeth will "spurn fate, scorn death."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Hecate and the machinery of fate? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene V develops the idea of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. When the text says “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)), it shows this directly. She says "security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" and that Macbeth will "spurn fate, scorn death."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When? Discuss the authorship question and whether to cut the scene.
Anchor question: Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When?
Facilitation: Discuss the authorship question and whether to cut the scene.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Hecate and the machinery of fate? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. (“He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear”, Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Hecate and the machinery of fate? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. (“He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear”, Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Hecate and the machinery of fate. Key takeaway: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence).
- **Structure:** The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Rhyming tetrameter like the witches'.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “scorn death, and bear / He hopes ’bove wisdom, grace and fear: / And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy. Music and” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)).
- **darkness and light:** Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder. In this scene: “and every thing beside. / I am for the air; this night I’ll spend / Unto a dismal and a fatal end: / Great business” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)) Overconfidence.
- “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)) Hecate's complaint.
- “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)) Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence.
Evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2))
Reasoning: She says "security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" and that Macbeth will "spurn fate, scorn death."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
overbold (adjective)	too bold; presumptuous	*Have I not reason, beldams as you are, Saucy and overbold?*	

			Student look-up (not yet verified)
wayward (adjective)	stubborn and self-willed	*And, which is worse, all you have done Hath been but for a wayward son, Spiteful and wrathful, who, as others do, Loves for his own ends, not for you.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
riddles (noun)	puzzling questions with hidden answers	*How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
traffic (verb)	to deal or trade with	*How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vessels (noun)	containers	*But make amends now: get you gone, And at the pit of Acheron Meet me i' the morning: thither he Will come to know his destiny: Your vessels and your spells provide, Your charms and every thing beside.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
delinquents (noun)	offenders	*How it did grieve Macbeth! did he not straight In pious rage the two delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and thralls of sleep?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bestows (verb)	lodges (himself); places	*But, peace! for from broad words and 'cause he fail'd His presence at the tyrant's feast, I hear Macduff lives in disgrace: sir, can you tell Where he bestows himself?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
accursed (adjective)	under a curse	*Some holy angel Fly to the court of England and unfold His message ere he come, that a swift blessing May soon return to this our suffering country Under a hand accursed!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Hecate call the Witches when she scolds them? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Beldams, saucy and overbold.
2. Why is Hecate angry with the Witches? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: They dealt with Macbeth without her
3. What does Hecate call Macbeth? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A wayward son
4. Where will they meet in the morning? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The pit of Acheron
5. What does Hecate say is mortals' chiefest enemy? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Security, or overconfidence
6. What will Hecate use to draw Macbeth on? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Illusions raised by magic
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Hecate angrily scolds the Witches, 'beldams' who are 'saucy and overbold,' for trading with Macbeth in riddles without her, for a 'wayward son' who loves for his own ends. She orders them to meet her at the pit of Acheron in the morning, where Macbeth will come to know his destiny, and plans illusions that will draw him on to his confusion. 'Security is mortals' chiefest enemy.'
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene V" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Have I not reason, beldams as you are, Saucy and overbold?" What does "overbold" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: overbold: too bold; presumptuous.

Inferential / analytical

1. How does the verse of this scene differ from the rest of the play, and why does that matter to editors? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Rhyming tetrameter and songs suggest a later addition, probably by Middleton.
2. What does "Act III, Scene V" suggest about Hecate and the machinery of fate? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the foreshadowing in this scene shape what we understand about Hecate and the machinery of fate? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Overconfidence. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “A Heath.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Hecate angrily scolds the Witches, 'beldams' who are 'saucy and overbold,' for trading with Macbeth in riddles without her, for a 'wayward son' who loves for his own ends. She orders them to meet her at the pit of Acheron in the morning, where Macbeth will come to know his destiny, and plans…
7. How does “Act III, Scene V” build on “Act III, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Hecate's complaint. On structure: The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. On characterization: Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Overconfidence. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. If this scene was not written by Shakespeare, should productions cut it? Argue for keeping or cutting it. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment balancing authorship and dramatic effect.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own

overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Hecate's complaint. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Overconfidence. On characterization: Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Hecate and the machinery of fate. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Hecate's complaint. On structure: The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Overconfidence. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Hecate's complaint. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act III, Scene V” treats Hecate and the machinery of fate with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene VI” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Overconfidence. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Hecate and the machinery of fate? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate (speech 2)): Hecate's complaint. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. Why is Hecate angry with the Witches?
   A. They left Scotland
   B. They dealt with Macbeth without her
   C. They lied to Macbeth
   D. They killed Banquo

2. What does Hecate call Macbeth?
   A. A noble king
   B. A wayward son
   C. A brave soldier
   D. An innocent man
3. Where will they meet in the morning?
   A. Birnam Wood
   B. Inverness castle
   C. The English court
   D. The pit of Acheron
4. What does Hecate say is mortals' chiefest enemy?
   A. Love
   B. Fear
   C. Time
   D. Security, or overconfidence
5. What will Hecate use to draw Macbeth on?
   A. Poison
   B. A letter
   C. An army
   D. Illusions raised by magic
6. In the line “Have I not reason, beldams as you are, Saucy and overbold?”, what does “overbold” most nearly mean?
   A. to deal or trade with
   B. stubborn and self-willed
   C. too bold; presumptuous
   D. puzzling questions with hidden answers
7. In the line “And, which is worse, all you have done Hath been but for a wayward son, Spiteful and wrathful, who, as others do, Loves for his own ends, not for you.”, what does “wayward” most nearly mean?
   A. stubborn and self-willed
   B. puzzling questions with hidden answers
   C. too bold; presumptuous
   D. to deal or trade with

Answer key: 1. B (They dealt with Macbeth without her); 2. B (A wayward son); 3. D (The pit of Acheron); 4. D (Security, or overconfidence); 5. D (Illusions raised by magic); 6. C (too bold; presumptuous); 7. A (stubborn and self-willed)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act III, Scene V," how does Shakespeare show Hecate and the machinery of fate? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Hecate and the machinery of fate? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene V develops the idea of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene V suggests about Hecate and the machinery of fate. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act III, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act III, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Hecate and the machinery of fate responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act III, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Hecate and the machinery of fate follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene V and its treatment of Hecate and the machinery of fate. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about Hecate and the machinery of fate in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "riddles" most nearly mean?

   A. puzzling questions with hidden answers

   B. under a curse

   C. offenders

   D. lodges (himself); places

2. *A Heath.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene V"?

   A. The apparitions and false security

   B. The last false confidence

   C. Hecate and the machinery of fate

   D. The army reveals itself

SAT key: 1. A (puzzling questions with hidden answers); 2. C (Hecate and the machinery of fate)

Lesson 19: Act III, Scene VI

Focus: suspicion spoken through irony

Teacher only · spoilers

Lennox, speaking with heavy irony, lists the 'convenient' deaths and flights: how the 'right-valiant' Banquo walked too late, how Fleance must have killed his father because he fled, how wisely Macbeth killed the grooms. A Lord reports that Malcolm lives at the English court of the holy King Edward, that Macduff has gone to ask Edward to rouse Northumberland and Siward, and that Macbeth prepares for war.

Background: Edward the Confessor (reigned 1042 to 1066) was revered as a saintly king; contrasting him with Macbeth sets holy kingship against tyranny.

Significance: Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....
Prompt: Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: speech must be guarded under tyranny.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: delinquents — offenders; bestows — lodges (himself); places; accursed — under a curse; caution — a warning; care to avoid danger; gracious — kind and good.
Words: delinquents: offenders · bestows: lodges (himself); places · accursed: under a curse · caution: a warning; care to avoid danger · gracious: kind and good

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Edward the Confessor (reigned 1042 to 1066) was revered as a saintly king; contrasting him with Macbeth sets holy kingship against tyranny. Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony. Irony: Lennox speaks sarcastically about Duncan and Banquo's "deaths," exposing Macbeth's guilt. Characterization: Macduff has gone to England to seek help. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "high respect: thither Macduff / Is gone to pray the holy king, upon his aid / To wake Northumberland and warlike Siward: / That, by" (Act III, Scene VI, Lord (speech 2)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)). Understatement. That is irony at work: Lennox speaks sarcastically about Duncan and Banquo's "deaths," exposing Macbeth's guilt.

> *Things have been strangely borne* (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)). Understatement. That is irony at work: Lennox speaks sarcastically about Duncan and Banquo's "deaths," exposing Macbeth's guilt.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Marry" means indeed; Lennox mocks the official story. Appearance and reality. Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality? Expected: Speech must be guarded under tyranny. (Irony.)

> *The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead* (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Marry" means indeed; Lennox mocks the official story. Appearance and reality.
Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality?
Expected answer: Speech must be guarded under tyranny. (Irony.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene VI develops the idea of suspicion spoken through irony. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. When the text says "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)), it shows this directly. He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.
Task: Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene VI develops the idea of suspicion spoken through irony. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. When the text says "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)), it shows this directly. He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power? Ask: when do people speak in irony instead of directly?
Anchor question: Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power?
Facilitation: Ask: when do people speak in irony instead of directly?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. ("The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead", Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. ("The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead", Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how irony shapes suspicion spoken through irony. Key takeaway: speech must be guarded under tyranny.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Lennox speaks sarcastically about Duncan and Banquo's "deaths," exposing Macbeth's guilt.
- **Characterization:** Macduff has gone to England to seek help.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** speech must be guarded under tyranny.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “high respect: thither Macduff / Is gone to pray the holy king, upon his aid / To wake Northumberland and warlike Siward: / That, by” (Act III, Scene VI, Lord (speech 2)).
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: “sleep to our nights, / Free from our feasts and banquets bloody knives, / Do faithful homage and receive free honours: / All which we” (Act III, Scene VI, Lord (speech 2)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)) Irony.
- “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)) Understatement.
- “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 5)) Scotland under tyranny.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly.
Evidence: “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1))
Reasoning: He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
	offenders		

delinquents (noun)		*How it did grieve Macbeth! did he not straight In pious rage the two delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and thralls of sleep?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bestows (verb)	lodges (himself); places	*But, peace! for from broad words and 'cause he fail'd His presence at the tyrant's feast, I hear Macduff lives in disgrace: sir, can you tell Where he bestows himself?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
accursed (adjective)	under a curse	*Some holy angel Fly to the court of England and unfold His message ere he come, that a swift blessing May soon return to this our suffering country Under a hand accursed!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
caution (noun)	a warning; care to avoid danger	*And that well might Advise him to a caution, to hold what distance His wisdom can provide.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
gracious (adjective)	kind and good	*The gracious Duncan Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead: And the right-valiant Banquo walk'd too late; Whom, you may say, if't please you, Fleance kill'd, For Fleance fled: men must not walk too late.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
interpret (verb)	to explain the meaning of	*My former speeches have but hit your thoughts, Which can interpret further: only, I say, Things have been strangely borne.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
scepters (noun)	rods carried by kings as a sign of power	*I'll see no more: And yet the eighth appears, who bears a glass Which shows me many more; and some I see That two-fold balls and treble scepters carry: Horrible sight!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pricking (noun)	a tingling feeling	*By the pricking of my thumbs, Something wicked this way comes.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whom does Lennox say Fleance must have killed, since he fled? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His father, Banquo (said ironically).
2. How does Lennox speak about the recent deaths? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: With irony, hinting that Macbeth is guilty
3. Where is Malcolm living? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: At the English court of King Edward
4. Where has Macduff gone? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To England to seek help
5. Whom does Macduff hope Edward will rouse? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Northumberland and warlike Siward
6. How do Lennox and the Lord now refer to Macbeth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: As a tyrant
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene VI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lennox, speaking with heavy irony, lists the 'convenient' deaths and flights: how the 'right-valiant' Banquo walked too late, how Fleance must have killed his father because he fled, how wisely Macbeth killed the grooms. A Lord reports that Malcolm lives at the English court of the holy King Edward, that Macduff has gone to ask Edward to rouse Northumberland and Siward, and that Macbeth prepares…
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene VI", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene VI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "How it did grieve Macbeth! did he not straight In pious rage the two delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and thralls of sleep?" What does "delinquents" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: delinquents: offenders.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Lennox never say directly that Macbeth is a murderer? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Speaking openly under a tyrant is dangerous; irony protects him.
2. What does "Act III, Scene VI" suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about suspicion spoken through irony? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was

dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)): Irony. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins "And that well might Advise him to a caution, to hold what distance His wisdom can provide.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act III, Scene VI", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Lennox, speaking with heavy irony, lists the 'convenient' deaths and flights: how the 'right-valiant' Banquo walked too late, how Fleance must have killed his father because he fled, how wisely Macbeth killed the grooms. A Lord reports that Malcolm lives at the English court of the holy King…
7. How does "Act III, Scene VI" build on "Act III, Scene V"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: "Things have been strangely borne" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)): Understatement. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: "this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 5)): Scotland under tyranny. On characterization: Macduff has gone to England to seek help. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: "Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)): Irony. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is irony a form of courage or a way of avoiding risk? Judge Lennox. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment about indirect resistance.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can

only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)): Understatement. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 5)): Scotland under tyranny. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)): Irony. On characterization: Macduff has gone to England to seek help. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene VI”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of suspicion spoken through irony. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)): Understatement. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 5)): Scotland under tyranny. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)): Irony. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)): Understatement. On irony: Lennox speaks sarcastically about Duncan and Banquo's "deaths," exposing Macbeth's guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act III, Scene VI” treats suspicion spoken through irony with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 5)): Scotland under tyranny. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)): Irony. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about suspicion spoken through irony? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox (speech 1)): Understatement. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz

1. How does Lennox speak about the recent deaths?
   A. With praise for Macbeth
   B. With grief and no suspicion
   C. In a letter to Malcolm

D. With irony, hinting that Macbeth is guilty

2. Where is Malcolm living?
   A. At the English court of King Edward
   B. In Fife
   C. In Ireland
   D. In Norway
3. Where has Macduff gone?
   A. To fight in Ireland
   B. To Inverness
   C. To Scone
   D. To England to seek help
4. Whom does Macduff hope Edward will rouse?
   A. The Witches
   B. Donalbain and Fleance
   C. The King of Norway
   D. Northumberland and warlike Siward
5. How do Lennox and the Lord now refer to Macbeth?
   A. As a saint
   B. As a tyrant
   C. As a weak king
   D. As a stranger
6. In the line "How it did grieve Macbeth! did he not straight In pious rage the two delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and thralls of sleep?", what does "delinquents" most nearly mean?
   A. under a curse
   B. offenders
   C. lodges (himself); places
   D. a warning; care to avoid danger
7. In the line "But, peace! for from broad words and 'cause he fail'd His presence at the tyrant's feast, I hear Macduff lives in disgrace: sir, can you tell Where he bestows himself?", what does "bestows" most nearly mean?
   A. under a curse
   B. offenders
   C. lodges (himself); places
   D. a warning; care to avoid danger

Answer key: 1. D (With irony, hinting that Macbeth is guilty); 2. A (At the English court of King Edward); 3. D (To England to seek help); 4. D (Northumberland and warlike Siward); 5. B (As a tyrant); 6. B (offenders); 7. C (lodges (himself); places)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act III, Scene VI," how does Shakespeare show suspicion spoken through irony? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene VI, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of suspicion spoken through irony? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene VI develops the idea of suspicion spoken through irony. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of suspicion spoken through irony. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene VI suggests about suspicion spoken through irony. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act III, Scene VI to complicate the reader's understanding of suspicion spoken through irony. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act III, Scene VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of suspicion spoken through irony responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act III, Scene VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of suspicion spoken through irony follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene VI and its treatment of suspicion spoken through irony. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene VI as evidence for a larger claim about suspicion spoken through irony in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene VI as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of suspicion spoken through irony. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Some holy angel Fly to the court of England and unfold His message ere he come, that a swift blessing May soon return to this our suffering country Under a hand accursed!*

   As used in the text, what does the word “accursed” most nearly mean?

   A. to explain the meaning of

   B. under a curse

   C. a tingling feeling

   D. rods carried by kings as a sign of power

2. *And that well might Advise him to a caution, to hold what distance His wisdom can provide. Some holy angel Fly to the court of England and unfold His message ere he come, that a swift blessing May soon return to this our suffering country Under a hand accursed!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene VI”?

   A. The murder and its first guilt

   B. Lady Macbeth's resolve

   C. The moving wood

   D. Suspicion spoken through irony

SAT key: 1. B (under a curse); 2. D (Suspicion spoken through irony)

Lesson 20: Act IV, Scene I

Focus: the apparitions and false security

Teacher only · spoilers

The Witches brew their potion ('Double, double toil and trouble'). Macbeth demands answers. Three apparitions warn him to beware Macduff (an armed head), tell him none of woman born shall harm him (a bloody child), and that he will never be vanquished until Great Birnam Wood comes to high Dunsinane Hill (a child crowned, with a tree in his hand). He then sees a show of eight kings followed by Banquo's ghost, the last king holding a glass. Learning from Lennox that Macduff has fled to England, Macbeth vows to seize Fife and kill his wife and children.

Background: The line of eight kings honors the Stuart ancestors of James I; the glass (mirror) may have reflected King James himself if he watched a performance.

Significance: Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.'

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: scepters — rods carried by kings as a sign of power; pricking — a tingling feeling; calendar — a table of the days of the year; vanquish — to defeat completely; exploits — bold deeds.
Words: scepters: rods carried by kings as a sign of power · pricking: a tingling feeling · calendar: a table of the days of the year · vanquish: to defeat completely · exploits: bold deeds

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The line of eight kings honors the Stuart ancestors of James I; the glass (mirror) may have reflected King James himself if he watched a performance. Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.' Imagery: The cauldron's recipe ("Eye of newt, and toe of frog"): grotesque catalogue of body parts. Structure: Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle. Dramatic irony: The audience can guess the tricks (a man not "of woman born," the wood that moves); Macbeth cannot. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "art, for thy good caution, thanks; / Thou hast harp'd my fear aright: but one word more" (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 26)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, All (speech 5)). The chant; trochaic rhythm. That is imagery at work: The cauldron's recipe ("Eye of newt, and toe of frog"): grotesque catalogue of body parts.

> *Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble* (Act IV, Scene I, All (speech 5))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, All (speech 5)). The chant; trochaic rhythm. That is imagery at work: The cauldron's recipe ("Eye of newt, and toe of frog"): grotesque catalogue of body parts.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Firstlings" means first-born; he will act on impulse. Equivocation and fate. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: The riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. (The equivocal prophecy.)

> *none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth* (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition (speech 30))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Firstlings" means first-born; he will act on impulse. Equivocation and fate.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: The riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. (The equivocal prophecy.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for imagery, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the apparitions and false security? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the apparitions and false security. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. When the text says “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition (speech 30)), it shows this directly. Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the apparitions and false security? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the apparitions and false security. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. When the text says “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition (speech 30)), it shows this directly. Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it? Ask: why does Macbeth kill Macduff's family if he believes he is safe?

Anchor question: Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?

Facilitation: Ask: why does Macbeth kill Macduff's family if he believes he is safe?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the apparitions and false security? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. ("none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth", Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition (speech 30)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the apparitions and false security? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. ("none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth", Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition (speech 30)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the apparitions and false security. Key takeaway: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The cauldron's recipe ("Eye of newt, and toe of frog"): grotesque catalogue of body parts.
- **Structure:** Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle.
- **Dramatic irony:** The audience can guess the tricks (a man not "of woman born," the wood that moves); Macbeth cannot.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "art, for thy good caution, thanks; / Thou hast harp'd my fear aright: but one word more" (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 26)).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "Macbeth! Macbeth! Macbeth! beware Macduff; / Beware the thane of Fife. Dismiss me. Enough. Descends" (Act IV, Scene I, First Apparition (speech 25)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, All (speech 5)) The chant; trochaic rhythm.
- "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition (speech 30)) The equivocal prophecy.
- "The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand" (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 53)) Macbeth will act without thought.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime.
Evidence: "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition (speech 30))
Reasoning: Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
scepters (noun)	rods carried by kings as a sign of power	*I'll see no more: And yet the eighth appears, who bears a glass Which shows me many more; and some I see That two-fold balls and treble scepters carry: Horrible sight!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pricking (noun)	a tingling feeling	*By the pricking of my thumbs, Something wicked this way comes.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
calendar (noun)	a table of the days of the year	*Let this pernicious hour Stand aye accursed in the calendar!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vanquish (verb)	to defeat completely	*Be lion-mettled, proud; and take no care Who chafes, who frets, or where conspirers are: Macbeth shall never vanquish'd be until Great Birnam wood to high Dunsinane hill Shall come against him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
exploits (noun)	bold deeds	*Time, thou anticipatest my dread exploits: The flighty purpose never is o'ertook Unless the deed go with it: from this moment The very firstlings of my heart shall be The firstlings of my hand.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
boasting (noun)	bragging	*No boasting like a fool; This deed I'll do before this purpose cool.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
impress (verb)	to force into service; also, to cut into or mark	*That will never be: Who can impress the forest, bid the tree Unfix his earth-bound root?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
	under a curse	*Let this pernicious hour Stand aye accursed in the calendar!*	

accursed (adjective)			Student look-up (not yet verified)
caution (noun)	a warning; care to avoid danger	*What'er thou art, for thy good caution, thanks; Thou hast harp'd my fear aright: but one word more—*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the Second Witch say just before Macbeth enters? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: 'By the pricking of my thumbs, something wicked this way comes.'
2. What does the first apparition, an armed head, warn? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Beware Macduff
3. What does the bloody child say? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: None of woman born shall harm Macbeth
4. Until what happens will Macbeth never be vanquished? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Birnam Wood comes to Dunsinane
5. What does the show of eight kings reveal? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Banquo's descendants will rule
6. What does Macbeth decide after hearing Macduff has fled? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To kill Macduff's wife and children
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The Witches brew their potion ('Double, double toil and trouble'). Macbeth demands answers. Three apparitions warn him to beware Macduff (an armed head), tell him none of woman born shall harm him (a bloody child), and that he will never be vanquished until Great Birnam Wood comes to high Dunsinane Hill (a child crowned, with a tree in his hand). He then sees a show of eight kings followed by…
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “Act IV, Scene I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I’ll see no more: And yet the eighth appears, who bears a glass Which shows me many more; and some I see That two-fold balls and treble scepters carry: Horrible sight!” What does “scepters” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: scepters: rods carried by kings as a sign of power.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macbeth feel safe after the apparitions, even though the first one warned him? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: He trusts the reassuring riddles and ignores the warning: overconfidence.
2. What does Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family show about how his violence has changed? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: It is now reflexive and pointless, aimed at the innocent.
3. What does “Act IV, Scene I” suggest about the apparitions and false security? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.'
4. Find one example of foreshadowing in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
5. How does the symbolism in this scene shape what we understand about the apparitions and false security? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All (speech 5)): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins “That will never be: Who can impress the forest, bid the tree Unfix his earth-bound root?”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: The Witches brew their potion ('Double, double toil and trouble'). Macbeth demands answers. Three apparitions warn him to beware Macduff (an armed head), tell him none of woman born shall harm him (a bloody child), and that he will never be vanquished until Great Birnam Wood comes to high Dunsinane…
8. How does “Act IV, Scene I” build on “Act III, Scene VI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition (speech 30)): The equivocal prophecy. On structure: Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a

riddle. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 53)): Macbeth will act without thought. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Are the Witches' prophecies lies? Argue whether deceiving with literal truth is worse than lying. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment about deception through literal truth.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All (speech 5)): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.'” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition (speech 30)): The equivocal prophecy. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 53)): Macbeth will act without thought. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the apparitions and false security. [DOK 4 ·

thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All (speech 5)): The chant; trochaic rhythm. On structure: Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition (speech 30)): The equivocal prophecy. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 53)): Macbeth will act without thought. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the foreshadowing in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All (speech 5)): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene I” treats the apparitions and false security with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition (speech 30)): The equivocal prophecy. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth (speech 53)): Macbeth will act without thought. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the apparitions and false security? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All (speech 5)): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. What does the first apparition, an armed head, warn?
    A. Beware Banquo
    B. Trust Lady Macbeth
    C. Beware Macduff
    D. Fear no man
2. What does the bloody child say?
    A. Macbeth will die tonight
    B. None of woman born shall harm Macbeth
    C. Fleance will be king
    D. Macduff is dead
3. Until what happens will Macbeth never be vanquished?
    A. Birnam Wood comes to Dunsinane
    B. Banquo returns
    C. The sun sets at noon
    D. Malcolm returns
4. What does the show of eight kings reveal?
    A. Banquo's descendants will rule
    B. Duncan's line is ended
    C. England will conquer Scotland

D. Macbeth's sons will rule

5. What does Macbeth decide after hearing Macduff has fled?
   A. To give up the crown
   B. To follow him to England
   C. To pardon Macduff
   D. To kill Macduff's wife and children
6. In the line "I'll see no more: And yet the eighth appears, who bears a glass Which shows me many more; and some I see That two-fold balls and treble scepters carry: Horrible sight!", what does "scepters" most nearly mean?
   A. to defeat completely
   B. a table of the days of the year
   C. rods carried by kings as a sign of power
   D. a tingling feeling
7. In the line "By the pricking of my thumbs, Something wicked this way comes.", what does "pricking" most nearly mean?
   A. a tingling feeling
   B. to defeat completely
   C. a table of the days of the year
   D. rods carried by kings as a sign of power

Answer key: 1. C (Beware Macduff); 2. B (None of woman born shall harm Macbeth); 3. A (Birnam Wood comes to Dunsinane); 4. A (Banquo's descendants will rule); 5. D (To kill Macduff's wife and children); 6. C (rods carried by kings as a sign of power); 7. A (a tingling feeling)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act IV, Scene I," how does Shakespeare show the apparitions and false security? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the apparitions and false security? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the apparitions and false security. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the

apparitions and false security. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene I suggests about the apparitions and false security. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's foreshadowing and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses foreshadowing in Act IV, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the apparitions and false security. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act IV, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the apparitions and false security responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act IV, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the apparitions and false security follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene I and its treatment of the apparitions and false security. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's foreshadowing and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the apparitions and false security in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the apparitions and false security. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Let this pernicious hour Stand aye accursed in the calendar!*

   As used in the text, what does the word “calendar” most nearly mean?

   A. a table of the days of the year

   B. to force into service; also, to cut into or mark

   C. a warning; care to avoid danger

D. under a curse

2. *That will never be: Who can impress the forest, bid the tree Unfix his earth-bound root? Sweet bodements! good! Rebellion's head, rise never till the wood Of Birnam rise, and our high-placed Macbeth Shall live the lease of nature, pay his breath To time and mortal custom. Yet my heart Throbs to know one thing: tell me, if your art Can tell so much: shall Banquo's issue ever Reign in this kingdom?*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene I"?

A. The apparitions and false security

B. Defiance and despair

C. Lady Macbeth's resolve

D. The guilt that will not wash away

SAT key: 1. A (a table of the days of the year); 2. A (The apparitions and false security)

Lesson 21: Act IV, Scene II

Focus: the murder of the innocent

Content note (murder of a child, violence against a mother): A child is stabbed on stage and his mother pursued by murderers. Some students may have experienced violence or loss; allow a pass on reading aloud and consider presenting the moment in summary.
Student preview: This scene shows a child and his mother attacked by murderers.
Suggested language: "What does this scene show about what Macbeth has become?"

Teacher only · spoilers

At Fife, Lady Macduff tells Ross that her husband's flight was madness and that he loves them not; Ross defends him as wise and leaves. She tells her son his father is dead and a traitor; the clever boy banters that the liars and swearers are enough to beat the honest men and hang them up. A messenger warns her to flee. Murderers enter, call Macduff a traitor, and stab the boy ('He has kill'd me, mother'); she runs out crying 'Murder!' and is pursued.

Background: The scene is one of very few in Shakespeare to show a child killed on stage. It is the moment many audiences turn wholly against Macbeth.

Significance: The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because.... Content note before we start: This scene shows a child and his mother attacked by murderers.
Prompt: Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: pitfall — a trap for catching birds; diminutive — tiny; smallest; laudable — praiseworthy; traitors — people who betray their country; methinks — it seems to me.
Words: pitfall: a trap for catching birds · diminutive: tiny; smallest · laudable: praiseworthy · traitors: people who betray their country · methinks: it seems to me

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The scene is one of very few in Shakespeare to show a child killed on stage. It is the moment many audiences turn wholly against Macbeth. The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family. Characterization: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave. Dramatic irony: A messenger warns them too late; murderers arrive. Structure: The only domestic scene in the play: innocence slaughtered. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "You know not / Whether it was his wisdom or his fear" (Act IV, Scene II, Ross (speech 4)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch" (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff (speech 5)). Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. That is characterization at work: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave.

> *He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch* (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff (speech 5))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch" (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff (speech 5)). Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. That is characterization at work: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The child's joke is true in Macbeth's Scotland: the liars rule. Masculinity and power. Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." (The son's wit.)

> *Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them* (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 30))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The child's joke is true in Macbeth's Scotland: the liars rule. Masculinity and power.
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected answer: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." (The son's wit.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the murder of the innocent? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of the murder of the innocent. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. When the text says "Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them" (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 30)), it shows this directly. The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the murder of the innocent? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of the murder of the innocent. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. When the text says "Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them" (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 30)), it shows this directly. The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause? Content note: a child is killed on stage. Ask how staging choices affect the audience.
Anchor question: Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause?
Facilitation: Content note: a child is killed on stage. Ask how staging choices affect the audience.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the murder of the innocent? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. ("Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them", Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 30)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the murder of the innocent? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. ("Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them", Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 30)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the murder of the innocent. Key takeaway: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not."*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave.
- **Dramatic irony:** A messenger warns them too late; murderers arrive.
- **Structure:** The only domestic scene in the play: innocence slaughtered.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “You know not / Whether it was his wisdom or his fear” (Act IV, Scene II, Ross (speech 4)).
- **equivocation:** "Fair is foul": appearances and words that mean two things, from the witches to the Porter to the prophecies. In this scene: “Bless you, fair dame! I am not to you known, / Though in your state” (Act IV, Scene II, Messenger (speech 34)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff (speech 5)) Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight.
- “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 30)) The son's wit.
- “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 41)) The son's death.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny.
> **Evidence:** “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 30))
> **Reasoning:** The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	

	Definition (in this sentence)		Word history
pitfall (noun)	a trap for catching birds	*Poor bird! thou'ldst never fear the net nor lime, The pitfall nor the gin.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
diminutive (adjective)	tiny; smallest	*He loves us not; He wants the natural touch: for the poor wren, The most diminutive of birds, will fight, Her young ones in her nest, against the owl.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
laudable (adjective)	praiseworthy	*But I remember now I am in this earthly world; where to do harm Is often laudable, to do good sometime Accounted dangerous folly: why then, alas, Do I put up that womanly defence, To say I have done no harm?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
traitors (noun)	people who betray their country	*He had none: His flight was madness: when our actions do not, Our fears do make us traitors.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
methinks (verb)	it seems to me	*To fright you thus, methinks, I am too savage; To do worse to you were fell cruelty, Which is too nigh your person.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sometime (adverb)	sometimes; at times	*But I remember now I am in this earthly world; where to do harm Is often laudable, to do good sometime Accounted dangerous folly: why then, alas, Do I put up that womanly defence, To say I have done no harm?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
transpose (verb)	to change	*But I shall crave your pardon; That which you are my thoughts cannot transpose: Angels are bright still, though the brightest fell: Though all things foul would wear the brows of grace, Yet grace must still look so.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hoodwink (verb)	to deceive; to blind	*But fear not yet To take upon you what is yours: you may Convey your pleasures in a spacious plenty, And yet seem cold, the time you may so hoodwink.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the son say about liars and swearers? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: They are fools: there are enough of them to beat the honest men and hang them up.
2. What does Lady Macduff think of her husband's flight? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It was madness, and he loves his family not
3. Who visits her and then leaves? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Ross
4. What does she tell her son about his father? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: That he is dead and a traitor
5. What happens to the son? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The murderers kill him
6. Who warns her to flee? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: An unnamed messenger
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: At Fife, Lady Macduff tells Ross that her husband's flight was madness and that he loves them not; Ross defends him as wise and leaves. She tells her son his father is dead and a traitor; the clever boy banters that the liars and swearers are enough to beat the honest men and hang them up. A messenger warns her to flee. Murderers enter, call Macduff a traitor, and stab the boy ('He has kill'd me,…
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Poor bird! thou'ldst never fear the net nor lime, The pitfall nor the gin." What does "pitfall" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: pitfall: a trap for catching birds.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Shakespeare give the boy such clever, funny lines just before his death? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: It makes him vivid and the loss more painful: innocence against tyranny.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene II" suggest about the murder of the innocent? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the murder of the innocent? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: "He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch" (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff (speech 5)): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. On characterization: Lady Macduff and her

son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Wisdom!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: At Fife, Lady Macduff tells Ross that her husband's flight was madness and that he loves them not; Ross defends him as wise and leaves. She tells her son his father is dead and a traitor; the clever boy banters that the liars and swearers are enough to beat the honest men and hang them up. A…
7. How does “Act IV, Scene II” build on “Act IV, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 30)): The son's wit. On structure: The only domestic scene in the play: innocence slaughtered. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 41)): The son's death. On characterization: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff (speech 5)): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should this scene be staged in full or with the violence offstage? Defend your choice, considering the audience. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A staging judgment balancing impact and care.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and

swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them" (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 30)): The son's wit. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: "The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: "He has kill'd me, mother" (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 41)): The son's death. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: "He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch" (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff (speech 5)): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. On characterization: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing "Act IV, Scene II". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the murder of the innocent. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: "Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them" (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 30)): The son's wit. On structure: The only domestic scene in the play: innocence slaughtered. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about "Act IV, Scene II": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: "He has kill'd me, mother" (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 41)): The son's death. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: "He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch" (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff (speech 5)): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her

husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 30)): The son's wit. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene II” treats the murder of the innocent with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He has kill'd me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 41)): The son's death. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff (speech 5)): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the murder of the innocent? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son (speech 30)): The son's wit. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. What does Lady Macduff think of her husband's flight?
   A. It was wise and brave
   B. It was ordered by the king
   C. It was madness, and he loves his family not
   D. It was a trick
2. Who visits her and then leaves?
   A. Malcolm
   B. Lennox
   C. Banquo's ghost
   D. Ross
3. What does she tell her son about his father?
   A. That he is in prison
   B. That he is king
   C. That he will return tonight
   D. That he is dead and a traitor
4. What happens to the son?
   A. He escapes to England
   B. The murderers kill him
   C. He is taken prisoner
   D. He kills a murderer
5. Who warns her to flee?
   A. Macduff
   B. An unnamed messenger
   C. Malcolm
   D. Macbeth
6. In the line “Poor bird! thou’ldst never fear the net nor lime, The pitfall nor the gin.”, what does “pitfall” most nearly mean?
   A. people who betray their country
   B. praiseworthy
   C. tiny; smallest
   D. a trap for catching birds
7. In the line “He loves us not; He wants the natural touch: for the poor wren, The most diminutive of birds, will fight, Her young ones in her nest, against the owl.”, what does “diminutive” most nearly mean?
   A. praiseworthy
   B. tiny; smallest
   C. people who betray their country
   D. a trap for catching birds

Answer key: 1. C (It was madness, and he loves his family not); 2. D (Ross); 3. D (That he is dead and a traitor); 4. B (The murderers kill him); 5. B (An unnamed messenger); 6. D (a trap for catching birds); 7. B (tiny; smallest)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act IV, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show the murder of the innocent? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the murder of the innocent? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of the murder of the innocent. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the murder of the innocent. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene II suggests about the murder of the innocent. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act IV, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the murder of the innocent. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act IV, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the murder of the innocent responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act IV, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the murder of the innocent follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene II and its treatment of the murder of the innocent. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the murder of the innocent in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the murder of the innocent. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *But I remember now I am in this earthly world; where to do harm Is often laudable, to do good sometime Accounted dangerous folly: why then, alas, Do I put up that womanly defence, To say I have done no harm?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “laudable” most nearly mean?

   A. praiseworthy

   B. to change

   C. to deceive; to blind

   D. sometimes; at times

2. *Wisdom! to leave his wife, to leave his babes, His mansion and his titles in a place From whence himself does fly? He loves us not; He wants the natural touch: for the poor wren, The most diminutive of birds, will fight, Her young ones in her nest, against the owl. All is the fear and nothing is the love; As little is the wisdom, where the flight So runs against all reason.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene II”?

   A. The last false confidence

   B. The apparitions and false security

   C. The decision to murder

   D. The murder of the innocent

SAT key: 1. A (praiseworthy); 2. D (The murder of the innocent)

Lesson 22: Act IV, Scene III

Focus: testing loyalty and the cost of grief

Content note (grief for murdered family): Macduff learns his wife and children were killed. Give space for the emotion of the scene; the focus is grief and what strength means.
Student preview: A father learns his family has been killed.
Suggested language: "What does Macduff mean by 'I must also feel it as a man'?"

Teacher only · spoilers

In England, Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and without any of the 'king-becoming graces.' When Macduff despairs ('O Scotland, Scotland!'), Malcolm reveals it was a test and that old Siward with ten thousand men is ready. A Doctor describes King Edward healing the sick by touch. Ross arrives and, after hesitating, tells Macduff his wife and children have been slaughtered. Macduff asks 'All my pretty ones?' and, told to 'dispute it like a man,' answers 'I shall do so; but I must also feel it as a man.' He vows to face Macbeth.

Background: The 'king's evil' (scrofula) was believed to be cured by a monarch's touch; James I continued the ceremony. The scene contrasts a healing king with a destroying one.

Significance: The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because.... Content note before we start: A father learns his family has been killed.
Prompt: What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: transpose — to change; hoodwink — to deceive; to blind; rawness — haste that leaves people unprotected; demerits — faults; wrongdoings; whetstone — a stone for sharpening blades.
Words: transpose: to change · hoodwink: to deceive; to blind · rawness: haste that leaves people unprotected · demerits: faults; wrongdoings · whetstone: a stone for sharpening blades

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The 'king's evil' (scrofula) was believed to be cured by a monarch's touch; James I continued the ceremony. The scene contrasts a healing king with a destroying one. The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii. Dialogue: Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and vicious; Macduff's despair proves his loyalty. Characterization: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Structure: The long scene in England sets up the counterforce. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Be not offended: / I speak not as in absolute fear of you. / I think our country sinks beneath the yoke; / It" (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 9)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "All my pretty ones? / Did you say all" (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 60)). Macduff's grief. That is dialogue at work: Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and vicious; Macduff's despair proves his loyalty.

> *All my pretty ones? / Did you say all* (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 60))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "All my pretty ones? / Did you say all" (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 60)). Macduff's grief. That is dialogue at work: Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and vicious; Macduff's despair proves his loyalty.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Malcolm's advice. Look at the craft: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." (Malcolm's advice.)

> *Dispute it like a man* (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 61))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Malcolm's advice. Look at the craft: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children."
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected answer: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." (Malcolm's advice.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. When the text says “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 61)), it shows this directly. Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man."
Task: Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. When the text says “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 61)), it shows this directly. Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed? Compare this with Lady Macbeth's "When you durst do it, then you were a man."
Anchor question: What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed?
Facilitation: Compare this with Lady Macbeth's "When you durst do it, then you were a man."

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. (“Dispute it like a man”, Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 61)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. (“Dispute it like a man”, Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 61)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dialogue shapes testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Key takeaway: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dialogue:** Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and vicious; Macduff's despair proves his loyalty.
- **Characterization:** Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children."
- **Structure:** The long scene in England sets up the counterforce.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Be not offended: / I speak not as in absolute fear of you. / I think our country sinks beneath the yoke; / It” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 9)).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “England. Before the King’s palace” (Act IV, Scene III, speech (speech 0)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 60)) Macduff's grief.
- “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 61)) Malcolm's advice.
- “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 62)) Macduff's redefinition of manhood.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness.
Evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 61))
Reasoning: Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
transpose (verb)	to change	*But I shall crave your pardon; That which you are my thoughts cannot transpose: Angels are bright still, though the brightest fell: Though all things foul would wear the brows of grace, Yet grace must still look so.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
	to deceive; to blind		

hoodwink (verb)		*But fear not yet To take upon you what is yours: you may Convey your pleasures in a spacious plenty, And yet seem cold, the time you may so hoodwink.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
rawness (noun)	haste that leaves people unprotected	*Why in that rawness left you wife and child, Those precious motives, those strong knots of love, Without leave-taking?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
demerits (noun)	faults; wrongdoings	*Sinful Macduff, They were all struck for thee! naught that I am, Not for their own demerits, but for mine, Fell slaughter on their souls.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
whetstone (noun)	a stone for sharpening blades	*Be this the whetstone of your sword: let grief Convert to anger; blunt not the heart, enrage it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
lowliness (noun)	humility	*But I have none: the king-becoming graces, As justice, verity, temperance, stableness, Bounty, perseverance, mercy, lowliness, Devotion, patience, courage, fortitude, I have no relish of them, but abound In the division of each several crime, Acting it many ways.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
blisters (verb)	raises sores on (an image of disgust)	*This tyrant, whose sole name blisters our tongues, Was once thought honest: you have loved him well: He hath not touch'd you yet.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
niggard (noun)	a miser; one who holds back	*But not a niggard of your speech: how goes't?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
grafted (adjective)	firmly planted; fixed deep	*It is myself I mean: in whom I know All the particulars of vice so grafted That, when they shall be open'd, black Macbeth Will seem as pure as snow, and the poor state Esteem him as a lamb, being compared With my confineless harms.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
appease (verb)	cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of	*I am young; but something You may deserve of him through me, and wisdom To offer up a weak poor innocent lamb To appease an angry god.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Macduff vow at the end of the scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To bring Macbeth within his sword's length, 'front to front.'
2. Why does Malcolm pretend to be wicked? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To test whether Macduff is loyal or Macbeth's agent
3. What does King Edward do for the sick? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Heals them by touch
4. What news does Ross bring Macduff? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His wife and children have been slaughtered
5. How does Macduff answer the call to 'dispute it like a man'? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He must also feel it as a man
6. How many men does Malcolm say Siward has? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Ten thousand
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act IV, Scene III” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: In England, Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and without any of the 'king-becoming graces.' When Macduff despairs ('O Scotland, Scotland!'), Malcolm reveals it was a test and that old Siward with ten thousand men is ready. A Doctor describes King Edward healing the sick by touch. Ross arrives and, after hesitating, tells Macduff his wife and children have been slaughtered.…
8. Who is on stage in “Act IV, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act IV, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “But I shall crave your pardon; That which you are my thoughts cannot transpose: Angels are bright still, though the brightest fell: Though all things foul would wear the brows of grace, Yet grace must still look so.” What does “transpose” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: transpose: to change.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Ross hesitate before telling Macduff the news? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: He fears the pain it will cause and perhaps the blame for Macduff's absence.
2. What does “Act IV, Scene III” suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 60)): Macduff's grief. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “What I believe I’ll wail, What know believe, and what I can redress, As I shall find the time to friend, I will.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: In England, Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and without any of the 'king-becoming graces.' When Macduff despairs ('O Scotland, Scotland!'), Malcolm reveals it was a test and that old Siward with ten thousand men is ready. A Doctor describes King Edward healing the sick by…
7. How does “Act IV, Scene III” build on “Act IV, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 61)): Malcolm's advice. On structure: The long scene in England sets up the counterforce. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 62)): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. On characterization: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 60)): Macduff's grief. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Malcolm's test fair to Macduff? Is it a sign that Malcolm will be a good king? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: An evaluation of Malcolm's caution and its cost.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 61)): Malcolm's advice. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 62)): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 60)): Macduff's grief. On characterization: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 61)): Malcolm's advice. On structure: The long scene in England sets up the counterforce. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 62)): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 60)): Macduff's grief. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 61)): Malcolm's advice. On characterization: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene III” treats testing loyalty and the cost of grief with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 62)): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff (speech 60)): Macduff's grief. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm (speech 61)): Malcolm's advice. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Why does Malcolm pretend to be wicked?
   A. To protect Fleance
   B. To trick Siward
   C. To test whether Macduff is loyal or Macbeth's agent
   D. Because he is afraid to rule
2. What does King Edward do for the sick?
   A. Banishes them
   B. Prays for Macbeth
   C. Heals them by touch
   D. Builds hospitals
3. What news does Ross bring Macduff?
   A. Lady Macbeth is mad
   B. His wife and children have been slaughtered
   C. Scotland has surrendered
   D. Macbeth is dead
4. How does Macduff answer the call to 'dispute it like a man'?
   A. He will return home to bury them
   B. He will forgive Macbeth
   C. He will never weep
   D. He must also feel it as a man
5. How many men does Malcolm say Siward has?
   A. Three thousand
   B. Forty thousand
   C. One hundred
   D. Ten thousand
6. In the line “But I shall crave your pardon; That which you are my thoughts cannot transpose: Angels are bright still, though the brightest fell: Though all things foul would wear the brows of grace, Yet grace must still look so.”, what does “transpose” most nearly mean?
   A. faults; wrongdoings
   B. to deceive; to blind
   C. haste that leaves people unprotected
   D. to change
7. In the line “But fear not yet To take upon you what is yours: you may Convey your pleasures in a spacious plenty, And yet seem cold, the time you may so hoodwink.”, what does “hoodwink” most nearly mean?
   A. to deceive; to blind
   B. to change
   C. faults; wrongdoings
   D. haste that leaves people unprotected

Answer key: 1. C (To test whether Macduff is loyal or Macbeth's agent); 2. C (Heals them by touch); 3. B (His wife and children have been slaughtered); 4. D (He must also feel it as a man); 5. D (Ten thousand); 6. D (to change); 7. A (to deceive; to blind)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act IV, Scene III," how does Shakespeare show testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of testing loyalty and the cost of grief? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene III suggests about testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act IV, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act IV, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of testing loyalty and the cost of grief responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act IV, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of testing loyalty and the cost of grief follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene III and its treatment of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about testing loyalty and the cost of grief in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Why in that rawness left you wife and child, Those precious motives, those strong knots of love, Without leave-taking?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “rawness” most nearly mean?

   A. a miser; one who holds back

   B. cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of

   C. firmly planted; fixed deep

   D. haste that leaves people unprotected

2. *What I believe I’ll wail, What know believe, and what I can redress, As I shall find the time to friend, I will. What you have spoke, it may be so perchance. This tyrant, whose sole name blisters our tongues, Was once thought honest: you have loved him well: He hath not touch’d you yet. I am young; but something You may deserve of him through me, and wisdom To offer up a weak poor innocent lamb To appease an angry god.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene III”?

   A. The ghost at the banquet

   B. Defiance and despair

   C. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief

   D. The guilt that will not wash away

SAT key: 1. D (haste that leaves people unprotected); 2. C (Testing loyalty and the cost of grief)

Lesson 23: Act V, Scene I

Focus: the guilt that will not wash away

Teacher only · spoilers

A Doctor and a Gentlewoman watch Lady Macbeth sleepwalk with a taper; she has light by her continually, by her own command. She rubs her hands as if washing them ('Out, damned spot!'), recalls the murder of Duncan ('who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him?'), Lady Macduff ('The Thane of Fife had a wife: where is she now?') and Banquo, and says 'What's done cannot be undone.' The Doctor says she needs 'the divine' more than the physician.

Background: Lady Macbeth speaks in prose here, though earlier she spoke commanding verse; prose often marks madness or loss of control in Shakespeare.

Significance: The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....
Prompt: Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: what she suppressed now speaks.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: discharge — to unload; to pour out; troubles — worries; nightgown — a dressing gown worn over night clothes; revolts — rebellions; distemper — a disordered or diseased state.
Words: discharge: to unload; to pour out · troubles: worries · nightgown: a dressing gown worn over night clothes · revolts: rebellions · distemper: a disordered or diseased state

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Lady Macbeth speaks in prose here, though earlier she spoke commanding verse; prose often marks madness or loss of control in Shakespeare. The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments. Characterization: Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose. Structure: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Imagery: Blood, the smell of blood, "all the perfumes of Arabia." Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Dunsinane. Anteroom in the castle” (Act V, Scene I, speech (speech 0)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Out, damned spot! out, I say" (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 15)). Guilt as stain. That is characterization at work: Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose.

> *Out, damned spot! out, I say* (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 15))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Out, damned spot! out, I say" (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 15)). Guilt as stain. That is characterization at work: Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Echoes Macbeth's ocean. Look at the craft: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected: What she suppressed now speaks. (Echoes Macbeth's ocean.)

> *Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand* (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 20))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Echoes Macbeth's ocean. Look at the craft: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected answer: What she suppressed now speaks. (Echoes Macbeth's ocean.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of the guilt that will not wash away. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. When the text says "Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand" (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 20)), it shows this directly. She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand."

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of the guilt that will not wash away. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. When the text says "Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand" (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 20)), it shows this directly. She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it? Content note: mental breakdown and implied suicide later. Ask what the Doctor and Gentlewoman add as witnesses.

Anchor question: Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it?

Facilitation: Content note: mental breakdown and implied suicide later. Ask what the Doctor and Gentlewoman add as witnesses.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. ("Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand", Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 20)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. ("Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand", Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 20)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the guilt that will not wash away. Key takeaway: what she suppressed now speaks.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose.
- **Structure:** She speaks prose; her verse control is gone.
- **Imagery:** Blood, the smell of blood, "all the perfumes of Arabia."

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** what she suppressed now speaks.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Dunsinane. Ante-room in the castle” (Act V, Scene I, speech (speech 0)).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “The thane of Fife had a wife: where is she now?—What, will these” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 17)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 15)) Guilt as stain.
- “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 20)) Echoes Macbeth's ocean.
- “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 28)) Echo of "what's done is done."

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away.
Evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 20))
Reasoning: She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

discharge (verb)	to unload; to pour out	*Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
troubles (noun)	worries	*Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
nightgown (noun)	a dressing gown worn over night clothes	*Wash your hands, put on your nightgown; look not so pale.—I tell you yet again, Banquo's buried; he cannot come out on's grave.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
revolts (noun)	rebellions	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
distemper (noun)	a disordered or diseased state	*Great Dunsinane he strongly fortifies: Some say he's mad; others that lesser hate him Do call it valiant fury: but, for certain, He cannot buckle his distemper'd cause Within the belt of rule.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
upbraid (verb)	to scold; to reproach	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mortified (adjective)	deadened; numb as if dead	*The English power is near, led on by Malcolm, His uncle Siward and the good Macduff: Revenges burn in them; for their dear causes Would to the bleeding and the grim alarm Excite the mortified man.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
manhood (noun)	adulthood as a man	*For certain, sir, he is not: I have a file Of all the gentry: there is Siward's son, And many unrough youths that even now Protest their first of manhood.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who watches Lady Macbeth sleepwalk? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A Doctor of Physic and a Waiting-Gentlewoman.
2. What does Lady Macbeth do while sleepwalking? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Rubs her hands as if washing them
3. What does she keep by her continually? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A light
4. Whom does she mean by 'The Thane of Fife had a wife'? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lady Macduff
5. What does she say about what's done? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It cannot be undone
6. What does the Doctor say she needs more than a physician? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The divine (a priest)
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A Doctor and a Gentlewoman watch Lady Macbeth sleepwalk with a taper; she has light by her continually, by her own command. She rubs her hands as if washing them ('Out, damned spot!'), recalls the murder of Duncan ('who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him?'), Lady Macduff ('The Thane of Fife had a wife: where is she now?') and Banquo, and says 'What's done cannot be…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician." What does "discharge" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: discharge: to unload; to pour out.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Lady Macbeth now need a light, when in Act I she called for 'thick night'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Darkness, once her ally, now terrifies her: guilt has reversed her.
2. What does "Act V, Scene I" suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the symbolism in this scene shape what we understand about the guilt that will not wash away? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier

confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 15)): Guilt as stain. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Since his majesty went into the field, I have seen her rise from her bed, throw her nightgown upon her, unlock her closet, take forth paper, fold it, write upon’t, read it,…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A Doctor and a Gentlewoman watch Lady Macbeth sleepwalk with a taper; she has light by her continually, by her own command. She rubs her hands as if washing them ('Out, damned spot!'), recalls the murder of Duncan ('who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him?'), Lady…
7. How does “Act V, Scene I” build on “Act IV, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 20)): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. On structure: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 28)): Echo of "what's done is done." On characterization: Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 15)): Guilt as stain. On structure: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the sleepwalking scene a punishment, a confession or a cry for help? Defend your reading. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: An interpretive judgment with evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 20)): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 28)): Echo of "what's done is done." Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 15)): Guilt as stain. On characterization: Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the guilt that will not wash away. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 20)): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. On structure: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 28)): Echo of "what's done is done." Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 15)): Guilt as stain. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 20)): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. On imagery: Blood, the smell of blood, "all the perfumes of Arabia." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene I” treats the guilt that will not wash away with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 28)): Echo of "what's done is done." Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 15)): Guilt as stain. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the guilt that will not wash away? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth (speech 20)): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz

1. What does Lady Macbeth do while sleepwalking?
   A. Writes letters to Macbeth
   B. Rubs her hands as if washing them
   C. Sings with the Witches
   D. Sharpens a dagger
2. What does she keep by her continually?
   A. A light
   B. A letter
   C. A crown
   D. A dagger
3. Whom does she mean by 'The Thane of Fife had a wife'?
   A. Hecate
   B. The Gentlewoman
   C. Herself
   D. Lady Macduff
4. What does she say about what's done?
   A. It was Banquo's fault
   B. It must be done again
   C. It was a dream
   D. It cannot be undone
5. What does the Doctor say she needs more than a physician?
   A. Her husband
   B. The divine (a priest)
   C. More sleep
   D. A soldier
6. In the line “Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.”, what does “discharge” most nearly mean?
   A. rebellions
   B. worries
   C. to unload; to pour out
   D. a dressing gown worn over night clothes
7. In the line “Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.”, what does “troubles” most nearly mean?
   A. worries
   B. to unload; to pour out
   C. a dressing gown worn over night clothes

D. rebellions

Answer key: 1. B (Rubs her hands as if washing them); 2. A (A light); 3. D (Lady Macduff); 4. D (It cannot be undone); 5. B (The divine (a priest)); 6. C (to unload; to pour out); 7. A (worries)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene I," how does Shakespeare show the guilt that will not wash away? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the guilt that will not wash away? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of the guilt that will not wash away. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the guilt that will not wash away. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene I suggests about the guilt that will not wash away. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act V, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the guilt that will not wash away. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the guilt that will not wash away responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the guilt that will not wash away follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene I and its treatment of the guilt that will not wash away. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the guilt that will not wash away in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the guilt that will not wash away. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Wash your hands, put on your nightgown; look not so pale.—I tell you yet again, Banquo's buried; he cannot come out on's grave.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "nightgown" most nearly mean?

   A. to scold; to reproach

   B. a dressing gown worn over night clothes

   C. adulthood as a man

   D. deadened; numb as if dead

2. *Since his majesty went into the field, I have seen her rise from her bed, throw her nightgown upon her, unlock her closet, take forth paper, fold it, write upon't, read it, afterwards seal it, and again return to bed; yet all this while in a most fast sleep.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene I"?

   A. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief

   B. The murder of the innocent

   C. The Witches' riddling world

   D. The guilt that will not wash away

SAT key: 1. B (a dressing gown worn over night clothes); 2. D (The guilt that will not wash away)

Lesson 24: Act V, Scene II

Focus: the tyrant's weakening grip

Teacher only · spoilers

Scottish thanes (Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox) march to join Malcolm's English power near Birnam Wood. They say Macbeth strongly fortifies Dunsinane; some call him mad, and those he commands 'move only in command, nothing in love.' Angus says Macbeth's title hangs loose about him 'like a giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief.' They march to give their blood as medicine to purge their sick country.

Background: Images of clothing that does not fit Macbeth recur through the play ('borrow'd robes' in I.iii); here they end in contempt.

Significance: Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition because....
Prompt: How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the stolen title does not fit.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: revolts — rebellions; distemper — a disordered or diseased state; upbraid — to scold; to reproach; mortified — deadened; numb as if dead; manhood — adulthood as a man.
Words: revolts: rebellions · distemper: a disordered or diseased state · upbraid: to scold; to reproach · mortified: deadened; numb as if dead · manhood: adulthood as a man

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Images of clothing that does not fit Macbeth recur through the play ('borrow'd robes' in I.iii); here they end in contempt. Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland. Imagery: Clothing imagery: Macbeth's title hangs "loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief." Characterization: Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "The country near Dunsinane" (Act V, Scene II, speech (speech 0)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)). His followers obey from fear. That is imagery at work: Clothing imagery: Macbeth's title hangs "loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief."

> *Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)). His followers obey from fear. That is imagery at work: Clothing imagery: Macbeth's title hangs "loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief."

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The robe image recalls "borrowed robes" (I.iii). Ambition. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition? Expected: The stolen title does not fit. (Clothing imagery.)

> *now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The robe image recalls "borrowed robes" (I.iii). Ambition.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition?
Expected answer: The stolen title does not fit. (Clothing imagery.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's weakening grip? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the tyrant's weakening grip. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. When the text says "Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love" (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)), it shows this directly. Angus says his title hangs "like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief," and his soldiers "move only in command, / Nothing in love."
Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's weakening grip? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the tyrant's weakening grip. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. When the text says "Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love" (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)), it shows this directly. Angus says his title hangs "like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief," and his soldiers "move only in command, / Nothing in love."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them? Trace clothing imagery across the play.
Anchor question: How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them?
Facilitation: Trace clothing imagery across the play.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's weakening grip? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. ("Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love", Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's weakening grip? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. ("Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love", Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the tyrant's weakening grip. Key takeaway: the stolen title does not fit.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** Clothing imagery: Macbeth's title hangs "loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief."
- **Characterization:** Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition:** the stolen title does not fit.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “The country near Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene II, speech (speech 0)).
- **clothing:** Borrowed and ill-fitting robes show Macbeth as a man in a role that does not suit him. In this scene: “in command, / Nothing in love: now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)) Clothing imagery.
- “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)) His followers obey from fear.
- “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)) Guilt.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole.
Evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7))
Reasoning: Angus says his title hangs "like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief," and his soldiers "move only in command, / Nothing in love."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
revolts (noun)	rebellions	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

distemper (noun)	a disordered or diseased state	*Great Dunsinane he strongly fortifies: Some say he's mad; others that lesser hate him Do call it valiant fury: but, for certain, He cannot buckle his distemper'd cause Within the belt of rule.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
upbraid (verb)	to scold; to reproach	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mortified (adjective)	deadened; numb as if dead	*The English power is near, led on by Malcolm, His uncle Siward and the good Macduff: Revenges burn in them; for their dear causes Would to the bleeding and the grim alarm Excite the mortified man.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
manhood (noun)	adulthood as a man	*For certain, sir, he is not: I have a file Of all the gentry: there is Siward's son, And many unrough youths that even now Protest their first of manhood.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
condemn (verb)	to declare guilty	*Who then shall blame His pester'd senses to recoil and start, When all that is within him does condemn Itself for being there?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
commands (verb)	gives orders to	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
antidote (noun)	a remedy that counteracts a poison	*Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which thanes appear in this scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox.

2. Near where will the thanes meet the English army? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Birnam Wood
3. How do Macbeth's followers obey him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Only in command, nothing in love
4. What image does Angus use for Macbeth's title? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief
5. What is Macbeth doing at Dunsinane? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Strongly fortifying it
6. What do the thanes want to do for their country? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Purge it, like medicine for a sick body
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Scottish thanes (Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox) march to join Malcolm's English power near Birnam Wood. They say Macbeth strongly fortifies Dunsinane; some call him mad, and those he commands 'move only in command, nothing in love.' Angus says Macbeth's title hangs loose about him 'like a giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief.' They march to give their blood as medicine to purge their sick…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a…" What does "revolts" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: revolts: rebellions.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does the clothing image suggest about Macbeth's right to rule? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: He is small inside a role that does not fit; the crown is stolen.
2. What does "Act V, Scene II" suggest about the tyrant's weakening grip? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the tyrant's weakening grip? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: "now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief" (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): Clothing imagery. On characterization: Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Scottish thanes (Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox) march to join Malcolm's English power near Birnam Wood. They say Macbeth strongly fortifies Dunsinane; some call him mad, and those he commands 'move only in command, nothing in love.' Angus says Macbeth's title hangs loose about him 'like a…
7. How does “Act V, Scene II” build on “Act V, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): His followers obey from fear. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): Guilt. On characterization: Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): Clothing imagery. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Are the thanes heroes for changing sides now, or late opportunists? Judge them. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment about timing and loyalty.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene

II, Angus (speech 7)): His followers obey from fear. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): Guilt. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): Clothing imagery. On characterization: Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the tyrant's weakening grip. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): His followers obey from fear. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): Guilt. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): Clothing imagery. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and

evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): His followers obey from fear. On imagery: Clothing imagery: Macbeth's title hangs "loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene II” treats the tyrant's weakening grip with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): Guilt. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): Clothing imagery. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the tyrant's weakening grip? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus (speech 7)): His followers obey from fear. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz

1. Near where will the thanes meet the English army?

   A. Scone

   B. Forres

   C. Birnam Wood

   D. Inverness

2. How do Macbeth's followers obey him?
   A. Out of love and loyalty
   B. Not at all
   C. Only for money
   D. Only in command, nothing in love
3. What image does Angus use for Macbeth's title?
   A. A giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief
   B. A falling star
   C. A crown of thorns
   D. A broken sword
4. What is Macbeth doing at Dunsinane?
   A. Abandoning it
   B. Strongly fortifying it
   C. Praying
   D. Holding a feast
5. What do the thanes want to do for their country?
   A. Purge it, like medicine for a sick body
   B. Sell it to England
   C. Leave it
   D. Divide it
6. In the line "Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.", what does "revolts" most nearly mean?
   A. a disordered or diseased state
   B. deadened; numb as if dead
   C. to scold; to reproach
   D. rebellions
7. In the line "Great Dunsinane he strongly fortifies: Some say he's mad; others that lesser hate him Do call it valiant fury: but, for certain, He cannot buckle his distemper'd cause Within the belt of rule.", what does "distemper" most nearly mean?
   A. deadened; numb as if dead
   B. to scold; to reproach
   C. rebellions
   D. a disordered or diseased state

Answer key: 1. C (Birnam Wood); 2. D (Only in command, nothing in love); 3. A (A giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief); 4. B (Strongly fortifying it); 5. A (Purge it, like medicine for a sick body); 6. D (rebellions); 7. D (a disordered or diseased state)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show the tyrant's weakening grip? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the tyrant's weakening grip? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the tyrant's weakening grip. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the tyrant's weakening grip. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene II suggests about the tyrant's weakening grip. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act V, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the tyrant's weakening grip. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the tyrant's weakening grip responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the tyrant's weakening grip follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene II and its treatment of the tyrant's weakening grip. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the tyrant's weakening grip in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the tyrant's weakening grip. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "upbraid" most nearly mean?

   A. to scold; to reproach

   B. gives orders to

   C. a remedy that counteracts a poison

   D. to declare guilty

2. *Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene II"?

   A. Nature's revolt against the crime

   B. The tyrant's weakening grip

   C. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief

   D. The army reveals itself

SAT key: 1. A (to scold; to reproach); 2. B (The tyrant's weakening grip)

Lesson 25: Act V, Scene III

Focus: defiance and despair

Teacher only · spoilers

Macbeth, trusting the prophecies, refuses to fear the fleeing thanes or 'the boy Malcolm.' He curses a pale servant who reports ten thousand English soldiers. Aside, he says he has lived long enough: his way of life is fallen 'into the sear, the yellow leaf,' without honor, love, obedience or troops of friends. He insists on putting on his armor. He asks the Doctor to 'minister to a mind diseased'; the Doctor says the patient must minister to himself. 'Throw physic to the dogs; I'll none of it.'

Background: Seyton, Macbeth's last attendant, has a name that sounds like 'Satan' to many readers and directors.

Significance: Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....
Prompt: Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: antidote — a remedy that counteracts a poison; troubles — worries; censures — judgments; opinions; chambers — bedrooms; approaches — comes near.
Words: antidote: a remedy that counteracts a poison · troubles: worries · censures: judgments; opinions · chambers: bedrooms · approaches: comes near

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Seyton, Macbeth's last attendant, has a name that sounds like 'Satan' to many readers and directors. Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt. Characterization: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf." Soliloquy: He longs for "honour, love, obedience, troops of friends." Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Dunsinane. A room in the castle” (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 0)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15)). Guilt as disease. That is characterization at work: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf."

> *Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased* (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15)). Guilt as disease. That is characterization at work: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf."

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Autumn leaf = old age without companions. Guilt. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected: He asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." (Autumn imagery.)

> *I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf* (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 7))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Autumn leaf = old age without companions. Guilt.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected answer: He asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." (Autumn imagery.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, soliloquy (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about defiance and despair? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of defiance and despair. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. When the text says “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15)), it shows this directly. He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, soliloquy (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about defiance and despair? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of defiance and despair. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. When the text says “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15)), it shows this directly. He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside? Ask: do we pity Macbeth here?
Anchor question: Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside?
Facilitation: Ask: do we pity Macbeth here?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about defiance and despair? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. (“Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased”, Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about defiance and despair? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. (“Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased”, Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes defiance and despair. Key takeaway: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf."
- **Soliloquy:** He longs for "honour, love, obedience, troops of friends."

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Dunsinane. A room in the castle” (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 0)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 7)) Autumn imagery.
- “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15)) Guilt as disease.
- “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 11)) Defiance.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him.
Evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15))
Reasoning: He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
antidote (noun)	a remedy that counteracts a poison	*Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff’d bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
troubles (noun)	worries	*Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff’d bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

censures (noun)	judgments; opinions	*Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chambers (noun)	bedrooms	*Cousins, I hope the days are near at hand That chambers will be safe.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
approaches (verb)	comes near	*The time approaches That will with due decision make us know What we shall say we have and what we owe.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
yesterdays (noun)	past days	*To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
equivocation (noun)	the use of double meanings to mislead	*I pull in resolution, and begin To doubt the equivocation of the fiend That lies like truth: "Fear not, till Birnam wood Do come to Dunsinane:" and now a wood Comes toward Dunsinane.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tarrying (verb)	staying; lingering	*If this which he avouches does appear, There is nor flying hence nor tarrying here.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who is Macbeth's attendant who brings his armor? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Seyton.
2. Why does Macbeth say he will not fear Malcolm? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Malcolm was born of woman
3. What season image does Macbeth use for his life? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The sear, the yellow leaf (autumn)
4. What does Macbeth say he cannot look to have in old age? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Honour, love, obedience, troops of friends

5. What does Macbeth ask the Doctor? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To minister to a mind diseased
6. What does the Doctor reply? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The patient must minister to himself
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Macbeth, trusting the prophecies, refuses to fear the fleeing thanes or 'the boy Malcolm.' He curses a pale servant who reports ten thousand English soldiers. Aside, he says he has lived long enough: his way of life is fallen 'into the sear, the yellow leaf,' without honor, love, obedience or troops of friends. He insists on putting on his armor. He asks the Doctor to 'minister to a mind…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which…" What does "antidote" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: antidote: a remedy that counteracts a poison.

Inferential / analytical

1. Macbeth asks the Doctor to cure his wife, then says 'Throw physic to the dogs.' What does this shift reveal? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: He knows no medicine can cure guilt, his or hers.
2. What does "Act V, Scene III" suggest about defiance and despair? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about defiance and despair? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: "I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf" (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 7)): Autumn imagery. On characterization: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Cure her of that.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Macbeth, trusting the prophecies, refuses to fear the fleeing thanes or 'the boy Malcolm.' He curses a pale servant who reports ten thousand English soldiers. Aside, he says he has lived long enough: his way of life is fallen 'into the sear, the yellow leaf,' without honor, love, obedience or…
7. How does “Act V, Scene III” build on “Act V, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15)): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 11)): Defiance. On characterization: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with appearance versus reality? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 7)): Autumn imagery. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does Macbeth's self-awareness here make him more tragic or less sympathetic? Explain. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment about tragic recognition.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15)): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look

for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 11)): Defiance. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 7)): Autumn imagery. On characterization: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of defiance and despair. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15)): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 11)): Defiance. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 7)): Autumn imagery. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth

(speech 15)): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene III” treats defiance and despair with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 11)): Defiance. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 7)): Autumn imagery. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about defiance and despair? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth (speech 15)): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Why does Macbeth say he will not fear Malcolm?
   A. Malcolm was born of woman
   B. Malcolm is a coward
   C. Malcolm is in Ireland
   D. Malcolm has no army
2. What season image does Macbeth use for his life?
   A. The sear, the yellow leaf (autumn)

B. Early spring

C. High summer

D. Frozen winter

3. What does Macbeth say he cannot look to have in old age?

A. Sleep and food

B. Honour, love, obedience, troops of friends

C. A son and heir

D. Gold, land and horses

4. What does Macbeth ask the Doctor?

A. To poison Malcolm

B. To minister to a mind diseased

C. To bring the Witches

D. To read the stars

5. What does the Doctor reply?

A. The patient must minister to himself

B. She should go to England

C. She will recover by morning

D. He can cure her with herbs

6. In the line "Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?", what does "antidote" most nearly mean?

A. worries

B. a remedy that counteracts a poison

C. judgments; opinions

D. bedrooms

7. In the line "Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?", what does "troubles" most nearly mean?

A. worries

B. judgments; opinions

C. bedrooms

D. a remedy that counteracts a poison

Answer key: 1. A (Malcolm was born of woman); 2. A (The sear, the yellow leaf (autumn)); 3. B (Honour, love, obedience, troops of friends); 4. B (To minister to a mind diseased); 5. A (The patient must minister to himself); 6. B (a remedy that counteracts a poison); 7. A (worries)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene

III," how does Shakespeare show defiance and despair? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of defiance and despair? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of defiance and despair. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of defiance and despair. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene III suggests about defiance and despair. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act V, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of defiance and despair. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of defiance and despair responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of defiance and despair follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene III and its treatment of defiance and despair. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about defiance and despair in Macbeth. Connect close

reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of defiance and despair. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “censures” most nearly mean?

   A. the use of double meanings to mislead

   B. staying; lingering

   C. past days

   D. judgments; opinions

2. *Cure her of that. Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff’d bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene III”?

   A. The cast and world of the play

   B. Lady Macbeth's resolve

   C. Defiance and despair

   D. The decision to murder

SAT key: 1. D (judgments; opinions); 2. C (Defiance and despair)

Lesson 26: Act V, Scene IV

Focus: the moving wood

Teacher only · spoilers

Near Birnam Wood, Malcolm orders every soldier to cut down a bough and carry it before him to hide the army's numbers from Macbeth's scouts. Siward reports that Macbeth will wait for a siege at Dunsinane; Malcolm notes that many have revolted and only 'constrained things whose hearts are absent too' serve him. Macduff and Siward urge action over speculation.

Background: Camouflage with branches appears in medieval chronicle tales; Shakespeare uses it to fulfil the apparition's riddle literally.

Significance: A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: censures — judgments; opinions; chambers — bedrooms; approaches — comes near; yesterdays — past days; equivocation — the use of double meanings to mislead.
Words: censures: judgments; opinions · chambers: bedrooms · approaches: comes near · yesterdays: past days · equivocation: the use of double meanings to mislead

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Camouflage with branches appears in medieval chronicle tales; Shakespeare uses it to fulfil the apparition's riddle literally. A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined. Plot: Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers. Dramatic irony: The audience sees the prophecy being fulfilled by human strategy. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Country near Birnam wood" (Act V, Scene IV, speech (speech 0)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear't before him" (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)). Malcolm's order. That is plot at work: Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers.

> *Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear't before him* (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear't before him" (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)). Malcolm's order. That is plot at work: Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The strategy. Look at the craft: The audience sees the prophecy being fulfilled by human strategy. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: Prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. (The strategy.)

> *thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host* (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The strategy. Look at the craft: The audience sees the prophecy being fulfilled by human strategy.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: Prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. (The strategy.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for plot, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the moving wood? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene IV develops the idea of the moving wood. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. When the text says “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)), it shows this directly. Malcolm orders "every soldier hew him down a bough," to "shadow / The numbers of our host."
Task: Annotate the scene for plot, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the moving wood? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene IV develops the idea of the moving wood. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. When the text says “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)), it shows this directly. Malcolm orders "every soldier hew him down a bough," to "shadow / The numbers of our host."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy? Ask: does this make the witches' prophecy a trick or truth?
Anchor question: Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy?
Facilitation: Ask: does this make the witches' prophecy a trick or truth?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the moving wood? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. (“Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him”, Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the moving wood? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. (“Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him”, Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes the moving wood. Key takeaway: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers.
- **Dramatic irony:** The audience sees the prophecy being fulfilled by human strategy.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Country near Birnam wood” (Act V, Scene IV, speech (speech 0)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)) Malcolm's order.
- “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)) The strategy.
- “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, Siward (speech 7)) Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action.
Evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5))
Reasoning: Malcolm orders "every soldier hew him down a bough," to "shadow / The numbers of our host."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
censures (noun)	judgments; opinions	*Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chambers (noun)	bedrooms	*Cousins, I hope the days are near at hand That chambers will be safe.*	

			Student look-up (not yet verified)
approaches (verb)	comes near	*The time approaches That will with due decision make us know What we shall say we have and what we owe.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
yesterdays (noun)	past days	*To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
equivocation (noun)	the use of double meanings to mislead	*I pull in resolution, and begin To doubt the equivocation of the fiend That lies like truth: "Fear not, till Birnam wood Do come to Dunsinane:" and now a wood Comes toward Dunsinane.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tarrying (verb)	staying; lingering	*If this which he avouches does appear, There is nor flying hence nor tarrying here.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
syllable (noun)	a single word or sound (here, "a syllable said" = a word said)	*To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
recorded (adjective)	written down	*To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Near which wood does the army gather? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Birnam Wood.

2. What does Malcolm order each soldier to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Cut down a bough and carry it
3. Why does he give this order? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To hide the size of the army
4. Which prophecy does this begin to fulfil? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Birnam Wood coming to Dunsinane
5. Who still serves Macbeth, according to Malcolm? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Constrained things whose hearts are absent
6. What do Macduff and Siward urge? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Action rather than speculation
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Near Birnam Wood, Malcolm orders every soldier to cut down a bough and carry it before him to hide the army's numbers from Macbeth's scouts. Siward reports that Macbeth will wait for a siege at Dunsinane; Malcolm notes that many have revolted and only 'constrained things whose hearts are absent too' serve him. Macduff and Siward urge action over speculation.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership." What does "censures" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: censures: judgments; opinions.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is it ironic that the trick is Malcolm's ordinary military plan? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: The 'impossible' sign Macbeth trusted is achieved by simple strategy.
2. What does "Act V, Scene IV" suggest about the moving wood? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined.
3. Find one example of foreshadowing in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about the moving wood? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear't before him" (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)): Malcolm's order. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “The time approaches That will with due decision make us know What we shall say we have and what we owe.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Near Birnam Wood, Malcolm orders every soldier to cut down a bough and carry it before him to hide the army's numbers from Macbeth's scouts. Siward reports that Macbeth will wait for a siege at Dunsinane; Malcolm notes that many have revolted and only 'constrained things whose hearts are absent…
7. How does “Act V, Scene IV” build on “Act V, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, Siward (speech 7)): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)): Malcolm's order. On plot: Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the fulfilment of the prophecy make Malcolm a tool of fate or a free agent? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment on fate and free will.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “thereby shall we shadow / The

numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, Siward (speech 7)): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)): Malcolm's order. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the moving wood. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, Siward (speech 7)): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)): Malcolm's order. Theme link:

prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the foreshadowing in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene IV” treats the moving wood with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, Siward (speech 7)): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)): Malcolm's order. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the moving wood? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm (speech 5)): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz

1. What does Malcolm order each soldier to do?
   A. March at night without torches
   B. Burn the wood
   C. Cut down a bough and carry it
   D. Hide in the trees
2. Why does he give this order?
   A. To make fires
   B. To build a bridge
   C. To hide the size of the army
   D. To scare the Witches
3. Which prophecy does this begin to fulfil?
   A. None of woman born
   B. Banquo's heirs as kings
   C. Beware Macduff
   D. Birnam Wood coming to Dunsinane
4. Who still serves Macbeth, according to Malcolm?
   A. Constrained things whose hearts are absent
   B. Ten thousand English soldiers
   C. His loyal thanes
   D. The Witches
5. What do Macduff and Siward urge?
   A. Action rather than speculation
   B. Retreat to England
   C. Negotiation with Macbeth
   D. Waiting for winter
6. In the line “Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership.”, what does “censures” most nearly mean?
   A. bedrooms
   B. past days
   C. judgments; opinions
   D. comes near
7. In the line “Cousins, I hope the days are near at hand That chambers will be safe.”, what does “chambers” most nearly mean?
   A. past days
   B. bedrooms
   C. judgments; opinions
   D. comes near

Answer key: 1. C (Cut down a bough and carry it); 2. C (To hide the size of the army); 3. D (Birnam Wood coming to Dunsinane); 4. A (Constrained things whose hearts are absent); 5. A (Action rather than speculation); 6. C (judgments; opinions); 7. B (bedrooms)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene IV," how does Shakespeare show the moving wood? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the moving wood? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene IV develops the idea of the moving wood. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the moving wood. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene IV suggests about the moving wood. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's foreshadowing and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses foreshadowing in Act V, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of the moving wood. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the moving wood responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the moving wood follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene IV and its treatment of the moving wood. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's foreshadowing and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about the moving wood in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the moving wood. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *The time approaches That will with due decision make us know What we shall say we have and what we owe.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “approaches” most nearly mean?

   A. staying; lingering

   B. comes near

   C. a single word or sound (here, "a syllable said" = a word said)

   D. written down

2. *The time approaches That will with due decision make us know What we shall say we have and what we owe. Thoughts speculative their unsure hopes relate, But certain issue strokes must arbitrate: Towards which advance the war. Exeunt, marching.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene IV”?

   A. The army reveals itself

   B. The apparitions and false security

   C. The decision to murder

   D. The moving wood

SAT key: 1. B (comes near); 2. D (The moving wood)

Lesson 27: Act V, Scene V

Focus: life as a tale told by an idiot

Teacher only · spoilers

Macbeth orders banners hung on the outward walls, boasting his castle will laugh a siege to scorn. A cry of women is heard; he says he has almost forgotten the taste of fears. Seyton reports 'The queen, my lord, is dead.' Macbeth replies 'She should have died hereafter' and speaks of 'To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow': life is 'a walking shadow, a poor player,' a tale 'told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, signifying nothing.' A messenger reports that Birnam Wood seems to move. Macbeth begins to doubt 'the equivocation of the fiend that lies like truth' and goes out to fight: 'At least we'll die with harness on our back.'

Background: Comparing life to a stage play was a commonplace in Shakespeare's theater; here an actor speaks of life as a part that means nothing.

Significance: The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: meaninglessness.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: yesterdays — past days; equivocation — the use of double meanings to mislead; tarrying — staying; lingering; syllable — a single word or sound (here, "a syllable said" = a word said); recorded — written down.
Words: yesterdays: past days · equivocation: the use of double meanings to mislead · tarrying: staying; lingering · syllable: a single word or sound (here, "a syllable said" = a word said) · recorded: written down

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Comparing life to a stage play was a commonplace in Shakespeare's theater; here an actor speaks of life as a part that means nothing. The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom. Soliloquy: "Tomorrow, and tomorrow, and tomorrow": Macbeth's response to his wife's death. Imagery: Life as a "brief candle," "a walking shadow," "a poor player," "a tale / Told by an idiot." Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Dunsinane. Within the castle” (Act V, Scene V, speech (speech 0)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)). His response. That is soliloquy at work: "Tomorrow, and tomorrow, and tomorrow": Macbeth's response to his wife's death.

> *She should have died hereafter* (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)). His response. That is soliloquy at work: "Tomorrow, and tomorrow, and tomorrow": Macbeth's response to his wife's death.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The metaphors (candle, shadow, player, tale) all suggest brevity and emptiness. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: Meaninglessness. (Meaninglessness.)

> *it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing* (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The metaphors (candle, shadow, player, tale) all suggest brevity and emptiness.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: Meaninglessness. (Meaninglessness.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for soliloquy, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of life as a tale told by an idiot. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of metaphor and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. When the text says "it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing" (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)), it shows this directly. Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing."
Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of life as a tale told by an idiot. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of metaphor and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. When the text says "it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing" (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)), it shows this directly. Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none? Ask: is this Shakespeare's view or Macbeth's?
Anchor question: What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none?
Facilitation: Ask: is this Shakespeare's view or Macbeth's?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. ("it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing", Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. ("it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing", Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how soliloquy shapes life as a tale told by an idiot. Key takeaway: meaninglessness.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** "Tomorrow, and tomorrow, and tomorrow": Macbeth's response to his wife's death.
- **Imagery:** Life as a "brief candle," "a walking shadow," "a poor player," "a tale / Told by an idiot."

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** meaninglessness.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Dunsinane. Within the castle” (Act V, Scene V, speech (speech 0)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)) His response.
- “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)) Time.
- “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)) Meaninglessness.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning.
Evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5))
Reasoning: Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
yesterdays (noun)	past days	*To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

equivocation (noun)	the use of double meanings to mislead	*I pull in resolution, and begin To doubt the equivocation of the fiend That lies like truth: "Fear not, till Birnam wood Do come to Dunsinane:" and now a wood Comes toward Dunsinane.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tarrying (verb)	staying; lingering	*If this which he avouches does appear, There is nor flying hence nor tarrying here.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
syllable (noun)	a single word or sound (here, "a syllable said" = a word said)	*To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
recorded (adjective)	written down	*To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
harness (noun)	armor	*At least we'll die with harness on our back.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hereafter (adverb)	later; at some future time	*She should have died hereafter; There would have been a time for such a word.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
screens (noun)	coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army)	*Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none?
2. Where does metaphor appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Macbeth say life signifies, at the end of the speech? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Nothing: a tale told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, signifying nothing.
2. What does Seyton report? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The queen is dead
3. How does Macbeth first respond to his wife's death? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: She should have died hereafter
4. What does Macbeth compare life to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A walking shadow and a poor player
5. What does the messenger see? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Birnam Wood beginning to move
6. How does Macbeth say he will die? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: With harness (armor) on his back
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Macbeth orders banners hung on the outward walls, boasting his castle will laugh a siege to scorn. A cry of women is heard; he says he has almost forgotten the taste of fears. Seyton reports 'The queen, my lord, is dead.' Macbeth replies 'She should have died hereafter' and speaks of 'To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow': life is 'a walking shadow, a poor player,' a tale 'told by an idiot,…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene V" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death." What does "yesterdays" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: yesterdays: past days.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macbeth react so flatly to his wife's death? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: He has 'supp'd full with horrors'; feeling itself has been numbed by crime.
2. What does Macbeth mean by 'the equivocation of the fiend that lies like truth'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: He realizes the Witches' words were true only in a deceptive sense.
3. What does "Act V, Scene V" suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom.
4. Find one example of metaphor in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for direct comparisons that call one thing another.
5. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about life as a tale told by an idiot? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. In the passage that begins “She should have died hereafter; There would have been a time for such a word.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Macbeth orders banners hung on the outward walls, boasting his castle will laugh a siege to scorn. A cry of women is heard; he says he has almost forgotten the taste of fears. Seyton reports 'The queen, my lord, is dead.' Macbeth replies 'She should have died hereafter' and speaks of 'To-morrow,...
8. How does “Act V, Scene V” build on “Act V, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): Time. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): Meaninglessness. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is 'To-morrow, and to-morrow' the play's message or only Macbeth's? Argue with evidence from the ending. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment distinguishing character and work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): Time. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): Meaninglessness. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of life as a tale told by an idiot. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): Time. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): Meaninglessness. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the metaphor in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene V” treats life as a tale told by an idiot with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): Time. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene VI” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): Meaninglessness. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about life as a tale told by an idiot? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth (speech 5)): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Metaphor:** look for direct comparisons that call one thing another (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What does Seyton report?
   A. The queen is dead
   B. The Witches are at the gate
   C. Malcolm has surrendered
   D. Banquo's ghost has returned
2. How does Macbeth first respond to his wife's death?
   A. He laughs
   B. She should have died hereafter
   C. He weeps and faints
   D. He blames Malcolm

3. What does Macbeth compare life to?
   A. A river and a sea
   B. A battle and a crown
   C. A walking shadow and a poor player
   D. A garden and a storm
4. What does the messenger see?
   A. The Witches flying
   B. A comet
   C. Macduff's army retreating
   D. Birnam Wood beginning to move
5. How does Macbeth say he will die?
   A. By his own hand
   B. In exile
   C. In his bed
   D. With harness (armor) on his back
6. In the line “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.”, what does “yesterdays” most nearly mean?
   A. the use of double meanings to mislead
   B. past days
   C. a single word or sound (here, "a syllable said" = a word said)
   D. staying; lingering
7. In the line “I pull in resolution, and begin To doubt the equivocation of the fiend That lies like truth: “Fear not, till Birnam wood Do come to Dunsinane:” and now a wood Comes toward Dunsinane.”, what does “equivocation” most nearly mean?
   A. past days
   B. the use of double meanings to mislead
   C. staying; lingering
   D. a single word or sound (here, "a syllable said" = a word said)

Answer key: 1. A (The queen is dead); 2. B (She should have died hereafter); 3. C (A walking shadow and a poor player); 4. D (Birnam Wood beginning to move); 5. D (With harness (armor) on his back); 6. B (past days); 7. B (the use of double meanings to mislead)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show life as a tale told by an idiot? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the metaphor you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of life as a tale told by an idiot? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the metaphor in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of life as a tale told by an idiot. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of metaphor and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its metaphor shape the reader's understanding of life as a tale told by an idiot. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene V suggests about life as a tale told by an idiot. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's metaphor and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses metaphor in Act V, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of life as a tale told by an idiot. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of life as a tale told by an idiot responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of life as a tale told by an idiot follows or bends those conventions, using the metaphor as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene V and its treatment of life as a tale told by an idiot. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's metaphor and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about life as a tale told by an idiot in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of life as a tale told by an idiot. Position your

reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *If this which he avouches does appear, There is nor flying hence nor tarrying here.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "tarrying" most nearly mean?

   A. coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army)

   B. armor

   C. later; at some future time

   D. staying; lingering

2. *She should have died hereafter; There would have been a time for such a word. To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death. Out, out, brief candle! Life's but a walking shadow, a poor player That struts and frets his hour upon the stage And then is heard no more: it is a tale Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, Signifying nothing.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene V"?

   A. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

   B. Insecurity on the throne

   C. Life as a tale told by an idiot

   D. The murder and its first guilt

SAT key: 1. D (staying; lingering); 2. C (Life as a tale told by an idiot)

Lesson 28: Act V, Scene VI

Focus: the army reveals itself

Teacher only · spoilers

Before Dunsinane, Malcolm orders the soldiers to throw down their 'leavy screens' and show themselves as they are. His uncle Siward and Siward's son will lead the first battle; Malcolm and Macduff will do the rest. Macduff calls for all the trumpets to sound, 'those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.'

Background: Short battle scenes with alarums (trumpet calls) and quick exits created the impression of a large battle on a bare stage.

Significance: The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the prophecy is fulfilled.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: screens — coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army); clamorous — loud and noisy; trumpets — brass instruments sounded in battle; harbingers — forerunners; messengers announcing what comes next; professes — declares.
Words: screens: coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army) · clamorous: loud and noisy · trumpets: brass instruments sounded in battle · harbingers: forerunners; messengers announcing what comes next · professes: declares

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Short battle scenes with alarums (trumpet calls) and quick exits created the impression of a large battle on a bare stage. The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality. Plot: Malcolm's army throws down its branches and attacks. Structure: A brief scene that speeds the action. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Dunsinane. Before the castle" (Act V, Scene VI, speech (speech 0)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1)). Malcolm's command. That is plot at work: Malcolm's army throws down its branches and attacks.

> *your leavy screens throw down* (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1)). Malcolm's command. That is plot at work: Malcolm's army throws down its branches and attacks.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The trumpets "speak": personification, and the language of the battle is ominous. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: The prophecy is fulfilled. (Battle.)

> *Make all our trumpets speak* (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The trumpets "speak": personification, and the language of the battle is ominous.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: The prophecy is fulfilled. (Battle.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for plot, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the army reveals itself? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VI develops the idea of the army reveals itself. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. When the text says “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1)), it shows this directly. Malcolm orders "your leavy screens throw down" and the trumpets become "harbingers of blood and death."
Task: Annotate the scene for plot, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the army reveals itself? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VI develops the idea of the army reveals itself. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. When the text says “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1)), it shows this directly. Malcolm orders "your leavy screens throw down" and the trumpets become "harbingers of blood and death."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end? Ask: why are the final scenes so short?
Anchor question: Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end?
Facilitation: Ask: why are the final scenes so short?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the army reveals itself? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. ("your leavy screens throw down", Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the army reveals itself? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. ("your leavy screens throw down", Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes the army reveals itself. Key takeaway: the prophecy is fulfilled.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Malcolm's army throws down its branches and attacks.
- **Structure:** A brief scene that speeds the action.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the prophecy is fulfilled.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Dunsinane. Before the castle" (Act V, Scene VI, speech (speech 0)).
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: "trumpets speak; give them all breath, / Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death. Exeunt" (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "your leavy screens throw down" (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1)) Malcolm's command.
- "Make all our trumpets speak" (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3)) Battle.
- "Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death" (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3)) The trumpets.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true.
Evidence: "your leavy screens throw down" (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1))
Reasoning: Malcolm orders "your leavy screens throw down" and the trumpets become "harbingers of blood and death."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
screens (noun)	coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army)	*Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
clamorous (adjective)	loud and noisy	*Make all our trumpets speak; give them all breath, Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
trumpets (noun)	brass instruments sounded in battle	*Make all our trumpets speak; give them all breath, Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
harbingers (noun)	forerunners; messengers announcing what comes next	*Make all our trumpets speak; give them all breath, Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
professes (verb)	declares	*This way, my lord; the castle's gently render'd: The tyrant's people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do bravely in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
clatter (noun)	a loud rattling noise	*There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hateful (adjective)	deserving hatred	*The devil himself could not pronounce a title More hateful to mine ear.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pronounce (verb)	to declare or say aloud	*The devil himself could not pronounce a title More hateful to mine ear.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Malcolm call Siward in this scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: 'Worthy uncle.'
2. What does Malcolm order the soldiers to throw down? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Their leafy screens
3. Who will lead the first battle? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Siward and his son
4. What does Macduff call the trumpets? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Clamorous harbingers of blood and death
5. Where does this scene take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Before Dunsinane castle
6. What is the main effect of the short battle scenes? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Speed and the sense of a large battle
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene VI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Before Dunsinane, Malcolm orders the soldiers to throw down their 'leavy screens' and show themselves as they are. His uncle Siward and Siward's son will lead the first battle; Malcolm and Macduff will do the rest. Macduff calls for all the trumpets to sound, 'those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.'
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene VI", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene VI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are." What does "screens" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: screens: coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army).

Inferential / analytical

1. How does dropping the 'leavy screens' connect to the theme of appearance and reality? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Disguise ends; truth is revealed as the tyrant is confronted.
2. What does “Act V, Scene VI” suggest about the army reveals itself? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the imagery in this scene shape what we understand about the army reveals itself? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1)): Malcolm's command. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene VI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Before Dunsinane, Malcolm orders the soldiers to throw down their 'leavy screens' and show themselves as they are. His uncle Siward and Siward's son will lead the first battle; Malcolm and Macduff will do the rest. Macduff calls for all the trumpets to sound, 'those clamorous harbingers of blood…
7. How does “Act V, Scene VI” build on “Act V, Scene V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3)): Battle. On structure: A brief scene that speeds the action. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3)): The trumpets. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it

begins and ends where it does.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1)): Malcolm's command. On structure: A brief scene that speeds the action. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. If you staged this scene, how would you make a handful of actors feel like an army? Explain. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative staging solution with rationale.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3)): Battle. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3)): The trumpets. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1)): Malcolm's command. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene VI”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the army reveals itself. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3)): Battle. On structure: A brief scene that speeds the action. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3)): The trumpets. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A

judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1)): Malcolm's command. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3)): Battle. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene VI” treats the army reveals itself with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3)): The trumpets. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene VII” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm (speech 1)): Malcolm's command. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the army reveals itself? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff (speech 3)): Battle. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz

1. What does Malcolm order the soldiers to throw down?

   A. Their armor

B. Their weapons

C. Their banners

D. Their leafy screens

2. Who will lead the first battle?

A. Macduff alone

B. Malcolm

C. Siward and his son

D. Lennox

3. What does Macduff call the trumpets?

A. Clamorous harbingers of blood and death

B. The Witches' songs

C. Sweet music of peace

D. Voices of heaven

4. Where does this scene take place?

A. Before Dunsinane castle

B. In England

C. In Birnam Wood

D. At Inverness

5. What is the main effect of the short battle scenes?

A. Speed and the sense of a large battle

B. A long pause before the end

C. A flashback

D. A comic interlude

6. In the line "Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are.", what does "screens" most nearly mean?

A. forerunners; messengers announcing what comes next

B. loud and noisy

C. brass instruments sounded in battle

D. coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army)

7. In the line "Make all our trumpets speak; give them all breath, Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.", what does "clamorous" most nearly mean?

A. coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army)

B. brass instruments sounded in battle

C. loud and noisy

D. forerunners; messengers announcing what comes next

Answer key: 1. D (Their leafy screens); 2. C (Siward and his son); 3. A (Clamorous harbingers of blood and death); 4. A (Before Dunsinane castle); 5. A (Speed and the sense of a large battle); 6. D (coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army)); 7. C (loud and noisy)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene VI,” how does Shakespeare show the army reveals itself? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene VI, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the army reveals itself? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene VI develops the idea of the army reveals itself. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the army reveals itself. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene VI suggests about the army reveals itself. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act V, Scene VI to complicate the reader's understanding of the army reveals itself. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the army reveals itself responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the army reveals itself follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene VI and its treatment of the army reveals itself. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene VI as evidence for a larger claim about the army reveals itself in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene VI as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the army reveals itself. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Make all our trumpets speak; give them all breath, Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “trumpets” most nearly mean?

   A. to declare or say aloud

   B. deserving hatred

   C. brass instruments sounded in battle

   D. a loud rattling noise

2. *Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are. You, worthy uncle, Shall, with my cousin, your right-noble son, Lead our first battle: worthy Macduff and we Shall take upon’s what else remains to do, According to our order.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene VI”?

   A. The tyrant's end and a new order

   B. The guilt that will not wash away

   C. The army reveals itself

   D. Lady Macbeth's resolve

SAT key: 1. C (brass instruments sounded in battle); 2. C (The army reveals itself)

Lesson 29: Act V, Scene VII

Focus: the last false confidence

Teacher only · spoilers

Macbeth, 'tied to a stake' like a baited bear, still fears no man born of woman. He kills Young Siward in single combat and scorns swords 'brandish'd by man that's of a woman born.' Macduff enters seeking only Macbeth, refusing to strike at hired kerns. Siward tells Malcolm the castle is 'gently render'd' and that some of the tyrant's men fight on their side.

Background: Bear-baiting (a bear chained to a stake and attacked by dogs) was a popular entertainment near the Globe; Macbeth's image makes him both fierce and trapped.

Significance: Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: false security.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: professes — declares; clatter — a loud rattling noise; hateful — deserving hatred; pronounce — to declare or say aloud; vulnerable — able to be wounded.
Words: professes: declares · clatter: a loud rattling noise · hateful: deserving hatred · pronounce: to declare or say aloud · vulnerable: able to be wounded

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Bear-baiting (a bear chained to a stake and attacked by dogs) was a popular entertainment near the Globe; Macbeth's image makes him both fierce and trapped. Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand. Characterization: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable. Irony: His confidence in the prophecy. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "not born of woman? Such a one / Am I to fear, or none" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Thou wast born of woman" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9)). Macbeth's confidence. That is characterization at work: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable.

> *Thou wast born of woman* (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Thou wast born of woman" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9)). Macbeth's confidence. That is characterization at work: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The bear image: trapped, fighting. Fate and free will. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: False security. (Bear-baiting image.)

> *They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course* (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The bear image: trapped, fighting. Fate and free will.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: False security. (Bear-baiting image.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the last false confidence? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VII develops the idea of the last false confidence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. When the text says "Thou wast born of woman" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9)), it shows this directly. He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the last false confidence? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VII develops the idea of the last false confidence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. When the text says "Thou wast born of woman" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9)), it shows this directly. He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief? Ask: is Macbeth brave or deluded?
Anchor question: Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief?
Facilitation: Ask: is Macbeth brave or deluded?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the last false confidence? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. (“Thou wast born of woman”, Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the last false confidence? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. (“Thou wast born of woman”, Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the last false confidence. Key takeaway: false security.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable.
- **Irony:** His confidence in the prophecy.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** false security.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “not born of woman? Such a one / Am I to fear, or none” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)).
- **equivocation:** "Fair is foul": appearances and words that mean two things, from the witches to the Porter to the prophecies. In this scene: “shouldst be; / By this great clatter, one of greatest note / Seems bruited. Let me find him, fortune! / And more I beg not” (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff (speech 10)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)) Bear-baiting image.
- "Thou wast born of woman" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9)) Macbeth's confidence.
- "Tyrant, show thy face" (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff (speech 10)) Macduff seeks him.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped.
Evidence: "Thou wast born of woman" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9))
Reasoning: He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
professes (verb)	declares	*This way, my lord; the castle's gently render'd: The tyrant's people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do bravely in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
clatter (noun)	a loud rattling noise	*There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hateful (adjective)	deserving hatred	*The devil himself could not pronounce a title More hateful to mine ear.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pronounce (verb)	to declare or say aloud	*The devil himself could not pronounce a title More hateful to mine ear.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vulnerable (adjective)	able to be wounded	*Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a charmed life, which must not yield To one of woman born.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cheaply (adverb)	at small cost	*Some must go off: and yet, by these I see, So great a day as this is cheaply bought.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
monsters (noun)	freaks shown for money	*Then yield thee, coward, And live to be the show and gaze o' the time: We'll have thee, as our rarer monsters are, Painted on a pole, and underwrit, "Here may you see the tyrant."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
compass (verb)	to surround	*Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The usurper's cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my salutation in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Macduff say he cannot strike at? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Wretched kerns, whose arms are hired to bear their staves.
2. What animal does Macbeth compare himself to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A bear tied to a stake
3. Whom does Macbeth kill in this scene? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Young Siward
4. Why does Macbeth not fear Young Siward? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He was born of woman
5. Whom does Macduff want to fight? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Only Macbeth
6. What has happened to the castle? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It has been gently surrendered
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene VII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Macbeth, 'tied to a stake' like a baited bear, still fears no man born of woman. He kills Young Siward in single combat and scorns swords 'brandish'd by man that's of a woman born.' Macduff enters seeking only Macbeth, refusing to strike at hired kerns. Siward tells Malcolm the castle is 'gently render'd' and that some of the tyrant's men fight on their side.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene VII", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene VII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "This way, my lord; the castle's gently render'd: The tyrant's people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do bravely in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do." What does "professes" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: professes: declares.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macduff refuse to fight anyone but Macbeth? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: His quarrel is personal and just; he seeks justice, not slaughter.
2. What does "Act V, Scene VII" suggest about the last false confidence? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the last false confidence? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: "They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)): Bear-baiting image. On characterization: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "That way the noise is.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act V, Scene VII", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Macbeth, 'tied to a stake' like a baited bear, still fears no man born of woman. He kills Young Siward in single combat and scorns swords 'brandish'd by man that's of a woman born.' Macduff enters seeking only Macbeth, refusing to strike at hired kerns. Siward tells Malcolm the castle is 'gently…
7. How does "Act V, Scene VII" build on "Act V, Scene VI"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: "Thou wast born of woman" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9)): Macbeth's confidence. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: "Tyrant, show thy face" (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff (speech 10)): Macduff seeks him. On characterization: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: "Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)): Bear-baiting image. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does Macbeth's fighting spirit at the end restore any of the admiration we felt for him in Act I? Explain. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment about the tragic hero.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9)): Macbeth's confidence. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff (speech 10)): Macduff seeks him. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)): Bear-baiting image. On characterization: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene VII”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the last false confidence. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9)): Macbeth's confidence. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene VII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff (speech 10)): Macduff seeks

him. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)): Bear-baiting image. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9)): Macbeth's confidence. On irony: His confidence in the prophecy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene VII” treats the last false confidence with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff (speech 10)): Macduff seeks him. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene VIII” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 1)): Bear-baiting image. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the last false confidence? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth (speech 9)): Macbeth's confidence. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz

1. What animal does Macbeth compare himself to?
   A. A hawk
   B. A bear tied to a stake
   C. A lion
   D. A wolf
2. Whom does Macbeth kill in this scene?
   A. Lennox
   B. Young Siward
   C. Macduff
   D. Malcolm
3. Why does Macbeth not fear Young Siward?
   A. He is too young
   B. He is alone
   C. He has no armor
   D. He was born of woman
4. Whom does Macduff want to fight?
   A. The hired soldiers
   B. Only Macbeth
   C. Anyone he meets
   D. Seyton
5. What has happened to the castle?
   A. It has been abandoned to the Witches
   B. It still holds out
   C. It has been gently surrendered
   D. It is burning
6. In the line "This way, my lord; the castle's gently render'd: The tyrant's people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do bravely in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do.", what does "professes" most nearly mean?
   A. to declare or say aloud
   B. a loud rattling noise
   C. declares
   D. deserving hatred
7. In the line "There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited.", what does "clatter" most nearly mean?
   A. deserving hatred
   B. declares

C. to declare or say aloud

D. a loud rattling noise

Answer key: 1. B (A bear tied to a stake); 2. B (Young Siward); 3. D (He was born of woman); 4. B (Only Macbeth); 5. C (It has been gently surrendered); 6. C (declares); 7. D (a loud rattling noise)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene VII," how does Shakespeare show the last false confidence? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene VII, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the last false confidence? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene VII develops the idea of the last false confidence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene VII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the last false confidence. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene VII suggests about the last false confidence. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act V, Scene VII to complicate the reader's understanding of the last false confidence. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene VII within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the last false confidence responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene VII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the last false confidence

follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene VII and its treatment of the last false confidence. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene VII as evidence for a larger claim about the last false confidence in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene VII as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the last false confidence. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *The devil himself could not pronounce a title More hateful to mine ear.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “hateful” most nearly mean?

   A. to surround

   B. at small cost

   C. deserving hatred

   D. freaks shown for money

2. *That way the noise is. Tyrant, show thy face! If thou be’st slain and with no stroke of mine, My wife and children’s ghosts will haunt me still. I cannot strike at wretched kerns, whose arms Are hired to bear their staves: either thou, Macbeth, Or else my sword with an unbatter’d edge I sheathe again undeeded. There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited. Let me find him, fortune! And more I beg not. Exit. Alarums.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene VII”?

   A. The prophecies and their pull

   B. The last false confidence

   C. Hecate and the machinery of fate

   D. The ghost at the banquet

SAT key: 1. C (deserving hatred); 2. B (The last false confidence)

Lesson 30: Act V, Scene VIII

Focus: the tyrant's end and a new order

Content note (suicide (reported), severed head, combat death): Macbeth refuses to 'play the Roman fool' (suicide); Malcolm reports that Lady Macbeth is thought to have taken her own life; Macduff enters with Macbeth's head. Use the safe-messaging script; discuss the verdict on the Macbeths, not the methods.
Student preview: The ending includes deaths, a reported suicide and a severed head. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: "Is Malcolm's description of the Macbeths fair? What does it leave out?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Macbeth refuses to 'play the Roman fool' and die on his own sword. Macduff finds him; Macbeth says he bears a charmed life, but Macduff reveals he was 'from his mother's womb untimely ripp'd.' Macbeth curses the 'juggling fiends' and refuses to yield; they fight. Siward learns his son died with his wounds on the front and accepts it. Macduff enters with Macbeth's head and hails Malcolm as king. Malcolm makes the thanes earls, speaks of 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen,' who is thought to have taken her own life 'by self and violent hands,' and invites all to see him crowned at Scone.

Background: Caesarean birth was rare and almost always fatal to the mother; Macduff's birth makes him 'not of woman born' in the narrow sense Macbeth never considered.

Significance: The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because.... Content note before we start: The ending includes deaths, a reported suicide and a severed head. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the equivocal prophecy completed.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: vulnerable — able to be wounded; cheaply — at small cost; monsters — freaks shown for money; compass — to surround; impress — to force into service; also, to cut into or mark.
Words: vulnerable: able to be wounded · cheaply: at small cost · monsters: freaks shown for money · compass: to surround · impress: to force into service; also, to cut into or mark

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Caesarean birth was rare and almost always fatal to the mother; Macduff's birth makes him 'not of woman born' in the narrow sense Macbeth never considered. The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience. Characterization: Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king. Structure: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "a charmed life, which must not yield / To one of woman born" (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 5)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Macduff was from his mother's womb / Untimely ripp'd" (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff (speech 6)). Caesarean birth. That is characterization at work: Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king.

> *Macduff was from his mother's womb / Untimely ripp'd* (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff (speech 6))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Macduff was from his mother's womb / Untimely ripp'd" (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff (speech 6)). Caesarean birth. That is characterization at work: Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Macbeth's last defiance. Look at the craft: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: The equivocal prophecy completed. (Macbeth's last defiance.)

> *Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, "Hold, enough* (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 9))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Macbeth's last defiance. Look at the craft: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: The equivocal prophecy completed. (Macbeth's last defiance.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VIII develops the idea of the tyrant's end and a new order. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. When the text says “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 9)), it shows this directly. Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VIII develops the idea of the tyrant's end and a new order. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. When the text says “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 9)), it shows this directly. Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out? Ask: is "dead butcher" a fair verdict?
Anchor question: Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out?
Facilitation: Ask: is "dead butcher" a fair verdict?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. (“Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough”, Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 9)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. (“Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough”, Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 9)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the tyrant's end and a new order. Key takeaway: the equivocal prophecy completed.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king.
- **Structure:** Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the equivocal prophecy completed.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “a charmed life, which must not yield / To one of woman born” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 5)).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands / The usurper’s cursed head” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff (speech 21)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff (speech 6)) Caesarean birth.
- “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 9)) Macbeth's last defiance.
- “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm (speech 23)) Malcolm's verdict.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth.
> **Evidence:** “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 9))
> **Reasoning:** Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

vulnerable (adjective)	able to be wounded	*Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a charmed life, which must not yield To one of woman born.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cheaply (adverb)	at small cost	*Some must go off: and yet, by these I see, So great a day as this is cheaply bought.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
monsters (noun)	freaks shown for money	*Then yield thee, coward, And live to be the show and gaze o' the time: We'll have thee, as our rarer monsters are, Painted on a pole, and underwrit, "Here may you see the tyrant."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
compass (verb)	to surround	*Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The usurper's cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my salutation in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
impress (verb)	to force into service; also, to cut into or mark	*Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a charmed life, which must not yield To one of woman born.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
professes (verb)	declares	*This way, my lord; the castle's gently render'd: The tyrant's people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do bravely in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
clatter (noun)	a loud rattling noise	*There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pronounce (verb)	to declare or say aloud	*The devil himself could not pronounce a title More hateful to mine ear.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does Siward react when told his son's wounds were on the front? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He accepts it: his son died as a soldier should; he would not wish him a fairer death.
2. Why will Macbeth not kill himself? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He will not play the Roman fool
3. What does Macduff reveal about his birth? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He was untimely ripped from his mother's womb
4. What does Macduff bring on stage? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Macbeth's head
5. What new title does Malcolm give the thanes? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Earls
6. Where will Malcolm be crowned? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: At Scone
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act V, Scene VIII” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Macbeth refuses to 'play the Roman fool' and die on his own sword. Macduff finds him; Macbeth says he bears a charmed life, but Macduff reveals he was 'from his mother's womb untimely ripp'd.' Macbeth curses the 'juggling fiends' and refuses to yield; they fight. Siward learns his son died with his wounds on the front and accepts it. Macduff enters with Macbeth's head and hails Malcolm as king.…
8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene VIII”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act V, Scene VIII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a charmed life, which must not yield To one of woman born.” What does “vulnerable” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: vulnerable: able to be wounded.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Macbeth finally understand when he calls the Witches 'juggling fiends… that palter with us in a double sense'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: The prophecies deceived through double meanings.
2. What does “Act V, Scene VIII” suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the structure in this scene shape what we understand about the tyrant's end and a new order? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff (speech 6)): Caesarean birth. On structure: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a charmed life, which must…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene VIII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Macbeth refuses to 'play the Roman fool' and die on his own sword. Macduff finds him; Macbeth says he bears a charmed life, but Macduff reveals he was 'from his mother's womb untimely ripp'd.' Macbeth curses the 'juggling fiends' and refuses to yield; they fight. Siward learns his son died with his…
7. How does “Act V, Scene VIII” build on “Act V, Scene VII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 9)): Macbeth's last defiance. On structure: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm (speech 23)): Malcolm's verdict. On characterization: Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with appearance versus reality? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff (speech 6)): Caesarean birth. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Malcolm's final speech an ending we should trust? Consider what he leaves out about Macbeth and Lady Macbeth. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment on the ending's perspective.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 9)): Macbeth's last defiance. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm (speech 23)): Malcolm's verdict. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff (speech 6)): Caesarean birth. On characterization: Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene VIII”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the tyrant's end and a new order. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 9)): Macbeth's last defiance. On structure: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene VIII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm (speech 23)): Malcolm's verdict. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII,

Macduff (speech 6)): Caesarean birth. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 9)): Macbeth's last defiance. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene VIII” treats the tyrant's end and a new order with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm (speech 23)): Malcolm's verdict. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve appearance versus reality? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff (speech 6)): Caesarean birth. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the tyrant's end and a new order? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth (speech 9)): Macbeth's last defiance. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Why will Macbeth not kill himself?

   A. He hopes to escape

B. The Witches forbade it

C. He wants to see Malcolm crowned

D. He will not play the Roman fool

2. What does Macduff reveal about his birth?

A. He is Banquo's son

B. He was untimely ripped from his mother's womb

C. He was born in battle

D. He was born in England

3. What does Macduff bring on stage?

A. Macbeth's sword

B. Macbeth's crown

C. Macbeth's head

D. Lady Macbeth's letter

4. What new title does Malcolm give the thanes?

A. Princes

B. Dukes

C. Earls

D. Knights

5. Where will Malcolm be crowned?

A. In London

B. At Scone

C. At Dunsinane

D. At Forres

6. In the line “Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a charmed life, which must not yield To one of woman born.”, what does “vulnerable” most nearly mean?

A. able to be wounded

B. at small cost

C. to surround

D. freaks shown for money

7. In the line “Some must go off: and yet, by these I see, So great a day as this is cheaply bought.”, what does “cheaply” most nearly mean?

A. freaks shown for money

B. able to be wounded

C. to surround

D. at small cost

Answer key: 1. D (He will not play the Roman fool); 2. B (He was untimely ripped from his mother's womb); 3. C (Macbeth's head); 4. C (Earls); 5. B (At Scone); 6. A (able to be wounded); 7. D (at small cost)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene VIII,” how does Shakespeare show the tyrant's end and a new order? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene VIII, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the tyrant's end and a new order? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene VIII develops the idea of the tyrant's end and a new order. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene VIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the tyrant's end and a new order. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene VIII suggests about the tyrant's end and a new order. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and structure), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act V, Scene VIII to complicate the reader's understanding of the tyrant's end and a new order. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene VIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the tyrant's end and a new order responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene VIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the tyrant's end and a new order follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene VIII and its treatment of the tyrant's end and a new order. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and structure, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene VIII as evidence for a larger claim about the tyrant's end and a new order in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene VIII as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the tyrant's end and a new order. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Then yield thee, coward, And live to be the show and gaze o' the time: We'll have thee, as our rarer monsters are, Painted on a pole, and underwrit, "Here may you see the tyrant."*

   As used in the text, what does the word "monsters" most nearly mean?

   A. freaks shown for money

   B. to declare or say aloud

   C. a loud rattling noise

   D. declares

2. *Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a charmed life, which must not yield To one of woman born.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene VIII"?

   A. The murder and its first guilt

   B. The tyrant's weakening grip

   C. The tyrant's end and a new order

   D. Defiance and despair

SAT key: 1. A (freaks shown for money); 2. C (The tyrant's end and a new order)

Whole-book test

Macbeth: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. Who is the king of Scotland at the start of the play?
   A. Duncan
   B. Macbeth
   C. Edward
   D. Malcolm
2. What weather opens the play?
   A. Heavy snow
   B. A calm night
   C. A clear summer day
   D. Thunder and lightning
3. Who reports Macbeth's deeds in battle at the start of the scene?
   A. A wounded Captain
   B. Macduff
   C. Banquo
   D. A Witch
4. What three titles do the Witches give Macbeth?
   A. Lord of the Isles, Thane of Cawdor, and prince
   B. Thane of Fife, prince, and king
   C. General, Thane of Ross, and king
   D. Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor, and king hereafter
5. How did the old Thane of Cawdor die, according to Malcolm?
   A. Trying to escape
   B. Cursing the king
   C. In battle
   D. Nobly, confessing his treasons
6. What does Lady Macbeth fear about her husband's nature?
   A. It is too cruel
   B. He does not want to be king
   C. It is too full of the milk of human kindness
   D. He is a coward in battle
7. How does Duncan describe the castle?
   A. It is dark and cold

B. It smells of smoke

C. It is too small for his men

D. It has a pleasant seat and sweet air

8. Which relationships does Macbeth say make the murder doubly wrong?

A. He is Malcolm's teacher

B. He is Duncan's son, heir and doctor

C. He is Banquo's friend and brother

D. He is Duncan's kinsman, subject and host

9. Why can Banquo not sleep?

A. He is troubled by cursed thoughts

B. He is guarding the gate

C. He is sick

D. He hears the Witches singing

10. Why did Lady Macbeth not kill Duncan herself?

A. She heard a noise

B. She was afraid of the guards

C. Macbeth forbade it

D. He looked like her father as he slept

11. Whom does the Porter pretend to be?

A. A soldier

B. A king

C. The porter of hell gate

D. A witch

12. What killed the falcon?

A. The storm

B. A mousing owl

C. A hunter

D. A hawk

13. What does Banquo suspect?

A. That Malcolm killed Duncan

B. That Macduff is a traitor

C. That the Witches lied

D. That Macbeth played most foully for the crown

14. What does Lady Macbeth mean by 'Nought's had, all's spent'?

A. They have gained nothing that brings content

B. The war is lost

C. They have lost all their money

D. The feast is over

15. Who joins the first two murderers?
    A. Lady Macbeth
    B. Lennox
    C. A Third Murderer
    D. Macbeth openly
16. What news does the Murderer bring?
    A. Fleance is captured
    B. Both are dead
    C. Banquo escaped
    D. Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped
17. Why is Hecate angry with the Witches?
    A. They left Scotland
    B. They dealt with Macbeth without her
    C. They lied to Macbeth
    D. They killed Banquo
18. How does Lennox speak about the recent deaths?
    A. With praise for Macbeth
    B. With grief and no suspicion
    C. In a letter to Malcolm
    D. With irony, hinting that Macbeth is guilty
19. What does the first apparition, an armed head, warn?
    A. Beware Banquo
    B. Trust Lady Macbeth
    C. Beware Macduff
    D. Fear no man
20. What does Lady Macduff think of her husband's flight?
    A. It was wise and brave
    B. It was ordered by the king
    C. It was madness, and he loves his family not
    D. It was a trick
21. Why does Malcolm pretend to be wicked?
    A. To protect Fleance
    B. To trick Siward
    C. To test whether Macduff is loyal or Macbeth's agent
    D. Because he is afraid to rule
22. What does Lady Macbeth do while sleepwalking?
    A. Writes letters to Macbeth
    B. Rubs her hands as if washing them
    C. Sings with the Witches

D. Sharpens a dagger

23. Near where will the thanes meet the English army?

A. Scone

B. Forres

C. Birnam Wood

D. Inverness

24. Why does Macbeth say he will not fear Malcolm?

A. Malcolm was born of woman

B. Malcolm is a coward

C. Malcolm is in Ireland

D. Malcolm has no army

25. What does Malcolm order each soldier to do?

A. March at night without torches

B. Burn the wood

C. Cut down a bough and carry it

D. Hide in the trees

26. What does Seyton report?

A. The queen is dead

B. The Witches are at the gate

C. Malcolm has surrendered

D. Banquo's ghost has returned

27. What does Malcolm order the soldiers to throw down?

A. Their armor

B. Their weapons

C. Their banners

D. Their leafy screens

28. What animal does Macbeth compare himself to?

A. A hawk

B. A bear tied to a stake

C. A lion

D. A wolf

29. Why will Macbeth not kill himself?

A. He hopes to escape

B. The Witches forbade it

C. He wants to see Malcolm crowned

D. He will not play the Roman fool

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how ambition and its costs develops from the beginning of the play to the end. Use two scenes.
2. Explain how fate and free will develops from the beginning of the play to the end. Use two scenes.
3. Explain how guilt and conscience develops from the beginning of the play to the end. Use two scenes.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the play's central concerns (ambition and its costs, fate and free will, guilt and conscience, appearance versus reality, masculinity, power and violence) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. A (Duncan); 2. D (Thunder and lightning); 3. A (A wounded Captain); 4. D (Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor, and king hereafter); 5. D (Nobly, confessing his treasons); 6. C (It is too full of the milk of human kindness); 7. D (It has a pleasant seat and sweet air); 8. D (He is Duncan's kinsman, subject and host); 9. A (He is troubled by cursed thoughts); 10. D (He looked like her father as he slept); 11. C (The porter of hell gate); 12. B (A mousing owl); 13. D (That Macbeth played most foully for the crown); 14. A (They have gained nothing that brings content); 15. C (A Third Murderer); 16. D (Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped); 17. B (They dealt with Macbeth without her); 18. D (With irony, hinting that Macbeth is guilty); 19. C (Beware Macduff); 20. C (It was madness, and he loves his family not); 21. C (To test whether Macduff is loyal or Macbeth's agent); 22. B (Rubs her hands as if washing them); 23. C (Birnam Wood); 24. A (Malcolm was born of woman); 25. C (Cut down a bough and carry it); 26. A (The queen is dead); 27. D (Their leafy screens); 28. B (A bear tied to a stake); 29. D (He will not play the Roman fool)

Essay assignments

Essay: Ambition and its costs

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Macbeth teaches about ambition and its costs. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops ambition and its costs in Macbeth. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops ambition and its costs across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of ambition and its costs. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of ambition and its costs in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of ambition and its costs, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Macbeth's treatment of ambition and its costs in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on ambition and its costs in Macbeth that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on ambition and its costs in Macbeth. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about ambition and its costs in Macbeth, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on ambition and its costs in Macbeth, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Fate and free will

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Macbeth teaches about fate and free will. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops fate and free will in Macbeth. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops fate and free will across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of fate and free will. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of fate and free will in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of fate and free will, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Macbeth's treatment of fate and free will in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on fate and free will in Macbeth that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on fate and free will in Macbeth. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about fate and free will in Macbeth, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on fate and free will in Macbeth, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Guilt and conscience

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Macbeth teaches about guilt and conscience. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops guilt and conscience in Macbeth. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops guilt and conscience across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of guilt and conscience. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of guilt and conscience in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of guilt and conscience, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Macbeth's treatment of guilt and conscience in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on guilt and conscience in Macbeth that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on guilt and conscience in Macbeth. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about guilt and conscience in Macbeth, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on guilt and conscience in Macbeth, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Appearance versus reality

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Macbeth teaches about appearance versus reality. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops appearance versus reality in Macbeth. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops appearance versus reality across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of appearance versus reality. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of appearance versus reality in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of appearance versus reality, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Macbeth's treatment of appearance versus reality in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on appearance versus reality in Macbeth that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on appearance versus reality in Macbeth. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about appearance versus reality in Macbeth, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on appearance versus reality in Macbeth, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Masculinity, power and violence

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Macbeth teaches about masculinity, power and violence. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops masculinity, power and violence across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of masculinity, power and violence. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of masculinity, power and violence, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Macbeth's treatment of masculinity, power and violence in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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